

Marathi, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they
are written.

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Preface

This book teaches Marathi one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Devanagari letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read नमस्कार *and* learn that it means “greetings” in the same few minutes. (A reader who already reads Devanagari simply skims the letter notes — “the letters in this word” in most chapters, “sounds you’ll need” in Chapter 7.)

Marathi is written in Devanagari, the script of Hindi and Sanskrit — but it is its own **Indo-Aryan** language, the tongue of Maharashtra, and one shaped by long contact with the Dravidian south. So the book keeps two contrasts in view: Marathi’s Sanskrit inheritance (shared with Hindi), and the ways it goes its own way — an extra letter ऌ, *three* grammatical genders where Hindi kept two, and gender marked on the *verb*. Roots are traced to Sanskrit and, where they reach, to the wider Indo-European family that also gave English its words — every form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of any other language is assumed.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Marathi out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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Chapter 1

Namaskar, Piece by Piece

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (13) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 14 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can hear and say namaskār, move हो from tracing through dictation, and read नमस्कार by assembling only signs I have already practised.

Read नमस्कार and copy it only after hearing its meaning, writing हो from memory and sound, and tracing every load-bearing sign in its own short lesson.

1.1 नमस्कार (namaskār) — “greetings”

The first Marathi word — and the everyday greeting of Maharashtra.

The letters in this word

(If you already read Devanagari, skim this.) Devanagari runs **left to right**; every consonant carries a built-in “a.” न na, म ma, का kā, र ra. The stroke under स् (a *halant*) removes its vowel, so the bare *s* leans onto the next as a conjunct: स् + का → स्का. Read न · म · स् · का · र → **namaskār**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नमस्कार (namaskār) = Sanskrit *namaḥ* (“a bow”) + *kāra* (“the making of”) — literally “the making of a bow.” The same word Kannada and Telugu borrowed, and close kin to Hindi’s *namaskār*. But note: where Hindi leans on *namaste*, Marathi’s default, all-purpose greeting is

namaskār — one of many small ways the two Devanagari languages differ.

Why it's said this way

Said with palms pressed together, respectful and neutral — hello and goodbye, any time, to almost anyone. Warmer and more casual: *kāy mhaṇtā?* (“what do you say?” ≈ “how’s it going?”) among friends.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- read it — na · ma · s · kā · r → “namaskār”
- what a *halant* does (removes स’s vowel, for the स्का conjunct)

Before you move on

What does नमस्कार literally mean, and how does Marathi’s greeting habit differ from Hindi’s? (“The making of a bow”; Marathi favors *namaskār*, Hindi *namaste*.)

1.2 ह — the consonant ha

Nothing is assumed but the words you can already say. This chapter turns them into words you can read.

Script

Devanagari is an **abugida**, and that word carries the whole system.

It is not an alphabet, where each letter is one sound. It is a system where **a consonant already carries a vowel**, and you write a vowel mark only when you want a different one.

Here is the first consonant:

ह

That is not *h*. It is **ha** — the consonant *h* with an **a** already inside it, the *a* of English *about*. Nobody wrote that vowel. A bare consonant in this script is understood to carry it, and it is called the **inherent vowel**.

Now look at the top of the shape. There is a **horizontal bar** running across it, and it is not decoration. It is the **shirorekhā**, the head-line, and in running Devanagari it joins up across a whole word so the writing appears to hang from a washing line. It is the single most recognisable thing about this script — and Gujarati, its sister, is written by **erasing** exactly this line.

Writing — notice and trace one consonant

Keep ह visible. Finger-trace it once, then trace one printed model once with a pencil. Say *ha* only after your hand stops. Do not copy the word for “yes” yet; its vowel sign comes next.

Before you move on

What vowel does a bare consonant carry? (**a** — the inherent vowel, and nobody writes it.) What is the bar across the top called, and what does it do in a whole word? (The **shirorekhā**; it **joins up** across the word.)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.3 ो — the vowel sign that replaces the inherent a

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

The inherent **a** is a default. To get a different vowel you **replace** it, with a mark called a **mātrā**.

ो

On its own it is meaningless. Attached to a consonant it swaps the inherent short *a* for **o**, the vowel of English *go* — and notice how it attaches: a stroke to the right, plus a small mark **riding on the head-line itself**.

Put it on the consonant you have:

ह + ो → हो

ho. That is a word: it is **yes**, and you have been saying it since your first lesson in Marathi.

One consonant and one mark, and a word you could already say became a word you can **read**. Nothing was memorised as a picture.

Writing — one supported copy

Keep हो visible. Copy it once: first ह, then its attached ो sign. Point to both pieces in your copy and read *ho*. You may look back after each piece; memory is not the task yet.

Before you move on

What does a mātrā do to the inherent vowel? (**Replaces** it.) What word did those two pieces make? (हो — *ho*, “yes”.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.4 हो — look, hide, write, compare

Look at हो for five seconds. Point first to ह, then to attached ो.
Do not copy it while the model is visible.

Writing — delayed copy

- cover हो
- wait five seconds
- write it once from memory
- uncover the model and compare the two pieces

If one piece differs, circle it and repair only that place. Repair is part of the exercise, not a failure. There is no tracing and no romanized answer model.

Before you move on

Read your repaired word as *ho*. Stop after one memory attempt.

1.5 One heard answer — write what you know

Cover the answer lower on this page. You will hear one familiar answer. No new Marathi and no new Devanagari shape is hiding in this lesson.

Writing — short dictation

[YOU HEAR: *ho* — “yes”]

Write the Devanagari word from sound alone. Do not use a visible model, romanization, or tracing guide. Now uncover and compare: हो. Check ह first and attached ी second. Repair one place if needed.

Before you move on

Writing from sound completes this tiny runway. It is not a mock assessment; later lessons must grow from one known word to forms, messages, and timed tasks.

1.6 न — the consonant na

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

न

na, with the same inherent **a** inside it — the *n* of English *net*, then the vowel nobody wrote.

Nothing new in the machinery. This is simply another consonant, and every rule you already have applies to it unchanged. That is the payoff of learning the system rather than the words: **every consonant from here behaves exactly like the two you already know**. New shapes are coming; new rules are not.

Write it beside the first, and notice both hang from the same head-line.

Your turn

- *Write it:* न
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

What vowel is inside न when nothing is attached? (**a.**) And how many new rules did this lesson introduce? (**None** — only a shape.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.7 ा — a second vowel sign, and the simplest one in the script

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

ा

ā, the long *a* of English *father*. It is a single upright stroke standing to the **right** of its consonant, dropping from the head-line.

न + ा → ना

nā. One beat — a mātrā changes the vowel, it never adds a beat.

You now hold two vowel signs, and they sit in different places: one to the right with a mark above, one plainly to the right. **Where a mātrā sits is part of its identity**, not a style choice, and in this family of scripts they can go right, left, above, below, or on both sides at once. A reader learns to look **around** a consonant rather than only after it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ा
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

Where does this mātrā sit? (To the **right** of the consonant.) Does it add a beat? (**No** — it replaces the vowel.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.8 ी — a mātrā that leans the other way

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

ी

ī, the long *ee* of English *see*. It stands to the right like the last one, but with a curve that rises and **hooks back over the head-line to the left**.

Here it is, and here is what it completes:

ह + ी → ही

And now put that beside a piece you already built:

ना + ही → नाही

nā-hī — no.

You can now read both answers to a yes-or-no question:

हो नाही

Two consonants and three vowel signs. That is the arithmetic of an abugida: consonants and mātrās **multiply**, so a small number of pieces reaches a large number of syllables very fast.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ी
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

What is नाही? (**No.**) How many pieces is it built from? (**Four** — two consonants and two mātrās.) And which two mātrās look similar but hook differently? (The ā and the ī.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.9 म — the consonant ma

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

म

ma — the *m* of English *met*, with the inherent vowel riding along.

Three consonants now. Say them in the order you met them, each with the vowel nobody wrote:

ह न म

ha, na, ma. Three shapes, one head-line each, and the same rule under all of them.

Your turn

- *Write it:* म
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

Say the three consonants you hold, each with its inherent vowel.

(*ha, na, ma.*)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.10 स — the consonant sa

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

स

sa — the *s* of English *sit*, plus the inherent vowel.

Four consonants. You are most of the way to a word you have been saying since your very first lesson, and the only piece of machinery still missing is the one that handles two consonants pressed together.

Your turn

- *Write it:* स
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

What is the inherent vowel in स? (a — *sa*.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.11 क — the consonant ka

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

क

ka — the *k* of English *skip*, unaspirated, with no puff of breath after it.

Hold your palm in front of your mouth and say English *kit*: you feel air. Say *skip*: you do not. **This is the second one.** Devanagari has a separate letter for the breathy version, and swapping them changes the word — so the difference that English treats as an accident is one this script writes down.

Five consonants, two mātrās, and one thing left.

Your turn

- *Write it:* क
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

Is क the *k* of *kit* or of *skip*? (Of ***skip*** — no puff of air.) And does the script care? (**Yes** — the breathy one is a different letter.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.12 ँ — the mark that DELETES the inherent vowel and glues two consonants together

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

The inherent vowel is a nuisance when you do not want it. If a word presses two consonants together with no vowel between them, writing them plainly would insert an *a* that is not there.

So there is a mark that **removes** it:

ँ

This is the **virama**, and it sits under a consonant meaning: *no vowel here*.

Then something happens that no European alphabet does. A consonant stripped of its vowel usually does not sit there bare — it **fuses** with the consonant after it into one joined shape, a **conjunct**:

स + ँ + क → स्क

ska, one cluster. Look closely and both letters are still in there. **Conjuncts are not new characters to memorise** — they are two you already know, joined, and the head-line runs straight across the join.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ँ
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

What does the virama do? (**Removes the inherent vowel.**)
 What usually happens to a consonant that loses its vowel? (It **joins** the next into a conjunct.) And are conjuncts new letters? (**No** — two known letters, fused.)
 Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.13 र — the last consonant of the greeting

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

र

ra — a light tap of the tongue, closer to the *r* in Spanish *pero* than to an English *r*.

That is the last piece. Everything the greeting needs is now something you can write from memory.

Your turn

- *Write it:* र
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

How is र made? (A **light tap** of the tongue, not an English *r*.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

1.14 नमस्कार — seven pieces, all of them already yours

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

Nothing new is introduced in this lesson. Every piece below is one you can write.

न + म + स + ् + क + ा + र → नमस्कार

Read it the way you built it:

- न — *na*, inherent vowel
- म — *ma*, inherent vowel

- स्क — the conjunct: *sa* with its vowel removed, fused to *ka*
- ा — the mātrā, making that piece *kā*
- र — *ra*

na-ma-skār. The greeting from your first lesson, now decoded rather than recalled.

Count what it took: **six consonants, three vowel signs, and one virama.** With them you can read *yes*, *no*, and the greeting — and every consonant you meet from here obeys rules you already hold.

Devanagari has around forty more letters. It does not have any more **systems.**

Your turn

- *Write it:* नमस्कार
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

How many new pieces were in this lesson? (**None.**) What is स्क made of? (स with its vowel removed, joined to क.) And what still remains to learn — rules, or shapes? (**Shapes.**)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

Chapter 2

Hear Thanks, Then Meet Six Signs

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (6)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can understand and say dhanyavad before decoding it, then write six new Devanagari signs one at a time through visible, guided, and delayed work.

Write dental ta after a delay while keeping the first five signs separately retrievable.

2.1 धन्यवाद (dhanyavād) — “thank you”

The formal “thanks” — Sanskrit, shared across the Indian languages.

You’ll want to know — hear the word before reading it

Keep the spelling in the heading as a sign you are not yet asked to decode. Listen first: *ghan-ya-vād*. Say it once for “thank you.” The next two tiny chapters will give you one missing sign at a time; only then will you read and write the whole word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Dhanyavād = Sanskrit *dhanya* (“worthy”) + *vāda* (“a saying”) — “an utterance of ‘[you are] worthy.’” The same Sanskrit word behind Hindi *dhanyavād*, Kannada *dhanyavāda*, Telugu *dhanyavādamulu*. Warmer, more spoken Marathi often says *ābhārī āhe* (“[I] am grateful”), on the root *ābhār*, “gratitude.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dhanyavād” — no reading yet
- the warmer spoken form — “ābhārī āhe”

Before you move on

What are the two Sanskrit pieces of *dhanyavād*, and a warmer Marathi alternative? (*dhanya* “worthy” + *vāda* “a saying”; *ābhārī āhe*.)

2.2 ः — a small breath after a vowel

You already know the greeting *namaskār* and its older first piece, *namaḥ*, “a bow.” The final breath in *namaḥ* has its own mark.

Script

ः

The **visarga** is two dots written vertically to the right of a syllable. It marks a quiet breath after the vowel. For this first encounter, place the upper dot, lift, then place the lower dot. Stop after this one sign.

Writing — visible model

Keep ः visible. Point to the upper dot, then the lower dot. Finger-trace the two positions once and copy the sign once.

Before you move on

Name it: **visarga**, a breath after a vowel.
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0903.

2.3 आ — long aa standing alone

Set one blank line aside for a single new vowel sign.

Script

आ

This is independent ā, used when the vowel begins a syllable. Curve around the joined left body; lift for the middle shoulder; descend the inner stem; descend the trailing stem; finish with the headline from left to right.

Writing — trace, then guided copy

Keep आ visible. Finger-trace the five runs once. Copy it once, looking back after every run. Say ā only when the pen stops.

Before you move on

Is this a vowel sign attached to a consonant? (**No.** It stands alone.)
Source: Saurmandal, Devanagari आ stroke order, frames 1–5.

2.4 भ — bha, with a puff of breath

Make room for one consonant and one careful copy.

Script

भ

Say *ba*, then *bha* with a small puff against your palm. For the shape, sweep the upper loop into the trunk, lower bowl, and crossbar without lifting; descend the right stem; finish the headline left to right.

Writing — guided copy

Keep भ visible. Copy one run at a time, looking back before each. Say *bha* once after the headline is complete.

Before you move on

Which has the puff: *ba* or *bha*? (**bha.**)
Source: JackPotte, Devanagari bh stroke animation.

2.5 ऎ — e above the headline

Leave a small space above the next practice headline.

Script

ॎ

This mātrā replaces the inherent vowel with **e**. Add its short rising stroke above the consonant's headline; it cannot stand alone as a spoken vowel here.

Writing — guided copy and first retrieval

Copy ऎ once beside the visible model. Then cover the previous three models and write, from their names, visarga, independent *ā*, and *bha*. Uncover and repair only one differing part.

Before you move on

Where does **e** sit? (**Above the headline.**)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0947.

2.6 ः — one nasal dot

Prepare to place one mark above a headline.

Script

ॐ

The **anusvāra** is one dot above the headline. It marks a nasal sound whose exact place follows the sound after it. Place one dot; do not turn it into the two-dot visarga.

Writing — guided copy

Keep ः visible and copy it once. Point above the imaginary headline where the dot belongs.

Before you move on

One dot or two? (**One.**)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0902.

2.7 त — dental ta

Touch the tongue lightly behind the upper teeth once.

Script

त

Touch the tongue lightly behind the upper teeth: *ta*. Sweep left across the shoulder and curve down to the open tip; descend the right stem; finish the headline left to right.

Writing — look, hide, write

Look at त for five seconds. Cover it, wait five seconds, and write it once. Uncover and compare body, stem, then headline.

Before you move on

Say *ta* once with the tongue at the teeth.

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ta stroke animation.

Chapter 3

Six More Signs Make Thank You Readable

Modes: ✍ pen (7) ⇌ Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write six more Devanagari signs from delayed or heard cues, then read and write dhanyavad independently.

Hear, say, read, and independently write dhanyavad only after every load-bearing sign has been taught.

3.1 ढ — dental da

Keep the tongue-at-the-teeth position ready and add voice next.

Script

ढ

Keep the tongue at the teeth and add voice: *da*. Descend the short stem; lift for the outer body, inward curl, and down-right tail; finish the headline.

Writing — delayed copy and retrieval

Look at ढ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Then retrieve the preceding three names: e-mark, anusvāra, dental *ta*. Repair only one miss.

Before you move on

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari da stroke animation.

3.2 ध — dha, voiced and breathy

Keep the dental voiced position ready; this sign adds breath.

Script

ध

Say *da*, then add a puff: *dha*. Curl around the upper spiral and sweep through its shoulder; lift for the lower bowl; descend the right stem; finish the headline.

Writing — delayed copy and a wider return

Hide ध after five seconds and write it once. Then, without models, name the first three signs of this runway: visarga, independent *ā*, *bha*.

Before you move on

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari dha stroke animation.

3.3 ब — ba without the puff

Hold one hand near your mouth so you can notice the missing puff.

Script

ब

This is *ba*, the quiet partner of *bha*. Circle the oval body; descend the right stem; draw the inner diagonal down-right; finish the headline.

Writing — heard cue

Cover the model. [YOU HEAR: *ba*, without a puff.] Write the single consonant from sound alone. Uncover ब and repair only the differing run.

Before you move on

Source: JackPotte, Devanagari ba stroke animation.

3.4 य — ya

Say the first sound of English *yes* once.

Script

य

Curve around the small inner curl; lift for the lower bowl; descend the right stem; finish the headline. The sound is the *y* at the start of English *yes*.

Writing — heard cue and retrieval

Cover the model. [YOU HEAR: *ya*.] Write the consonant once. Then say the three sign names immediately before it: dental *da*, breathy *dha*, quiet *ba*.

Before you move on

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ya stroke animation.

3.5 ऌ — Marathi's curled-back lla

Curl the tongue tip back once without adding a vowel.

Script

ऌ

Curl the tongue tip back for *la*. Draw the left loop through the centre and around the right loop in one run; add the short stem above the right loop; finish the headline.

Writing — heard cue and wider retrieval

Cover the model. [YOU HEAR: curled-back *la*.] Write it once. Then retrieve the e-mark, anusvāra, and dental *ta* by name; those three have now crossed a wider gap.

Before you move on

Source: Indic Script Explorer, U0933 stroke data.

3.6 व — between English *v* and *w*

Relax the lips for a light sound between English *v* and *w*.

Script

व

Marathi *va* can sound lighter than English *v*, toward *w*. Travel left around the top and circle the loop counterclockwise; descend the right stem; finish the headline.

Writing — heard cue

Cover the model. [YOU HEAR: *va*.] Write one consonant from sound. Uncover व and compare loop, right stem, headline.

Before you move on

Source: JackPotte, Devanagari va stroke animation.

3.7 धन्यवाद — now read what you already mean

Nothing in this word is an unknown shape now. Read ध · न्
· य · वा · द, join the middle consonants, and say धन्यवाद —
dhanyavād, “thank you.”

Your turn

- hear *dhanyavād* and point to धन्यवाद

- say the word from the English cue “thank you”
- read धन्यवाद without romanization
- cover every model and write धन्यवाद from the heard cue

Then retrieve the last three signs separately: *ya*, curled-back *la*, *va*.

Before you move on

Stop after one independent attempt.

Chapter 4

Courtesy, Responses, and Leave-Taking

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 👁️ eyes (4) 🖐️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can thank someone, answer yes or no, say that things are fine, and take my leave politely in Marathi.

Retrieve thanks, yes, fine, no, and gendered leave-taking in one short listening-and-speaking checkpoint, then write familiar हो without a visible model.

4.1 हो (ho) — “yes”

A one-syllable “yes.”

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) ह (ha) + the *o*-mātrā ो → हो (ho).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हो (ho, “yes”) is Marathi’s plain affirmative — distinct from Hindi’s *hāni*. Marathi builds its own everyday words on shared Indo-Aryan roots. The polite, fuller “yes” is *ho, barāṃ āhe* (“yes, it’s fine”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ho” (“yes”)
- the fuller polite form — “ho, baram̐ āhe”

Now cover the recent script models. Write dental *da*, breathy *dha*, and quiet *ba* once from their spoken names. Uncover and repair only a missed sign.

Before you move on

What is Marathi’s “yes,” and how does it differ from Hindi’s? (*ho*; Hindi says *hānī*.)

4.2 बरं (baram̐) — “okay, fine”

The verbal shrug of Marathi — “sure, fine, all right.”

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Devanagari.*) ब (*ba*) + रं (*ra* with the *anusvāra* dot ँ, a light nasal) → **baram̐**. That dot on top nasalises the vowel.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बरं (*baram̐*, “okay, fine, good, all right”) is the oil of everyday Marathi talk — a soft “sure, fine.” Its neutral form is *bare*. A genuinely Marathi word, not a Sanskrit loan — the kind of small, high-frequency word that gives a language its everyday texture.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “baram̐” (feel the nasal dot)
- “ho, baram̐ āhe” — “yes, it’s fine”

Before you move on

What does बरं mean, and what does the dot ँ do? (“Okay/fine”; the *anusvāra* nasalises the vowel.)

4.3 नाही (nāhī) — “no,” a word older than English

The partner of *ho* — built on one of the oldest words in the whole Indo-European family.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) ना (nā) + ही (hī) → **nāhī**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाही (nāhī, “no / is not”) sits on the ancient negative **na-** — the *same* Proto-Indo-European ***ne** behind English **no**, **not**, **none**, Latin *non*, and Hindi *nahī*. So Marathi’s “no” and English’s “no” are cousins from before either language existed. It doubles as “there isn’t”: Marathi, like Hindi, denies with this one word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — *ho* (“yes”) / *nāhī* (“no”)
- the ancient cousins — *no*, *not*, Latin *non*

Before you move on

What ancient root is नाही built on, and what English words share it? (PIE **ne*; *no*, *not*, *none*.)

4.4 येतो / येते (yeto / yete) — “I’ll take my leave”

The Marathi goodbye — which, like the Dravidian languages, refuses to say a bare “I’m leaving.” And it changes with the speaker’s gender.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) ये (ye) + तो (to) → *yeto*; ये + ते (te) → *yete*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Marathi, like the Dravidian languages to its south, will not say a bare “I’m leaving.” The everyday goodbye is **येतो** (*yeto*) — literally “I **come** [again],” a promise of return, never a final departure. (Fuller: *yeto*, *namaskār*.)

Grammar Lens: Marathi verbs carry gender

yeto is what a **man** says; a **woman** says **येते** (*yete*). The verb itself changes with the speaker’s gender — something Hindi does only in the past tense, but Marathi does in the **present** too. (And Marathi keeps **three** genders — masculine, feminine, and neuter — where Hindi kept only two.) You’ll meet this at every verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “yeto” (if male) / “yete” (if female)
- what it literally means (“I come [again]”) — a promise of return

Before you move on

What does the Marathi goodbye literally mean, and why two forms? (“I’ll come [again]”; the verb agrees with the speaker’s gender — *yeto* m. / *yete* f.)

4.5 Chapter 4 — courtesy, responses, and leave-taking

Marathi		Meaning
नमस्कार	<i>namaskār</i>	hello / goodbye
धन्यवाद	<i>dhanyavād</i>	thank you
हो	<i>ho</i>	yes
नाही	<i>nāhī</i>	no
बरं	<i>baram</i>	okay / fine
येतो / येते	<i>yeto / yete</i>	“I’ll be going” (m./f.)

What you've built

- It prefers **namaskār** as the everyday greeting (Hindi leans on *namaste*).
- It keeps **three** genders — masculine, feminine, neuter — where Hindi kept two.
- It marks **gender on the verb**, even in the present: *yeto* (m.) / *yete* (f.).
- It has an **extra letter**, ऌ (retroflex *ḷ*), shared with the Dravidian south and absent from Hindi.

Shared with Hindi/Sanskrit: the Devanagari script, the negative *nā-* (← PIE **ne*, English *no*), and much formal vocabulary (*dhanyavād*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six — namaskār · dhanyavād · ho · nāhī · baram · yeto/yete
- greet and thank — “namaskār!” ... “dhanyavād.”
- your leave-taking — “yeto/yete”

Before you move on

Read नमस्कार, write हो once without a model, then name two ways Marathi differs from Hindi despite sharing Devanagari. (Prefers *namaskār*; three genders; gender on the verb; the extra letter ऌ.)
Next chapter: introducing yourself — *mājhe nāv...* (“my name...” — and Marathi’s *tū* / *tumhī* (familiar / respectful “you”).

Chapter 5

Marks Above, Below, and Beside the Letter

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write and name the six Devanagari marks the rest of this book leans on, and say where each one sits relative to its letter.

Retrieve all six marks cold, by name and by placement, with no model on the page.

5.1 ि — short *i*, written before, read after

Say *dhanyavād* once from memory. Every mark in this chapter hangs on a consonant your hand already knows.

Script

ि

The short-*i* mark is the one that breaks the rule you would guess. It is **written to the LEFT** of its consonant and **read to the RIGHT** of it: कि is *ki*, never *ik*. The eye meets the mark first; the ear meets it second.

Draw the upright on the left of the letter, then carry the curve up and over the headline so it hooks back to the right. The hook is what tells this mark apart from its long partner, which you will meet later.

Writing — observe and trace

Keep कि in front of you. Trace the mark alone twice, then trace it beside क twice more. Say *ki* each time your pen finishes the hook, so the hand and the ear learn the same order the page will use.

Before you move on

Which side of क does the mark sit on? (**The left.**) Which side do you hear it on? (**The right.**)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+093F.

5.2 ँ — short *u*, a small hook below

One mark went to the left. This one goes straight down, and it is the mark you will meet most often of all.

Script

ँ

The short-*u* mark is a small hook tucked **under** the letter, opening to the right. It hangs from the foot of the stem, not from the headline.

तु is *tu* — the opening syllable of the polite *tumhā* you already say. Start at the base of त, dip below the line, and curl right. Keep it small: its long partner is the same hook drawn deeper.

Writing — guided copy

Copy तु twice with the model visible, saying *tu* as the hook closes. Then write the short-*i* mark once beside it from memory and check it still leans left.

Before you move on

Above the line, below it, or beside it? (**Below.**)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0941.

5.3 ऄ — long $\bar{u}$, the deeper hook below

You have the short hook. The long one is the same gesture, carried further.

Script

ॄ

Long $\bar{u}$ is the short hook drawn **deeper and turned back on itself**, so it finishes pointing down-left rather than right. Same place, same start, more travel.

दृ is $d\bar{u}$ — the first syllable of the word for milk. Say *tu* and $d\bar{u}$ one after the other and you can hear the length the extra travel is paying for.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at दृ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and compare the depth of the hook against the short one you wrote a moment ago. Repair only if the two look the same.

Before you move on

tu or $d\bar{u}$ — which hook travels further? (दृ.)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0942.

5.4 ॢ — the vocalic *r* mark, said *ru*

A third mark below the line. This one is not a vowel you have a letter for in English.

Script

ॢ

This mark writes a sound Sanskrit treated as a **vowel made of r**. Marathi speakers say it *ru*, so कृ is heard as *kṛ*, close to *kru*.

The shape is a small curl below the letter that opens to the left — the mirror of the short-*u* hook, and that mirroring is exactly how to remember it. It appears in tatsama words the language borrowed whole, like कृति, “activity”.

Writing — guided copy

Copy ऋ twice with the model visible. Then put the short-*u* hook beside it and check that the two curls open in opposite directions.

Before you move on

How does a Marathi speaker say this vowel? (**ru.**)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0943.

5.5 ँ — the moon holding a dot

You already write one nasal mark above the headline. Here is its second, softer cousin.

Script

ँ

The **candrabindu** is one dot cradled in a small upward crescent — a moon holding a dot, which is exactly what its name says.

Set it beside the anusvāra you already write:

ँ closes the vowel onto a nasal consonant. ँ leaves the vowel open and sends the air through the nose while you are still saying it. Draw the crescent first, sitting on the headline, then place the single dot inside it.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ँ twice, then trace ं once beside it. Point at which of the two carries a crescent. Repair only the mark that came out wrong.

Before you move on

Which of the two nasal marks has a moon under it? (**The candrabindu.**)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart, U+0901.

5.6 अ — the vowel your consonants have been hiding

Say क on its own. You did not say a bare *k*. Something came after it.

Script

अ

Every Devanagari consonant carries a short *a* inside it unless a mark or a halant takes it away: क is *ka*, not *k*. अ is that same hidden vowel written out on its own, for when a word begins with it and there is no consonant to hide inside.

You already write its long partner आ, and the relationship is visible: आ is अ with one upright added on the right. Draw the left loop, the vertical stem, then the headline that ties them together.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at अ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Then add the upright and check that you have made आ. If the two came out identical, the upright is missing.

Before you move on

What does क say on its own? (*ka* — the vowel is already inside.)
Source: Saurmandal, Devanagari a stroke order.

5.7 Six marks, named without the page

Close the chapter. Nothing here needs the page: every answer is a name and a place.

Before you move on

Which mark is written before its letter but read after it? (*i-mātrā*.)
[PAUSE 2s] Which two hang under the line, and which of them travels further? (Short *u* and long *ū*; the long one.)
[PAUSE 2s] Which curl opens the opposite way from short

u? (The vocalic *r*.) [PAUSE 2s] Which nasal mark sits in a crescent? (The candrabindu.) [PAUSE 2s] What vowel is already inside every consonant you write? (Short *a*.)

Chapter 6

The Throat Row and the Palate Row

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ↙ pen (7) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write seven more consonants and say, for any of them, whether the voice is on and whether the breath is released.

Say both four-step rows in order from the two switches that generate them, with no model on the page.

6.1 ख — *ka* with the breath let out

Say *ka* with your hand in front of your mouth. Now say it again and push the air out after it. That second sound has its own letter.

Script

ख

ख is *kha*: क said with a puff of breath released after it. Marathi keeps the two apart the way English keeps *pin* and *bin* apart — swap them and you have a different word.

The shape is not क with a mark added; it is its own letter. Draw the left loop, then the upright with its foot, then the headline across the top. You will need it for *khāṇe*, “to eat”.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ख twice with the model visible. Say *ka*, then *kha*, as your pen finishes each one, and listen for the puff that only the second has.

Before you move on

ka or *kha* — which one moves the air? (*kha*.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari kha stroke animation.

6.2 ण — the same place, with the voice on

Put two fingers on your throat and say *ka*, then *ga*. The place in your mouth does not move. Something else switches on.

Script

ण

ण is *ga*: the same back-of-the-mouth closure as क, made with the voice running. That is the only difference, and your fingers felt it a moment ago.

The shape is a single curve that swings down and left from the headline and finishes with a small tail on the right. It is the first letter of *gāv*, “village”, and it sits inside *sāṅḡe*, “to tell” — a verb this book uses long before it shows you this letter.

Writing — guided copy

Copy ण twice with the model visible. Then write ख once from memory beside it, and check the two are not the same shape.

Before you move on

Which of *ka* and *ga* switches the voice on? (*ga*.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ga stroke animation.

6.3 घ — voice and breath together

You have the puff, and you have the voice. Now do both in one sound.

Script

घ

घ is *gha*: voiced like ग, breathy like ख. Four letters now sit at the same place in your mouth, and only voice and breath tell them apart:

क plain · ख breath · ग voice · घ voice and breath.

You already say this letter. *Kāl̥jī ghyā*, “take care”, ends in it, and so does *ghēṇe*, “to take”. Draw the left bowl, then the right stem, then the headline.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at घ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and check it against ग: the bowl on the left is what you are looking for.

Before you move on

Of *ka*, *kha*, *ga*, *gha* — which one has both? (*gha*.)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari gha stroke animation.

6.4 च — one letter, two Marathi sounds

Move forward in your mouth: from the back, where *ka* lives, to the roof, right behind your teeth.

Script

च

च is *ca*, close to English *ch* in *church*. Marathi does something Hindi does not: in many words it says this letter as **ts**, the sound at the end of English *cats*. *Cār*, “four”, is one of them.

One letter, two pronunciations, and no mark on the page to tell you which — that is a thing you learn word by word. The shape is a bowl opening to the right, hung under the headline with a short stem.

Writing — guided copy

Copy च twice with the model visible. Say *ca* on the first and *tsa* on the second, so the hand learns that one shape carries both.

Before you move on

How many sounds does च carry in Marathi? (**Two.**)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ca stroke animation.

6.5 छ — the palate, with the breath let out

The same pair you learned at the back of the mouth happens again at the roof of it.

Script

छ

छ is *chha*: च with the breath released, exactly the step that took you from क to ख. Devanagari does this all the way down the alphabet — plain, breathy, voiced, voiced-and-breathy — which is why learning one row teaches you how to hear the next.

The shape is a closed loop with a tail curving away below. It carries *vicāraṇe* in some spellings and stands at the head of *chān*, “nice”.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace छ twice, then trace च once beside it. Point at the closed loop: that is what the breath costs you on the page.

Before you move on

Which of च and छ releases the breath? (छ.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari cha stroke animation.

6.6 ज — voice at the palate

Fingers on the throat again. Say *ca*, then *ja*. Same roof, voice on.

Script

ज

ज is *ja*, and it shadows च exactly: where a word says च as *ts*, it usually says ज as *dz*. The two travel together.

You need it for *jāne*, “to go”, and it hides inside *kāljī*, “care”, in the phrase you already use for goodbye. Draw the top stroke, the middle knot, and the descending stem under the headline.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at ज for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Then retrieve the names of the two letters before it in this chapter.

Before you move on

What does ज become where च becomes *ts*? (*dz*.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ja stroke animation.

6.7 झ — the letter inside *mājhe*

One more of the four-way sets, and this one closes a word you have been saying since your first introduction.

Script

झ

झ is *jha*: voiced like ज, breathy like छ. The palate now has its full four, in the same order the back of your mouth did.

This is the letter sitting in the middle of *mājhe*, “my” — माझे — a word this book taught you to say long before it taught you to read it. Every sign in that word is now yours.

Writing — guided copy

Copy माझे twice with the model visible, naming each sign as you form it: *ma*, long *ā*, *jha*, *e*-mark. This is the first whole word this runway has made writable.

Before you move on

Which sign in माझे did you learn today? (झ.)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari jha stroke animation.

6.8 Two rows, told apart by voice and breath

Two questions decide every letter in this chapter: is the voice on, and is the breath let out? Answer those and you have the row.

Before you move on

Back of the mouth: plain, breathy, voiced, voiced-and-breathy. (*ka, kha, ga, gha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Roof of the mouth, same four steps. (*ca, cha, ja, jha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which of the eight sits inside *mājhe*? (*jha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which one does Marathi also say as *ts*? (*ca.*)

Reaching back one chapter, with nothing on the page: which hook goes deeper, short *u* or long *ū*? (*ū.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which curl opens the other way? (The vocalic *r.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which nasal mark wears a crescent? (The candrabindu.) [PAUSE 2s] And which vowel is already inside every consonant? (Short *a.*)

Chapter 7

The Curled Row, and One Letter from the Lips

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ↙ pen (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write the four retroflex consonants and plain pa, and hear the curled row apart from the dental one.

Retrieve the curled row and plain pa cold, together with two marks from two chapters back.

7.1 ढ — the tongue curled back

Say *ta* with your tongue on your teeth. Now curl the tip up and back until it touches the ridge behind them, and say it again.

Script

ढ

That second sound is ढ, *ṭa*. Marathi has a whole row of these **retroflex** letters, made with the tongue tip curled back, and they are genuinely different words from the dental row you already write: ढ and ढ are not variants.

The shape is a hook that opens to the right and hangs from the headline. It is the sound in *ṭebal*, the borrowed word for table, and it is why this book has been writing *ṭ* with a dot under it in every romanization you have read.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ढ twice, then trace ढ once beside it. Say each one with the tongue in the right place. If they sound the same, the tongue has not moved.

Before you move on

Teeth or ridge for ढ? (**Ridge.**)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari tta stroke animation.

7.2 ढ — the curl, with the breath let out

The four-way pattern again: you have the plain one, so you can predict the next.

Script

ढ

ढ is *ṭha*: ढ with the breath released. You have now seen this step three times — ढ/ख, च/छ, and here — which is the point. Devanagari is built so that hearing one pair teaches you to expect the rest.

The shape is a plain circle sitting under the headline. It is the roundest letter in the alphabet and the easiest of this chapter to draw.

Writing — guided copy

Copy ढ twice with the model visible. Then write ढ once from memory and check the hook did not close into a circle.

Before you move on

Which of the two is a full circle? (ढ.)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ttha stroke animation.

7.3 ढ — the curl, with the voice on

Fingers on the throat, tongue curled back. Say *ṭa*, then switch the voice on.

Script

ड

ड is *ḍa*, the voiced member of the curled row — the same relationship ण has to ण.

Marathi needs it for *ḍolā*, “eye”, a word that also carries the retroflex ढ you learned in the doorway chapters. Draw the top stroke, then the body that curves down and closes to the left under the headline.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at ड for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and set it beside ढ: one closes into a ring, the other does not.

Before you move on

Which word for a part of the face starts with ड? (*ḍolā* — eye.)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari dda stroke animation.

7.4 ण — the nasal with the tongue curled back

Every row in this alphabet ends with its own nasal. The curled row is no exception.

Script

ण

ण is *ṇa*: the tongue curled back, the air through the nose. Set it against ण, the dental nasal you learned in your first chapter, and the difference is the same one you made a moment ago for *ta* and *ṭa*.

This is the single most useful letter in this chapter. It ends every Marathi infinitive this book teaches — *bolṇe*, *khāṇe*, *jāṇe*, *sāṅṇe* — so once it is yours, the shape of “to do something” is readable.

Writing — guided copy

Copy ण twice with the model visible. Then write ण once beside it and say both aloud, curling the tongue only for the first.

Before you move on

Which letter ends *bolṇe* and *khāṇe*? (प, with the *e*-mark after it.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari nna stroke animation.

7.5 प — the lips, with the voice off

Leave the tongue alone for this one. Close your lips, and let the voice stay off.

Script

प

प is *pa*, the voiceless partner of the ब you already write. Same lips, same closure, voice switched off — the fourth time this book has used that one distinction to give you a letter.

It opens *pāṇī*, “water”, and *pāḥṇe*, “to see”, and it stands inside *punhā*, “again”, in the goodbye you already say. The shape is ब without the inner dot: left bowl, right stem, headline across.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at प for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and set it beside ब: the missing dot is the whole difference on the page.

Before you move on

Voice on or off for प? (**Off.**)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari pa stroke animation.

7.6 The curled row, and one letter from the lips

One question for the row: where is the tongue? Then two older marks, further back than you have retrieved them before.

Before you move on

Tongue curled back: plain, breathy, voiced, nasal. (*ṭa, ṭha, ḍa, ṇa.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which of them ends every infinitive this book teaches? (*ṇa.*) [PAUSE 2s] Lips closed, voice off — and one dot fewer than ँ. (*pa.*) [PAUSE 2s] Where does the short-*i* mark go on the page? (Left of its letter.)

One chapter back, at the roof of the mouth: plain, breathy, voiced. (*ca, cha, ja.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which of those three does Marathi also say as *ts*? (*ca.*)

Chapter 8

Two Sibilants, One Liquid, and Three Standalone Vowels

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ↙ pen (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write the last six signs of the second runway, and name every sign in it after four chapters' distance.

Retrieve the whole twenty-four-sign runway at real distance, one group at a time.

8.1 ल — the plain *l*, beside the curled one you know

You learned the harder *l* first. Here is the ordinary one.

Script

ल

ल is plain *la*, the tongue at the teeth — the sound English writes with *l*. You already write ऌ, the retroflex *ḷ* Marathi keeps alongside it, and which Hindi does not have at all.

Meeting the rare one first was not an accident: ऌ sits in *kālḷi* and *ḍolā*, words this book needed early. Now the common one arrives, and with it *bolṇe*, “to speak”, becomes readable end to end.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ल twice, then trace ऌ once beside it. Say *la* and *la*, moving the tongue back only for the second.

Before you move on

Which of the two does Hindi not have? (ऌ.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari la stroke animation.

8.2 श — the *sh* at the roof of the mouth

You write the plain *s*. Slide the tongue back along the roof of your mouth and it becomes something else.

Script

श

श is *śa*, English *sh*. Marathi keeps it distinct from the स you learned in your first chapter, and the pair behaves like every other pair in this runway: same air, different place.

It opens *śahar*, “city” — one of the six labels the A1 form chapters will ask you to fill in. Draw the left hook, the upright, and the headline; the small loop at the top left is what separates it from स.

Writing — guided copy

Copy श twice with the model visible. Then write स once beside it and say both, sliding the tongue back only for the first.

Before you move on

Which one opens *śahar*? (श.)
Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari sha stroke animation.

8.3 ष — the third sibilant, kept on the page

Marathi writes three sibilants and says two. This is the third one.

Script

ॡ

ॡ is *ṣa*, the retroflex sibilant. Sanskrit distinguished it from ॠ; most Marathi speakers today say the two the same way, and keep them apart only in **spelling**.

That is worth knowing rather than hiding: a letter can survive in the writing system after the sound behind it has merged. ॡ appears in tatsama words taken whole from Sanskrit, such as *bhāṣā*, “language” — another of the six form labels waiting for you.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at ॡ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and set it beside ॠ: two shapes your mouth no longer separates.

Before you move on

Are ॠ and ॡ different sounds for most speakers today? (**No — different spellings.**)

Source: Opiaterein, Devanagari ssa stroke animation.

8.4 ॢ — short *u* standing on its own

You already hang a short *u* under a consonant. What happens when there is no consonant to hang it on?

Script

ॢ

Then you write ॢ, the independent short *u* — the same vowel given its own full letter for the start of a word.

Devanagari does this for every vowel: a **mark** when something carries it, a **letter** when nothing does. You have already seen the pair once, with ॠ and its mark. ॢ opens *udyā*, “tomorrow”, in the farewell this book taught you chapters ago.

Writing — guided copy

Copy उ twice with the model visible. Then write the short-*u* mark beside it and say aloud which of the two needs a consonant to lean on.

Before you move on

Which word for *tomorrow* starts with it? (*udyā.*)
Source: Saurmandal, Devanagari u stroke order.

8.5 ऊ — long *ū* standing on its own

One more, and this runway is finished. It is the long partner of the letter you wrote a moment ago.

Script

ऊ

ऊ is the independent long *ū*: उ with a tail carried down and to the right, the same extra travel the long mark asked for below the line.

Four forms, one vowel: उ and ऊ when it stands alone, the short and long marks when a consonant carries it. That symmetry is the whole vowel system of this script, and you now write all of it.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at ऊ for five seconds, cover it, and write it once. Uncover and set the four *u* forms in a row: उ ऊ and the two marks. Repair only one.

Before you move on

How many written forms does this one vowel have? (**Four.**)
Source: Saurmandal, Devanagari uu stroke order.

8.6 ए — the vowel that opens *ek*

One vowel left, and you have been reading it since the chapter where you learned to count.

Script

ए

ए is the independent long *e* — the same vowel as the [॑] mark you write above the headline, given its own letter for the start of a word.

It opens एक, *ek*, “one”. That word has been printed beside its romanization since the counting chapter, which means you have been looking at this letter for a long time without being told what it was. Draw the left hook, the upright, and the headline; the mark version is what remains if you take the letter away and keep only the top.

Writing — guided copy

Copy एक twice with the model visible, naming both signs: independent *e*, then *ka*. Then write the [॑] mark once on its own and say which of the two forms needs a consonant to lean on.

Before you move on

Which number word starts with ए? (*ek* — one.)

Source: Saurmandal, Devanagari e stroke order.

8.7 Twenty-four signs, at real distance

Four chapters ago the page was still full of shapes nobody had taught you. Close every model and find out what stayed.

Before you move on

Which *l* does Hindi not have? (The curled ऌ.) [PAUSE 2s] Which two sibilants are kept apart only in spelling? (*śa* and *ṣa*.)

[PAUSE 2s] How many written forms does the *u* vowel

have? (Four — two letters and two marks.) [PAUSE 2s]

Which number word opens with the independent *e*? (*ek*.)

[PAUSE 2s] Which letter ends every infinitive? (*na*.) [PAUSE 2s]

Which nasal mark wears a crescent? (The candrabindu.)

[PAUSE 2s] Which sign did *mājhe* need? (*jha*.)

And one from the chapter before: *ba* with the voice switched off? (*pa*, which is *ba* without the inner dot.)

Chapter 9

Introducing Yourself

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 9 of 10 lessons.

Now a first real exchange — giving your name, asking for someone else’s, and saying you are glad to meet them:

माझं नाव मीरा आहे. (*mājhṃ nāv Mīrā āhe* — “My name is Mira.”)
तुमचं नाव काय आहे? (*tumchṃ nāv kāy āhe* — “What is your name?”)

9.1 नाव (*nāv*) — “name,” a word older than Europe

The letters in this word

ना (*nā*) + व (*va*) → नाव *nāv*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाव (*nāv*) ← Sanskrit नामन् (*nāman*, “name”). Watch the small Marathi shift: the Sanskrit *-m-* softened to *-v-*, so *nām* became **nāv** (Hindi kept the *m*: *nām*). That *nāman* goes back to PIE **h₃nómn*. — the same root as English **name** and **noun**, Latin *nōmen*, Greek *onoma*. A cousin from before either language existed.

Grammar Lens

A Marathi habit: soft consonants. *m*→*v* here is one of many softenings that distinguish Marathi from Hindi. Spot the shift and a Sanskrit word reads straight into Marathi.

9.2 माझं (*mājhṇ*) — “my,” and gender again

The letters in this word

मा (*mā*) + झं (*jha* with the *anusvāra* ँ) → *mājhṇ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माझं (*mājhṇ*, “my”) sits on the first-person root *ma-* — the same root behind English **me**, **my**, **mine**, Latin *meus*, Hindi *merā*.

Grammar Lens

“My” agrees in three genders. माझा (*mājhā*, m.) / माझी (*mājhī*, f.) / माझं (*mājhṇ*, n.). The noun *nāv* (“name”) is **neuter**, so “my name” is *mājhṇ nāv*. You met this gender idea already in the goodbye *yeto/yete*; it runs through the whole language.

9.3 आहे (*āhe*) — “is,” and it comes last

The letters in this word

आ (*ā*, the standalone long-*ā* vowel) + हे (*he*) → आहे *āhe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आहे (*āhe*, “is”) descends from Sanskrit अस्ति (*ásti*), on the root $\sqrt{\text{as}}$ (“to be”). That $\sqrt{\text{as}}$ / PIE $*h_1es-$ is the ancestor of Latin *est*, German *ist*, and English **is** itself — the oldest verb in the family, worn to *āhe* in Marathi.

Grammar Lens

The verb goes last. Marathi is subject–object–verb: “my name Mira *is*.” *āhe* sits at the end, and it changes with the subject — *mī āhe* (I am), *tū āhes* (you are), *tumhī āhāt* (you are, resp.), which you will use in the next chapter.

9.4 माझं नाव ...आहे — “my name is...”

माझं (my) + नाव (name) + आहे (is) = “my name is...” *Mājhm̐ nāv* *Arun āhe*. The *mājhm̐* is neuter to agree with *nāv*; the verb comes last.

9.5 तू / तुम्ही (*tū* / *tumhī*) — “you,” familiar and respectful

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तू (*tū*, familiar “you”) ← Sanskrit त्वम् (*tvam*), PIE **tū* — the root of English archaic **thou**, Latin *tū*, French *tu*, Hindi *tū*. तुम्ही (*tumhī*, respectful) is grammatically **plural** — honouring one person as many, exactly like French *vous*; it takes the plural copula *āhāt*.

Grammar Lens

A choice of respect, every time. *tū* for a friend or child; *tumhī* for an elder, a stranger, anyone you show courtesy to. Marathi makes you pick with each address.

9.6 काय (*kāy*) — “what”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काय (*kāy*, “what”) grows from the interrogative stem *ka-*, PIE **k^wo-* — the root behind English **wh-** words and Latin *qu-*. Marathi keeps the *k-* plainly across its questions: *kāy* (what), *koṇ* (who), *kuṭhe* (where), *kā* (why), *kaśm̐* (how). Hear that opening *k-* and a question is coming.

9.7 तुमचं नाव काय आहे? — “what’s your name?”

तुमचं (*tumchm̐*, “your,” neuter to match *nāv*) + नाव + काय (what) + आहे (is) = “your name what is?”, verb last. The “your” set mirrors the “my” set: *mājhm̐* (my) / *tumchm̐* (your, resp.) / *tujhm̐* (your, familiar) — all neuter here before *nāv*. To a friend: तुझं नाव काय आहे? (*tujhm̐ nāv kāy āhe?*).

9.8 भेटून आनंद झाला (*bheṭūn ānand jhālā*) — “a joy to meet you”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The warm close is भेटून आनंद झाला — literally “having met [you], joy happened.” आनंद (*ānand*, “joy, bliss”) is **Sanskrit** — *ā-* (“fully”) + *nand* (“to rejoice”) — the *ānanda* of *sat-cit-ānanda* and a common given name. And *bheṭūn* is built on भेटणे (*bheṭṇe*, “to meet”), the verb behind Chapter 4’s *punhā bheṭū*.

9.9 The whole exchange

Marathi	Say it	English
माझं नाव मीरा आहे.	<i>mājhami nāv Mīrā āhe.</i>	My name is Mira.
तुमचं नाव काय आहे?	<i>tumcham nāv kāy āhe?</i>	What’s your name?
माझं नाव अरुण आहे.	<i>mājhami nāv Aruṇ āhe.</i>	My name is Arun.
भेटून आनंद झाला.	<i>bheṭūn ānand jhālā.</i>	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom traced: *nāv* ($\rightarrow$ *name*), *mājham* ($\rightarrow$ *my*), *kāy* ($\rightarrow$ *what*), *tū* ($\rightarrow$ *thou*). And two Marathi distinctives came back: three genders (on *mājham*) and the verb *āhe* going **last**. Next chapter: *tumhī kase āhāt?* (“how are you?”).

9.10 The last six signs, one chapter on

No new language and nothing to look at. The six signs that closed the second runway are asked for cold, a chapter after you learned them — the first real retrieval of the set.

Your turn

Answer aloud, with the page shut:

1. which *l* does Marathi keep that Hindi does not? (the curled one, ऌ)
2. which two sibilants are told apart only in spelling? (*śa* and *ṣa*)
3. which vowel opens the word for “one”? (*e*, in *ek*)

4. how many written forms does the *u* vowel have? (four — two letters and two marks)

Repair one group only. This is the first retrieval, not the last: the same six come back at a durable gap in Chapter 13 and at book distance in Chapter 22.

Chapter 10

How Are You?

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

The everyday exchange after hello:

तुम्ही कसे आहात? (*tumhī kase āhāt* — “How are you?”)
मी बरा आहे, धन्यवाद. (*mī barā āhe, dhanyavād* — “I’m well, thank you.”)

10.1 कसा / कशी / कसं (*kasā / kaśī / kaṣṇ*) — “how”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कसा (*kasā*, “how”) is another *k-* question, from PIE **k^wo-* — the root behind English **how** (a *wh-* word that lost its *w*) and Latin *quo-modo* (“in what way,” → Spanish *cómo*).

Grammar Lens

“How” agrees with whom you ask. कसा (*kasā*, to a man) / कशी (*kaśī*, to a woman) / कसं (*kaṣṇ*, neuter). So “how are you?” shifts shape with the person addressed.

10.2 तुम्ही कसे आहात? — “how are you?”

तुम्ही (*tumhī*, resp. “you”) + कसे (*kase*, “how,” plural-agreeing) + आहात (*āhāt*, “are,” resp.) = “you how are?”, verb last. Because *tumhī* is grammatically plural, “how” appears as *kase* and the copula as *āhāt*. To a male friend: तू कसा आहेस? (*tū kasā āhes?*); to a female friend: तू कशी आहेस? (*tū kaśī āhes?*).

10.3 मी (*mī*) — “I”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मी (*mī*, “I”) descends from Sanskrit अहम् (*aham*), worn down to *mī*. That *aham* is PIE **h₁eg(H)om* — the ancestor of Latin **ego** and English **I**. Note its family tie to last chapter’s *mājhm* (“my”): the same first-person *m*- thread, as English pairs *I* with *me/my*.

Grammar Lens

“I am” is *mī āhe*. And “I’m fine” reaches back to Chapter 1’s *barṃ* in its gendered form: *mī barā āhe* (a man) / *mī barī āhe* (a woman).

10.4 मी बरा आहे — “I’m well, thank you”

मी (I) + बरा (*barā*, “well”) + आहे (am) = “I am well.” Chapter 1’s बरं (*barṃ*) was the bare **neuter** “okay”; describing a person it takes their gender: *barā* (m.) / *barī* (f.). Add thanks: *mī barā āhe*, *dhanyavād*.

Grammar Lens

The copula changes with the subject. *mī āhe* (I am), *tū āhes* (you are), *tumhī āhāt* (you are, resp.) — one verb, reshaped for each person. Marathi marks *who* on the verb itself.

10.5 काही हरकत नाही (*kāhī harkat nāhī*) — “no problem”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काही (*kāhī*, “any”) + हरकत (*harkat*, “objection”) + नाही (*nāhī*, “not”) = “[there is] no objection at all” — Marathi’s easy “you’re welcome / no problem.” Two histories meet: *nāhī* rides PIE **ne* (English **no**, **not**), while *harkat* is a **Perso-Arabic** loan (Arabic *ḥarakah*) — one of the many Persian and Arabic words Marathi absorbed under the Deccan sultanates. An Indo-European negative wrapped around an Arabic noun.

10.6 The whole exchange

Marathi	Say it	English
तुम्ही कसे आहात?	<i>tumhī kase āhāt?</i>	How are you?
मी बरा आहे, धन्यवाद.	<i>mī barā āhe, dhanyavād.</i>	I'm well, thank you.
काही हरकत नाही.	<i>kāhī harkat nāhī.</i>	No problem / you're welcome.

Roots banked: *kasā* (the *k*- questions, gender-agreeing), *mī* (*aham* → Latin *ego*, English *I*), *barā/barī* (now gendered), *harkat* (Arabic, the Deccan trade-and-court layer). Next chapter: the farewells — *punhā bhetū*.

Chapter 11

Farewells

Modes: ⇐ voice (2) 👁 eyes (4) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

Chapter 1 gave you the quick येतो (*yeto*, “I’ll come again”). Its explicit companion:

पुन्हा भेटू! (*punhā bheṭū* — “We’ll meet again!”)

11.1 पुन्हा (*punhā*) — “again”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुन्हा (*punhā*, “again, back”) is from Sanskrit पुनर् (*punar*, “again”), a cousin of Latin *re-* (“back/again”) and the *puna-* of *punarjanma* (“rebirth”). To say a thing *punhā* is to send it round once more.

11.2 भेटू (*bheṭū*) — “(we’ll) meet”

The letters in this word

भे (*bhe*) + टू (*tū*, the retroflex ट *ṭa* with the long-*u*) → *bheṭū*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भेटू (*bheṭū*) is a form of भेटणे (*bheṭṇe*, “to meet”), a native Marathi verb (the stem *bheṭ-* also gives *bheṭ*, “a meeting”). As *bheṭū* it means “let’s / we’ll meet” — the hopeful mood a goodbye wants.

Grammar Lens

“We” lives in the verb. *bheṭū* carries its own “we/let’s” in the *-ū* ending — no separate word for “we” needed. Unlike the present (*yeto/yete*), this future-wish form does *not* split by gender.

11.3 पुन्हा भेटू — “see you again”

पुन्हा (again) + भेटू (we’ll meet) = “**we’ll meet again**” — the explicit twin of Chapter 1’s *yeto*. Stack them for warmth: येतो, पुन्हा भेटू (*yeto, punhā bheṭū*). Neither word says “goodbye”; the parting is all return (Hindi *phir milenge*, Bengali *āshi*, Tamil *pōy varugirēṇ*).

11.4 उद्या भेटू (*udyā bheṭū*) — “see you tomorrow”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उद्या (*udyā*, “tomorrow”) + भेटू (we’ll meet) = “we’ll meet tomorrow.” Unlike Hindi *kal* (which means *both* tomorrow and yesterday), Marathi keeps them apart: *udyā* (tomorrow) vs. काल (*kāl*, yesterday). The verb carries the future; the first word sets the day.

11.5 काळजी घ्या (*kālǰī ghyā*) — “take care”

The letters in this word

काळजी carries ळ (*la*), the **retroflex “l”** Marathi keeps (Hindi dropped it): का+ळ+जी → *kālǰī*. Then घ्या (*ghyā*, “take,” resp.).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काळजी (*kālǰī*, “care, concern”) + घ्या (*ghyā*, “take”) = “take care.” Where *punhā bheṭū* looks to the next meeting, this looks after the person in between — “mind yourself until then.” The respectful घ्या (*ghyā*) matches *tumhā*; to a friend, काळजी घे (*kālǰī ghe*), matching *tū*.

11.6 The farewells

Marathi	Say it	English
येतो / येते.	<i>yeto / yete.</i>	I'll be going. (“come again”)
पुन्हा भेटू.	<i>punhā bheṭū.</i>	See you again.
उद्या भेटू.	<i>udyā bheṭū.</i>	See you tomorrow.
काळजी घ्या.	<i>kāljī ghyā.</i>	Take care.

Roots banked: *punhā* (*punar* “again”), *bheṭṇe* (“to meet”; “we” in the ending), *udyā* (tomorrow, kept apart from *kāl* yesterday), *kāljī* (the retroflex ञ). Every Marathi goodbye is a **return** or a caring wish — never a bare “farewell.” Next chapter: the first real verbs — *mī marāṭhī bolto*.

Chapter 12

The First Verbs

Modes: ⇐ voice (2) 👁 eyes (3) ⇐ **Hands-free start:** first 2 of 5 lessons.

Until now, verbs of *being* and *meeting*. Now verbs that *act* — and sentences that move:

मी मराठी बोलतो. (*mī marāṭhī bolto* — “I speak Marathi.”)

12.1 बोलणे (*bolṇe*) — “to speak,” your first full verb

The letters in this word

बो (*bo*) + ल (*la*) + णे (*ṇe*, the **retroflex** ण *ṇa*) → *bolṇe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोलणे (*bolṇe*, “to speak”) is a native Indo-Aryan verb on the stem *bol-* (the same *bol-* as Hindi *bolnā*, Punjabi *bolṇā*). Its ending -णे (*-ṇe*) is Marathi’s **infinitive**: *bol-ṇe* “to speak,” *bheṭ-ṇe* “to meet,” *ye-ṇe* “to come.” Strip *-ṇe* for the stem (*bol-*).

Grammar Lens

Stem + gendered present ending. *mī bolto* (a man speaks) / *mī bolte* (a woman speaks) — the present tense splits by the speaker’s gender, as *yeto/yete* did. And it needs **no** separate “am”: the one word does the work, at the end of the sentence.

12.2 मी मराठी बोलतो — “I speak Marathi”

मी (I) + मराठी (*marāṭhī*, the object) + बोलतो (speak) — “I Marathi speak,” verb last (a woman: *mī marāṭhī bolte*). The name मराठी is “[the language] of महाराष्ट्र (*Mahārāṣṭra*)” — the “great realm,” *mahā* (“great,” cousin of Latin *magnus*, English *magnitude*) + *rāṣṭra* (“nation”). People *Marāṭhā*, land *Mahārāṣṭra*, tongue *marāṭhī* — one root.

12.3 राहणे (*rāhṇe*) — “to live, to stay”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राहणे (*rāhṇe*, “to live, remain”) is from Sanskrit *rah-* (“to remain,” the same root as Hindi *rahnā*): *mī puṇyāt rāhto* (“I live in Pune”).

Grammar Lens

“In” comes after the noun. पुण्यात (*puṇyāt*) = पुणे (*Puṇe*, the city) + *-āt* (“in”), glued to the noun’s *end*. Marathi uses **postpositions**, verb last.

12.4 काम करणे (*kām karṇe*) — “to work”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

करणे (*karṇe*, “to do, make”) is from Sanskrit $\sqrt{kr}$ (“to do”), PIE $*k^{av}er-$ — the very root inside Chapter 1’s नमस्कार (*namaskār* = “the *making* of a bow”) and कर्म (*karma*, “a thing *done*”). And काम (*kām*, “work”) is itself worn down from that *karma*. Marathi builds compounds as **noun** + करणे: काम करणे (*kām karṇe*, “work-do” = “to work”), *madat karṇe* (“to help”). Present, gendered: *mī kām karto/karte* (“I work”).

12.5 Sentences about yourself

Marathi	Say it	English
मी मराठी बोलतो / बोलते.	<i>mī marāṭhī bolto / bolte.</i>	I speak Marathi.
मी पुण्यात राहतो / राहते.	<i>mī puṇyāt rāhto / rāhte.</i>	I live in Pune.
मी काम करतो / करते.	<i>mī kām karto / karte.</i>	I work.

One engine: an infinitive in *-ṇe*; a present of stem + a **gendered** ending (*-to* m. / *-te* f.) that folds in the “am”; the verb last; “in” on the noun’s tail. Roots banked: *bolṇe* (native), *marāṭhī* (← *Mahārāṣṭra* “great realm”), *rāhṇe* (*rah-* “remain”), *karṇe* ($\sqrt{kr}$ — root of *namaskār*, *karma*; *kām* ← *karma*). From here, Marathi only opens further.

Chapter 13

Numbers One to Five

Modes: 🗣️ voice (9) 👁️ eyes (1) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 6 of 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count from one to five in Marathi, say चार as tsār rather than chār, and tell which of Marathi's differences from Hindi is an innovation and which is Hindi holding on to something older.

Account for all three tells: दोन's final *n* copied from the rhyme of तिन्नी/donni, पाच dropping the nasal Hindi पाँच still writes, and चार spelled as everywhere else but pronounced with a *ts*.

13.1 Three signs after a durable gap

Close the earlier script pages and keep one blank line ready.

Before you move on

Cover the answer. Write *dhanyavād*, then the two-dot breath sign, independent long *ā*, and breathy *bha* from their spoken names. Compare: धन्यवाद; ॥ आ भ. Stop after one retrieval and one repair.

13.2 Three more signs after a durable gap

Close the earlier script pages and keep one blank line ready.

Before you move on

Cover the answer. Write the e-mark, one-dot anusvāra, and dental *ta* from their spoken names. Then compare: ऐ ँ त. Stop after one retrieval and one repair.

13.3 Keep three voiced consonants apart

Close the earlier script pages and keep one blank line ready.

Before you move on

Cover the answer. Write dental *da*, breathy *dha*, and quiet *ba* from sound. Then compare: द ध ब. Stop after one retrieval and one repair.

13.4 The final three doorway signs

Close the earlier script pages and keep one blank line ready.

Before you move on

Cover the answer. Write *ya*, Marathi curled-back *la*, and *va* from sound. Then compare: य ळ व. Stop after one retrieval and one repair.

13.5 एक, दोन, तीन, चार, पाच — one to five

Marathi and Hindi both use Devanagari and both descend from Sanskrit, so their numbers look almost identical. **Almost** is where the interest is.

You'll want to know: the five

	Marathi	said
1	एक	<i>ek</i>
2	दोन	<i>don</i>
3	तीन	<i>tīn</i>
4	चार	<i>chār</i> — but see below
5	पाच	<i>pāch</i>

What you've built: three Marathi tells

Set them against Hindi. Two differences are visible and one is audible:

number	Hindi	Marathi
2	दो <i>do</i>	दोन <i>don</i> : final <i>n</i>
5	पाँच <i>pāñch</i>	पाच <i>pāch</i> : no nasal mark
4	चार <i>chār</i>	चार <i>tsār</i> : same spelling, different sound

Do not explain all three histories yet. First make the five forms automatic; the next lesson earns the deeper comparison.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ek, don, tīn, tsār, pāch”
- the visible tells — *don* has *n*; *pāch* has no nasal mark
- the audible tell — written *chār*, Marathi *tsār*

Before you move on

Count to five in Marathi. (*Ek, don, tīn, tsār, pāch.*) Where does Marathi add a letter compared with Hindi? (दोन, *don.*) Which form drops a nasal mark? (पाच, *pāch.*) What differs in चार without differing in spelling? (Marathi's च is nearer **ts** before *ā*.) Next: explain where those differences came from.

13.6 Why Marathi *two* rhymes with *three*

Count once: *ek*, *don*, *tīn*, *tsār*, *pāch*. Which two words end in *n*? (*Don* and *tīn*.)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The tempting guess is that Marathi दोन *don* kept something Hindi दो *do* lost. It did not.

Sanskrit's neuter word for three, त्रीणि *trīṇi*, became Prakrit तिन्नि *tiṇṇi*. In *three*, the *ṇ* genuinely belongs to the word. The doubled consonant is a Prakrit trade for the lost *r*.

The word for two was then reshaped to match its neighbour: Prakrit दोन्नि *doṇṇi* copied the shape of तिन्नि *tiṇṇi*. Marathi *don*'s final *n* is therefore an **innovation**, a rhyme borrowed from the number next door. Hindi *do* simply never took it.

English numbers did this too: *four* acquired its initial *f*- by analogy with *five*. Familiar sequences pull neighbouring words toward one another.

What you've built: पाच and the nasal Hindi kept

Marathi पाच *pāch* and Hindi पाँच *pāñch* tell the opposite story. Hindi's chandrabindu ँ records the nasal of Sanskrit पाञ्च *pañca*; Marathi's spelling drops it.

So neither language is simply “older.” Marathi innovated in *don*, while Hindi retained an older feature in *pāñch*. Comparing both descendants reveals the history that either one alone could hide.

The letters in this word

Both write चार, but Marathi pronounces च before *ā* nearer **ts**: *tsār*. The letters stayed aligned while the sound moved.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the borrowed rhyme — तिन्नि ... दोन्नि
- innovation — Marathi *don*'s final *n*
- retention — Hindi *pāñch*'s nasal

- same spelling, shifted sound — *chār* / *tsār*

Before you move on

Did Marathi *don* preserve an ancient ending? (No: *two* copied *three*.) Which language retains Sanskrit *pañca*'s nasal in writing? (Hindi.) Why can neither daughter be called simply older? (Each changed or retained a different feature.) What does Marathi change without respelling चार? (*Ch* shifts toward *ts* before *ā*.)

13.7 The six marks, with the page shut

Nothing to look at. Every answer here is a place on an imaginary line: before the letter, above it, or under it.

Before you move on

Which mark is written before the letter it is read after? (**Short *i*.**) [PAUSE 2s] Which two hang below the line? (**Short *u* and long *ū*.**) [PAUSE 2s] Which curl opens the other way from short *u*? (**The vocalic *r*.**) [PAUSE 2s] Which nasal mark sits in a crescent? (**The candrabindu.**) And which vowel needs no mark at all, because every consonant already carries it? (**Short *a*.**)

13.8 Two rows, rebuilt from two questions

You do not need to remember seven letters. You need to remember two questions and the order they come in.

Before you move on

Back of the mouth, four steps. (*ka, kha, ga, gha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Roof of the mouth, the same four. (*ca, cha, ja, jha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which of the eight has both the voice and the breath at the palate? (*jha.*) And which one does Marathi also say as *ts*? (*ca.*)

13.9 The curled row, without a model

One question decides all five: where is the tongue, and is it doing anything different from the dental row you learned first?

Before you move on

Tongue curled back: plain, breathy, voiced, nasal. (*ṭa*, *ṭha*, *ḍa*, *ṇa*.) [PAUSE 2s] Which of them ends every infinitive you have learned? (*ṇa*.) [PAUSE 2s] Lips closed, voice off, one dot fewer than *ba*. (*pa*.)

13.10 The last six, without a model

Two letters your mouth keeps apart, two it no longer does, and three vowels that come in more than one shape.

Before you move on

Which *l* does Hindi not have? (**The curled one.**) [PAUSE 2s] Which two sibilants are kept apart only in spelling? (*śa* and *ṣa*.) [PAUSE 2s] How many written forms does the *u* vowel have? (**Four.**) [PAUSE 2s] And which vowel opens the word for one? (*e*.)

Chapter 14

The Core Verbs

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can use six everyday Marathi verbs, pick the present-tense ending that agrees with my subject’s gender, end every sentence on the verb, and say that I know something the way Marathi says it — with the knower in the dative and आहे closing the line.

Say मला माहीत आहे and मला मराठी येते unprompted: the knower in the dative, the verb agreeing with its own subject rather than with the speaker, and आहे closing the sentence — the whole chapter’s machinery in two lines.

14.1 असणे (asṇe) — “to be,” and the word your sentence ends on

You have already said it: *mājhami nāv ... āhe*. Now meet the verb that form belongs to, and notice where Marathi insists on putting it.

You’ll want to know: असणे and its present आहे

असणे — *asṇe* — to be

The ending -णे (-ṇe) is the Marathi infinitive, the same ending as *bolṇe* “to speak.” Its present tense is short, irregular, and already yours: आहे (*āhe*) — “am, is, are.”

who	Marathi	said
मी (I)	आहे	<i>āhe</i>
तू (you, familiar)	आहेस	<i>āhes</i>
तुम्ही (you, respectful)	आहात	<i>āhāt</i>

The letters in this word

अ is the bare vowel *a*; स is *sa*; णे is the retroflex ण *ṇa* carrying the *-e* stroke — *a-sa-ṇe*. आ is that first letter with an upright stroke added, the long *ā*. हे is ह *ha* with the same *-e* stroke: *ā-he*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sanskrit's word for “is” was अस्ति *ásti*, sitting on the stem *as-*, and that stem goes back to the Indo-European root **h₁es-*. It surfaces almost everywhere the family reaches: Latin *est*, Greek *estí*, German *ist*, and English **is**. *Asṇe* is built straight on it.

आहे itself is the contested piece. Some trace it to *ásti* directly; others route it through a Middle Indo-Aryan verb *acchai* “stays, remains.”

The family is not in doubt, the exact line of descent is — so treat it as an open question rather than a settled fact.

Grammar Lens: the sentence ends on आहे

English slots *is* into the middle of a sentence: “My name **is** Sara.”

Marathi holds it back to the very end:

माझं नाव सारा आहे — *mājhami nāv Sārā āhe* — piece by piece, “my name Sara is.”

That is the rule for every Marathi verb, and *āhe* is where it becomes unmissable. Whatever else the sentence carries, the verb closes it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “asṇe” — to be — then its present, “āhe”
- the three persons — “mī āhe ... tū āhes ... tumhī āhāt”
- your own name in Marathi order — “mājhami nāv ... āhe”

Before you move on

What is the infinitive behind *āhe*? (असणे, *asṇe*.) Where does a Marathi verb stand? (**Last** — the sentence closes on it.) Which everyday English word is *ásti*’s own cousin? (**Is**.) Next: a verb that changes shape according to who is speaking.

14.2 जाणे (jāṇe) — “to go,” and a present tense that gives you away

Say “my name is ...” once more, and hear where *āhe* lands. Every verb from here obeys that same rule. This one adds a second rule English has no use for.

You’ll want to know: जाणे

जाणे — *jāṇe* — to go

Strip the infinitive ending -णे and the stem is जा- *jā-*. On that stem Marathi builds the everyday present: जातो (*jāto*) and जाते (*jāte*).

Both mean “I go.” Neither is more correct than the other. Which one you may say is decided by something the English sentence never mentions.

The letters in this word

ज is *ja*, and the upright stroke after it is the long *ā* — together जा *jā*.
णे you met last lesson: retroflex ण with the -*e* stroke. Two syllables, *jā-ṇe*, with the tongue curled back for that second one.

Grammar Lens: the ending declares who is speaking

English “I go” hides the speaker completely — a man and a woman say the same two words. Marathi will not let you:

speaking of	Marathi	said
a man, of himself	मी जातो	<i>mī jāto</i>
a woman, of herself	मी जाते	<i>mī jāte</i>
a man, “he goes”	तो जातो	<i>to jāto</i>
a woman, “she goes”	ती जाते	<i>tī jāte</i>

The -तो / -ते swap is the whole mechanism, and it runs through every

verb: *bolto* / *bolte*, *yetto* / *yete*. Hindi marks gender on its verbs too, but Marathi makes it unavoidable in the plainest sentence a beginner can build. From your first “I go,” you are choosing. Notice also what is missing: no separate word for “am.” The ending carries the action, the person, and the gender at once.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “jāṇe” — to go — then the stem, “jā-”
- “I go” in your own gender — “mī jāto” or “mī jāte”
- the pair — “to jāto ... tī jāte”

Before you move on

What is the stem inside *jāṇe*? (जा-, *jā-*.) Which two endings split the present, and by what? (-तो / -ते, by the gender of the one the verb is about.) Can a Marathi speaker say “I go” without revealing it? (No — the choice is forced.) Next: the same ancient root, pointed the other way.

14.3 येणे (yeṇe) — “to come,” the other half of “to go”

Say “I go” in your own gender: *mī jāto* or *mī jāte*. Hold that shape. The next verb is closer to it than it sounds.

You’ll want to know: येणे

येणे — *yeṇe* — to come

Same infinitive ending, same machinery: stem ये- *ye-*, present येतो (*yeto*) and येते (*yete*), split by gender exactly as *jāto* / *jāte* was.

You met *yeto* in Chapter 4 as a farewell — Marathi takes its leave by saying “I come,” promising the return rather than announcing the departure.

The letters in this word

य is *ya*, a soft English *y* as in *yes*. Add the *-e* stroke above and you have ये *ye* — the same stroke you have been putting on णे and on हे in *āhe*. Two syllables: *ye-ṇe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sanskrit had a verb of travelling, **yā-**, whose present was याति *yāti* “goes, travels.” Middle Indo-Aryan turned that initial *y-* into a *j-*, giving Prakrit *jāi* — and that is Marathi जाणे.

Now put a prefix on it. Sanskrit आ- *ā-* means “toward, hither,” and आयाति *āyāti* is “travels toward here” — that is, **comes**. Worn down through the same centuries, *āyāti* is Marathi येणे.

So *going* and *coming* are not two verbs in this family. They are one verb of travelling, and the only difference is a prefix meaning “this way.” English keeps a faint echo of the same trick in *go* against *in-coming*, but it needs two separate roots to do what Sanskrit did with one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “yeṇe” — to come — then the stem, “ye-”
- “I come” in your own gender — “mī yeto” or “mī yete”
- the derivation — “yāti ... āyāti ... yeṇe”

Before you move on

What is the stem of *yeṇe*? (ये-, *ye-*.) Which Sanskrit root do *jāṇe* and *yeṇe* share? (**yā-**, to travel.) What single piece turns going into coming? (The prefix आ- *ā-*, “toward here.”) Next: an infinitive that is also a noun, and the gender Hindi does not have.

14.4 खाणे (khāṇe) — “to eat,” and Marathi’s third gender

Two infinitives so far: *jāṇe*, *yeṇe*. Say them. This third one is ordinary as a verb and quietly remarkable as a noun.

You'll want to know: खाणे

खाणे — *khāṇe* — to eat

Stem खा- *khā-*, present खातो (*khāto*) and खाते (*khāte*) on the gendered pattern you already have.

Its root is Sanskrit खादति *khādati*, “chews, eats” — a solidly Indo-Aryan word with no borrowing in its history. The *-d-* wore away on the road to Marathi; the long *ā* stayed.

The letters in this word

ख is *kha* — a *k* with a genuine puff of breath after it, the sound in English *kit* said hard, not the *k* of *skit*. Marathi treats that puff as a different letter, not an accent. Add the long-*ā* stroke and the familiar णे: *khā-ṇe*.

Grammar Lens: the infinitive is a neuter noun

खाणे also simply means “eating” — the thing, not the act of doing it. Every -णे infinitive works this way; खाणपिणं (*khāṇam-piṇam*), “eating and drinking,” is how Marathi says food and drink.

And as a noun it carries a gender — **neuter**, the third one. Hindi has two genders, masculine and feminine. Marathi kept all three that Sanskrit had, so words agreeing with a noun come in three shapes:

gender	“good”	said
masculine	चांगला	<i>chāṅglā</i>
feminine	चांगली	<i>chāṅglī</i>
neuter	चांगलं	<i>chāṅglam</i>

So “eating is good” is खाणं चांगलं आहे — *khāṇam chāṅglam āhe*, with the neuter ending twice over and the verb, as always, last.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “khāṇe” — to eat — then “I eat” in your own gender
- the three shapes — “chāṅglā ... chāṅglī ... chāṅglam”
- “eating is good” — “khāṇam chāṅglam āhe”

Before you move on

What are the two things खाणे means? (**To eat**, and **eating** as a noun.) How many genders does Marathi have, and how many does Hindi have? (**Three** against **two** — Marathi kept Sanskrit's neuter.) Which gender is an infinitive? (**Neuter**.) Next: a verb whose root you already own in a dozen English words.

14.5 पाहणे (pāhṇe) — “to see,” a root you already own

Say “I eat” in your own gender — *mī khāto* or *mī khāte*. The next verb runs on the same endings, and on a root you have been using in English all your life without knowing it.

You'll want to know: पाहणे

पाहणे — *pāhṇe* — **to see, to watch**

Stem पाह- *pāh-*, present पाहतो (*pāhto*) and पाहते (*pāhte*). In everyday speech you will also hear बघणे (*baghṇe*) for the same job; *pāhṇe* is the one whose history repays digging.

The letters in this word

प is *pa* without the puff of breath that *kha* had. Add the upright stroke for long *ā*: पा *pā*. Then ह *ha*, and the णे you now know by heart. Three light syllables, *pā-ha-ṇe*, usually spoken as two: *pāh-ṇe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sanskrit's verb for seeing was पश्यति *paśyati*, on the root *paś-*, and Marathi's *pāhṇe* descends from its prefixed form प्रपश्यति *prapaśyati*, “looks out at.”

Now the payoff. That *paś-* is the Indo-European root ***spek-**, “to observe.” Sanskrit dropped the *s-* and swapped the consonants around; Latin kept them in order as *speciō*, “I look.” From the Latin side English inherited an enormous family, every one of them a cousin of *pāhṇe*:

spectacle, inspect, respect, suspect, prospect, species, specimen,

speculate, telescope, and — through Italian — spy.

So a Marathi speaker asking you to *pāhṇe* something is asking you to *inspect* it, in the most literal ancestral sense the word has.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*pāhṇe*” — to see — then “I see” in your own gender
- the derivation — “*paśyati ... prapaśyati ... pāhṇe*”
- four English cousins — “spectacle, inspect, species, spy”

Before you move on

What is the stem of *pāhṇe*? (पाह्-, *pāh-*.) Which Sanskrit verb is it from? (पश्यति *paśyati*, in its prefixed form *prapaśyati*.) Name three English words from the same ancient root. (*Spectacle, inspect, species, spy* — any three.) Next: a verb Marathi mostly refuses to use, and what it says instead.

14.6 माहीत असणे (māhīt asṇe) — “to know,” which Marathi says sideways

Say “I go” and “I come” in your own gender — *jāto* or *jāte*, *yetō* or *yete*. Five verbs obeyed that pattern. This one refuses.

You’ll want to know: माहीत असणे and जाणणे

माहीत असणे — *māhīt asṇe* — **to know** (everyday)

जाणणे — *jāṇṇe* — **to know** (formal, literary)

Marathi has an inherited verb for knowing and barely uses it. Everyday speech says *māhīt asṇe*, “to be known,” built on *asṇe*.

The letters in this word

म is *ma*; with the long-*ā* stroke, मा. ही is ह *ha* with the long -*ī* stroke, which leans forward ahead of its letter. त is *ta*: *mā-hī-t*.

Grammar Lens: knowledge comes to you, you do not do it

मला माहीत आहे — *malā māhīt āhe* — “I know.”

Word by word: “**to me** known **is**.” *Malā* is “to me,” and the knower sits there, not in the subject slot. Nobody acts; a fact is simply in your possession, and *āhe* closes the line.

The same frame carries a language: मला मराठी येते — *malā marāṭhī yete* — “I know Marathi,” literally “to me Marathi comes.” *Yete* is feminine because the subject is मराठी, a feminine noun — not the speaker; a man says it too. The verb agrees with its subject, as always. Here the subject is not you.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माहीत is a **loan**: through Persian from Arabic *māhiyat*, “the particulars” — one of the administrative words the Deccan sultanates left in Marathi.

जाणणे is pure inheritance: Sanskrit जानाति *jānāti*, root *jñā-*, from Indo-European ***gnō-** — the root of English **know**, Latin *nōscere* (*notice, recognize*) and Greek *gnōsis* (*diagnosis*). Marathi kept the cousin and gave the daily work to the loan.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*malā māhīt āhe*” — then literally, “to me known is”
- “I know Marathi” — “*malā marāṭhī yete*”
- the inherited verb and its English cousin — “*jāṇṇe ... know*”

Before you move on

Where does Marathi put the knower? (**In the dative** — *malā*, “to me.”) Which verb finishes *malā māhīt āhe*, and where? (आहे, **last**.) Why *yetē* in *malā marāṭhī yete*? (The subject is मराठी, feminine — agreeing with it, not the speaker.) Which know-verb was borrowed? (माहीत, through Persian.)

Chapter 15

The Mind and the Page

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I think, understand, read and write in Marathi, put the understander in the dative where Marathi puts it, and name what each of the four roots meant before it meant a mental act — turning, waking, speaking and scratching.

Say मी माझं नाव लिहितो, run the chapter’s four verbs back with the four things their roots meant — vichār karṇe from a root meaning to turn, samajṇe from one meaning to wake, vāchṇe from one meaning to speak, lihṇe from one meaning to scratch — and pick out the one of the four that refuses मी and takes मला instead.

15.1 विचार करणे (vichār karṇe) — “to think,” which is a turning

Say “I see” in your own gender — *mī pāhto* or *mī pāhte* — and name one English word from that verb’s root. (*Spectacle, inspect, spy*: any of them.) Now the verb for what happens behind the eyes.

You’ll want to know: विचार करणे

विचार करणे — *vichār karṇe* — to think

Two words, not one. विचार *vichār* is a noun, “a thought”; करणे *karṇe* is “to do,” which has been yours since *kām karṇe*, “to work.” Marathi thinks by doing a thought.

The present runs on endings you already own: मी विचार करतो — *mī vichār karto*, a man speaking — and करते *karte*, a woman.

The letters in this word

विचार is वि (*vi* — व carrying the short-*i* stroke, which stands to the **left** of its letter), then चा (*chā*), then र (*ra*). करणे is क *ka*, र *ra*, णे *ṇe*.

The letters in this word

च before a long *ā* hides a sound change: Marathi says it nearer **ts**. So चार is *tsār*, and विचार is *vitsār* — spelling unchanged, mouth moved.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विचार is वि- *vi-* (“apart, thoroughly”) on the Sanskrit root चर् *car-*, “to move, to range about.” A thought is a **ranging over**. And *car-* comes from Indo-European ***k^welh₁-**, “to turn,” which surfaces as Greek *pélomai*, Latin *colō*, and — through a doubled form — English **wheel** and **cycle**. When English says you *turn something over* in your mind, that is the same picture, and विचार has it built into the root.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vichār karṇe” — to think — with the *ts*: *vitsār*
- “I think” in your own gender — “mī vichār karto” or “karte”
- the root and its English cousins — “car-, to turn ... wheel, cycle”

Before you move on

Which two words make “to think”? (विचार “a thought” and करणे “to do.”) What did the root inside विचार mean? (**To move, to turn** — the root behind **wheel**.) What gender is a -णे infinitive as a noun? (**Neuter**.) And why *vitsār*? (Marathi’s च leans toward **ts** before a long *ā*.)

15.2 समजणे (samajṇe) — “to understand,” which happens to you

Say “I think” — *mī vichār karto* or *karte*. Now say “I know” the way Marathi builds it. (मला माहीत आहे — *malā māhīt āhe*, “to me known is.”) Understanding takes that second shape, not the first.

You’ll want to know: समजणे

समजणे — *samajṇe* — to understand

मला मराठी समजते — *malā marāṭhī samajte* — “I understand Marathi.”
Piece by piece: “to me Marathi is-understood.”

The letters in this word

समजणे is four plain letters with nothing hanging off the first three: स *sa*, म *ma*, ज *ja*, then णे *ṇe*. Each consonant carries its own built-in *a*, which is why *sa-ma-ja* comes out of three letters.

Grammar Lens: three verbs, one frame

You now have two Marathi sentences built the same way, and they belong side by side:

Marathi	word for word
मला मराठी येते	to-me Marathi comes — I know Marathi
मला मराठी समजते	to-me Marathi is-understood — I understand Marathi

In both, you sit in the dative — *malā*, “to me” — and the verb agrees with मराठी, a feminine noun, which is why both end -ते whoever is speaking.

The first one is worth hearing literally: knowing a language is it **coming** to you, on येणे — the verb that is जाणे with आ- “toward here” fixed to the front. Understanding works the same way. Neither is something you do.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समजणे comes through Prakrit *sambujjhai* from Sanskrit सम्बुध्यते *sambudhyate*: सम् *sam*-, “together,” on the root बुध् *budh*-, “to wake up.” To understand is to come awake to something.

That root named a man: बुद्ध *buddha* is simply “the awakened one.” It is Indo-European *b^hewd^h-, which also gave Greek *punthánomai*, “to learn by asking,” and English **bid**. English keeps the picture in *it dawned on me*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “malā marāṭhī samajte” — hearing “to me,” not “I”
- its twin — “malā marāṭhī yete”
- the root and the man it named — “budh-, to wake ... buddha”

Before you move on

Where does Marathi put the understander? (**In the dative** — *malā*.) Why *samajte* and not *samajto*, even for a man? (It agrees with मराठी, feminine.) What did *budh*- mean before it meant understanding, and whom did it name? (**To wake** — and the **Buddha**.) Which two verbs beside this one take *malā*? (माहीत असणे and येणे, in *malā marāṭhī yete*.)

15.3 वाचणे (vāchṇe) — “to read,” which is making a page speak

Say “I understand Marathi” — *malā marāṭhī samajte*. And “I see” — *mī pāhto* or *pāhte*. This verb sits between the two: eyes first, meaning after.

You’ll want to know: वाचणे

वाचणे — *vāchṇe* — to read

मी मराठी वाचतो — *mī marāṭhī vāchto* — “I read Marathi,” and वाचते *vāchte* if a woman is speaking. This one takes an ordinary subject: मी. Reading is something you do.

The letters in this word

वा is व *va* with the upright long-*ā* stroke; च is *cha*; णे is the retroflex infinitive ending. Three letters, and you have met all three before — व in *nāv*, च in *chār*, णे on every verb in the last chapter.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वाचणे goes back to Sanskrit वाचयति *vācayati*, and *vācayati* is not its own verb — it is the root वच् *vac-*, “to speak,” with a gear changed: “to **make** speak.” Marathi reading is making the marks talk. That is not a poetic gloss; it is the grammar of the Sanskrit form.

वच् is Indo-European ***wek^w-**. Latin took it as *vōx*, “voice,” and *vocāre*, “to call,” and from that pair English has **voice**, **vocal**, **vocation**, **invoke** and **advocate**. Greek has *óps*, “voice.”

One honest footnote: Marathi also has a वाचणे meaning “to survive,” and it is a different word — from *vañcati*, “to escape.” Same spelling, unrelated history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mī marāṭhī vāchto” or “vāchte” — in your own gender
- the literal sense — “to make it speak”
- the cousins — “vāch- ... voice, vocal, invoke”
- the chapter’s three verbs so far — “vichār karṇe, samajṇe, vāchṇe”

Before you move on

What did वाचणे’s Sanskrit ancestor literally mean? (**To make speak** — reading as speaking aloud.) Name two English words from the same root. (**Voice, vocal, invoke, advocate**: any two.) Which of your verbs takes *mī* and which takes *malā* — *vāchṇe* or *samajṇe*? (*Vāchṇe* takes मी; *samajṇe* takes मला.)

15.4 लिहिणे (lihīṇe) — “to write,” which began as scratching

Three verbs and three roots: *vichār karṇe* on a root meaning **to turn**, *samajṇe* on one meaning **to wake**, *vāchṇe* on one meaning **to speak**. Say all three. The fourth root is the most physical of the lot.

You’ll want to know: लिहिणे

लिहिणे — *lihīṇe* — **to write**

मी माझं नाव लिहितो — *mī mājhami nāv lihito* — “I write my name,” and लिहिते *lihite* if a woman says it. The stem keeps its *i*: *lihi-*, not *lih-*.

The letters in this word

लि is ल *la* with the short-*i* stroke standing to its left; हि is ह *ha* with the same stroke; then णे. One stroke, used on two letters running: *li-hi-ṇe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लिहिणे comes through Prakrit *lihai* from Sanskrit लिखति *likhati*, and *likh-* meant **to scratch**, **to score** before it meant to write. Its plainest relative inside Sanskrit is रेखा *rekhā*, “a line, a scratch.”

Outside Indo-Aryan the cousins are genuinely disputed, and this lesson claims none. What is not disputed is that three families reached for the same picture: Latin *scribere* also meant **to scratch**, and stands behind **scribe** and **script**; English **write** began as Germanic “to tear, to score.”

Grammar Lens: what Marathi writes that Hindi does not

A lesson about writing is the place for two things Marathi writes its own way. Count to five: *ek*, *don*, *tīn*, *tsār*, *pāch*. दोन ends in a न that Hindi’s दो does not have. पाच has no nasal mark, where Hindi writes पाँच.

And लिहिणे is a noun as well as a verb — “writing,” the thing — because every -णे infinitive is, and every one of them is **neuter**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mī mājhami nāv lihito” or “lihite”
- the chapter’s four verbs — “vichār karṇe, samajṇe, vāchṇe, lihṇe”
- their four roots — “to turn, to wake, to speak, to scratch”

Before you move on

What did *likh-* mean first, and which two families named writing the same way? (**To scratch** — Latin *scribere*, English *write*.) Give the four verbs of this chapter and what their roots meant. (*Vichār karṇe* / turn, *samajṇe* / wake, *vāchṇe* / speak, *lihṇe* / scratch.) Which one refuses मी? (समजणे — it takes *malā*.) Which number does Marathi write with an extra न, and which with one mark fewer than Hindi? (दोन; पाच.)

Chapter 16

Taking, Asking, Helping, Liking

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can take, ask, help and say what I like and what I love in Marathi, build a fresh verb by putting **करणे** behind a noun, and say why **मला मराठी आवडते** has no room for me as its subject while **मी प्रेम करतो** does.

Say **मला मराठी आवडते** and hear that you are not its subject, set it against **मी प्रेम करतो** where you are, place both beside **मला मराठी येते** and **मला मराठी समजते** so one frame carries three meanings, and run the chapter's four verbs back with where each came from — Sanskrit **ग्रह्** beside English **grab**, **विचार** doing double duty as thought and question, Arabic **मदद** through Persian, and **आवडणे** with no Sanskrit ancestor to claim.

16.1 घेणे (ghēṇe) — “to take,” which you have been saying since Chapter 11

Say “to write” and “to read” — *lihīṇe*, *vāchṇe* — and what *lihīṇe*'s root meant before writing existed. (**To scratch.**) This next verb has been in your mouth since the farewells, unrecognised.

You'll want to know: घेणे

घेणे — *ghēṇe* — to take

काळजी घ्या — *kālji ghyā*, “take care” — is this verb. घ्या *ghyā* is its respectful command, घे *ghe* the familiar one you would use with तू. The plain present is मी घेतो *mī gheto* / घेते *ghete*.

Note the -त- that appears in the present but not the infinitive: *ghe-* on its own, *ghe-t-o* when conjugated. Marathi’s commonest verbs are the ones that bend.

The letters in this word

घ is *gha* — a *g* with a real puff of breath behind it, a separate letter from ग *ga*, exactly as ख *kha* is separate from क *ka*. Add the -e stroke over the top and the retroflex णे: *ghe-ṇe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घेणे comes through Prakrit *gahai* from the Sanskrit root ग्रह् *grah-*, “to seize, to grasp” — the root of ग्रहण *grahan*, an eclipse, which is the sky being seized.

Its older Vedic shape was ग्रभ् *grabh-*, and that **bh** is the piece worth holding on to: Indo-European **g^hreb^h*- kept its *bh* in Vedic and turned it into a *b* in Germanic, which is English **grab**. Marathi’s *gh-* is what four thousand years did to the same first consonant. *Grabh* and *grab* are the same word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ghene” — to take — then “mī gheto” or “ghete”
- the farewell it was hiding in — “kālji ghyā”
- the Vedic form and its English cousin — “grabh ... grab”

Before you move on

Which farewell has been using घेणे all along, and what does it literally say? (काळजी घ्या — “take care.”) Which English word is the same word as Vedic *grabh*? (**Grab**.) What gender is घेणे when it acts as a noun? (**Neuter**, like every -णे form.) Say “to write” and “to take” in one breath. (*Lihine, gheṇe*.)

16.2 विचारणे (vichārṇe) — “to ask,” built out of “a thought”

Say “to take” — *gheṇe*. Say “to think” — *vichār karṇe* — and what its root meant. (**To turn, to range about.**) Hold that word. The next verb is it, with four letters fewer.

You’ll want to know: विचारणे

विचारणे — *vichārṇe* — **to ask**

मी विचारतो — *mī vichārto* — “I ask,” विचारते *vichārte* if a woman speaks. And the same च rule holds: say it *vitsārto*, with the *ts* Marathi puts before a long *ā*.

The letters in this word

There is nothing new. विचारणे is विचार — the noun from the last chapter, letter for letter — with णे on the end. If you can write “a thought,” you can write “to ask.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Marathi builds both verbs on विचार:

Marathi	what it means
विचार करणे	to think — “to do a thought”
विचारणे	to ask — the thought made into a verb

Both sit on वि- plus चर् *car-*, “to move, to range.” Thinking is ranging over something privately; asking is ranging over it out loud with somebody else. Marathi did not decide they were different enough to need different words.

This is Marathi’s own arrangement, not a family inheritance. Hindi’s verb for asking, पूछना *pūchnā*, comes from an unrelated root, and Hindi’s विचार stays a noun. Where a language draws its lines is a choice each language makes for itself.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, slowly — “vichār karṇe ... vichārṇe”
- “I ask” in your own gender — “mī vichārto” or “vichārte”
- both with the Marathi *ts* — “vitsār karto ... vitsārto”

Before you move on

What is the only difference between Marathi’s “to think” and its “to ask”? (करणे — thinking adds “to do”; asking puts -णे straight onto विचार.) What did the shared root mean? (**To move, to turn over.**) How is the च said in both? (Nearer **ts** before the long *ā*.) And “to take”? (*Gheṇe*.)

16.3 मदत करणे (madat karṇe) — “to help,” a word that travelled

Say “to ask” — *vichārṇe*. And say “I know” — *malā māhīt āhe* — then name where माहीत was borrowed from. (**Arabic, through Persian.**) A second borrowed word from that same layer is coming.

You’ll want to know: मदत करणे

मदत करणे — *madat karṇe* — **to help**

Built the way *kām karṇe* and *vichār karṇe* are built: a noun, मदत *madat* (“help”), with करणे behind it. मी मदत करतो — *mī madat karto* — “I help,” करते *karte* for a woman.

That pattern is the most productive thing in the language: put करणे behind almost any noun and Marathi will accept the verb.

The letters in this word

मदत is three bare consonants, each with its built-in *a*: म *ma*, द *da*, त *ta* — *ma-da-t*, with the last *a* falling away in speech as it usually does at the end of a Marathi word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मदत is **Arabic** *madad*, borrowed through **Persian**. Its Arabic root means **to stretch out, to extend** — *madad* is a thing extended: a hand, or reinforcements sent to an army. Help, named as reach. It belongs to the layer of Persian and Arabic administration that settled into Marathi under the Deccan sultanates — the same layer that gave you माहीत in *malā māhīt āhe*, and हरकत in *kāhī harkat nāhī*. Three everyday words, one route. One small tell worth keeping: Marathi writes मदत, with a final त. Hindi and Urdu write मदद, with a द. The same loan, landing differently in each language — which is what borrowing normally looks like.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “madat karṇe” — then “mī madat karto” or “karte”
- the three करणे verbs you have — “kāṁ karṇe, vichār karṇe, madat karṇe”
- what the Arabic root meant — “to stretch out”

Before you move on

What did मदत’s Arabic root mean before it meant help? (**To stretch out, to extend.**) Which road did it travel to reach Marathi? (**Persian.**) Name another word you have from that same layer. (माहीत, or हरकत in *kāhī harkat nāhī*.) And how does Marathi spell the end of the word, against Hindi and Urdu? (With त, not द.)

16.4 आवडणे (āvaḍṇe) — “to like,” which is not something you do

Three verbs from this chapter: *ghene*, *vichārṇe*, *madat karṇe*. Say them. Each let you be the one acting. The fourth will not.

You’ll want to know: आवडणे

आवडणे — *āvaḍṇe* — to like

मला मराठी आवडते — *malā marāṭhī āvaḍte* — “I like Marathi,” or word for word, “**to me** Marathi pleases.”

The letters in this word

आ is the standalone long *ā*; व *va*; ङ *ḍa*, a **retroflex** *d* made with the tongue curled back — new here, and not the द *da* of *madat*; then णे. *Ā-va-ḍa-ṇe*.

Grammar Lens: the third sentence built this way

Marathi	word for word
मला मराठी येते	to-me Marathi comes — I know it
मला मराठी समजते	to-me Marathi is-understood — I understand it
मला मराठी आवडते	to-me Marathi pleases — I like it

One frame, three meanings. You are मला in all three, never the subject, and the verb agrees with मराठी. Change the thing liked and the ending follows it: a masculine thing takes आवडतो, a neuter thing आवडतं.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आवडणे is **Marathi’s own** — straight down from Old Marathi, cousin to Konkani *āvaḍ*, with **no Sanskrit ancestor securely established**, so this lesson claims none. Hindi and Urdu say पसंद *pasand*, borrowed from Persian.

Loving is a separate verb: प्रेम करणे *prem karṇe*, and there you **are** the subject — मी प्रेम करतो. प्रेम is Sanskrit *preman*, on प्री *prī*-, “to be dear,” from Indo-European ***preyH-**. Germanic built a verb “to love” on it, and from that English has **friend** — the one loved — and **free**.

Why it’s said this way

Chapter 13’s rule holds here: neither language is simply older. Marathi’s दोन took its final *n* by copying तीन — an innovation. Hindi’s पाँच kept a nasal Marathi dropped — a retention. Now a verb: Marathi kept its native word for liking, Hindi took a Persian one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “malā marāṭhī āvaḍte” — hearing “to me,” not “I”
- the one you do — “mī prem karto” or “karte”
- this chapter’s four — “gheṇe, vichārṇe, madat karṇe, āvaḍṇe”

Before you move on

Who is the subject of *malā marāṭhī āvaḍte*? (मराठी — not you.) Which of the two puts you in the subject’s chair? (प्रेम करणे.) Which English words share प्रेम’s root? (**Friend**, **free**.) Now the chapter’s four sources — *gheṇe*, *vichārṇe*, *madat karṇe*, *āvaḍṇe*. (Sanskrit ग्रह्, cousin of *grab*; विचार, the thinking word itself; **Arabic** *madad* through Persian; and आवड, native.)

Chapter 17

Water, Tea, Milk, and Bhakri

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can politely ask for water, tea, milk, or bhakri in Marathi, name which of the four is a Chinese loan and which never touched Sanskrit at all, and say why all three of Marathi's genders already show up in one short chapter.

The chapter closes on भाकरी, the request that breaks every pattern the first three set: the reader produces all four requests with कृपया, sorts पाणी and दूध (inherited from Sanskrit) against चहा (a Chinese loan by the overland route) against भाकरी (native to Marathi's own ground, sharing Sanskrit with none of them), and names the three genders the four words already cover.

17.1 पाणी (pāṇī) — the first thing you'll actually ask for

आवडणे told you what you like; प्रेम करणे what you love. This chapter asks for something smaller and more frequent than either: a drink.

You'll want to know: पाणी

पाणी — pāṇī — water

The letters in this word

Nothing new here. प pa you have from punhā; ण you have from every -णे verb so far; ी is the familiar long ī. पा-णी.

Grammar Lens: asking politely

पाणी, कृपया. — *pāṇī, kṛpayā*. — Water, please.

कृपया *kṛpayā* is Sanskrit’s own instrumental of कृपा *kṛpā*, “mercy, kindness” — literally “by kindness, out of kindness.” Name the thing you want, add कृपया, and the request is complete: no verb for “give” required. This is the pattern the whole chapter reuses, and the first time this track has built a “please” of any kind — a spine node this book had left empty until now.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पाणी continues Maharastri Prakrit **pāṇīa**, from Sanskrit पानीय *pānīya*, “that which is to be drunk,” built on पा *pā-*, “to drink.” That root is Indo-European *peh₃(i)-*, and English keeps two disguised pieces of it: **potion** and **poison** both come through Latin *potare*, “to drink” — a poison, by origin, is just a drink gone wrong. Greek turned the same idea into *sympotēs*, “one who drinks together,” which English keeps as **symposium**.

Your turn

- Say it: **pāṇī** — water
- Say it: **pāṇī, kṛpayā**. — water, please
- Run through: **malā marāṭhī āvaḍte**, then **pāṇī, kṛpayā** — liking and requesting, side by side

Before you move on

Ask for water politely. (**Pāṇī, kṛpayā**.) What does कृपया literally mean? (“By kindness.”) Which two English words for a drink, and one for a whole gathering of them, share **pāṇī**’s root? (**Potion, poison, symposium**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: पाणी; Wiktionary: कृपया.

17.2 चहा (chahā) — a word that took the overland road

पाणी, कृपया (*pāṇī, kṛpayā*) — water, please. Say it once more, then ask for something that is not water at all.

You'll want to know: चहा

चहा — *chahā* — tea

चहा, कृपया. — *chahā, kṛpayā*. — Tea, please.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. च you already say near *ts* from Chapter 13's चार; ह is नमस्कार's; ण the familiar long *ā*. *Cha-hā*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Every other word in this chapter reaches back to Sanskrit. चहा does not — it is a loanword from Mandarin **cha**, and it reached Marathi by the **overland** route, through Persian and Turkic trade, the same road that gave Hindi चाय *chāy*, Bengali *cha*, and Persian *chāy* their words for the same drink. A second branch of the same plant travelled by **sea**: Dutch traders carried the Hokkien word **te** to Western Europe, which is why English says **tea**, not *cha*. One plant, two words, two trade routes. चहा is also this chapter's first **masculine** noun, against पाणी's neuter — a reminder that Marathi's three genders do not sort words by where they came from.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **chahā, kṛpayā** — tea, please
- *Name:* the two trade routes — overland to *chāy/chahā*, by sea to *tea*
- *Say it:* both requests — **pāṇī, kṛpayā ... chahā, kṛpayā**

Before you move on

Ask for tea politely. (**Chahā, kṛpayā.**) Which language does चहा ultimately come from? (Mandarin Chinese, *cha*.) Which English

word for the same plant took the sea route instead? (**Tea.**)
 Sources: Wiktionary: चहा.

17.3 दूध (dūdh) — back to Sanskrit, and a surprising English cousin

चहा broke the pattern — a loanword with no Sanskrit behind it. This next word rejoins पाणी’s family: inherited, traceable, Indo-European.

You’ll want to know: दूध

दूध — *dūdh* — milk

दूध, कृपया. — *dūdh, kṛpayā.* — Milk, please.

The letters in this word

One new mark: ू, the **long ū** vowel sign — a longer hook under the consonant than any you’ve written so far. द you have from *dhanyavād* and *madat*; ध from *dhanyavād* too. *Dū-dh*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दूध continues Maharastri Prakrit **duddha**, from Sanskrit दुग्ध *dugdha*, “milked, milk” — literally the past participle of दुह् *duh*-, “to milk.” That root traces to Indo-European **dʰewǵʰ-*, “to be fit, to be of use, to produce” — milking as *producing something useful*. Germanic kept the same root for a different sense of “useful, capable”: English **doughty**, “brave and able,” is *dūhtig* in Old English, built on this exact root. Milk and doughtiness, four thousand years apart, share one ancestor.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **dūdh, kṛpayā** — milk, please
- *Say it:* what *dugdha* literally was — “milked”
- *Run through:* all three requests — **pāṇī, chahā, dūdh** — kṛpayā

Before you move on

Ask for milk politely. (**Dūdh**, **kṛpayā**.) What English word for “brave and capable” shares दूध’s root? (**Doughty**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: दूध.

17.4 भाकरी (bhākarī) — the request that breaks the pattern

Three requests so far: **pāṇī**, **chahā**, **dūdh**. Two inherited from Sanskrit, one borrowed from Chinese. The fourth belongs to neither story.

You’ll want to know: भाकरी

भाकरी — *bhākarī* — a round flatbread, the everyday Maharashtra bread — of jowar, bajra, or rice flour, not wheat

भाकरी, कृपया. — *bhākarī*, *kṛpayā*. — Bhakri, please.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. भ from *bheṭū*, क from everywhere, र from *marāṭhī*, ी the familiar long *ī*. *Bhā-ka-rī*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाकरी is inherited from Old Marathi **bhākarī**, from Proto-Indo-Aryan ***b^hakkaras**, “heap, pile, lump” — the flatbread named for the lump of dough it started as. That reconstruction is as far back as the sources trace it; its own root before Proto-Indo-Aryan is not established, so this lesson claims none rather than inventing one.

Unlike पाणी and दूध, भाकरी is not a Sanskrit tatsama or tadbhava — it never touched classical Sanskrit. And unlike चहा, it is no loanword either — a regional word, close kin to Gujarati *bhākhri* and Kannada *bakkari*, and simply **not** Hindi’s word for bread: Hindi asks for रोटी *roṭī*, an unrelated root. A Delhi shopkeeper would not recognize the request; a Pune one would hand you lunch.

Why it's said this way

Say the four requests once more and notice their genders: पाणी neuter, चहा masculine, दूध neuter, भाकरी feminine. Four everyday nouns, all three of Marathi's genders, in one short chapter — proof, alongside the verbs' present-tense endings, that the third gender Hindi lost is not a museum piece here.

Your turn

- *Say it:* all four requests, kṛpayā each time — **pāṇī**, **chahā**, **dūdh**, **bhākarī**
- *Say it:* “I eat bhakri” — **mī bhākarī khāto** or **khāte**, putting Chapter 7's खाणे to work on a word it never had before
- *Name:* which of the four is neither Sanskrit nor a loanword — **bhākarī**

Before you move on

What did भाकरी's Proto-Indo-Aryan ancestor mean? (**A heap, a lump.**) What does Hindi ask for instead? (रोटी, an unrelated root.) Give all four requests with their genders. (पाणी n, चहा m, दूध n, भाकरी f — all with कृपया.) Sort the four sources: two from Sanskrit, one a Chinese loan, one purely regional. (**Pāṇī**, **dūdh** — Sanskrit; **chahā** — Chinese; **bhākarī** — regional.) Sources: Wiktionary: भाकरी.

Chapter 18

Friend and Family

Modes: ⇐ voice (2) 👁 eyes (4) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a friend, a family, a brother, and a sister in Marathi, sort each word into a tatsama taken up whole from Sanskrit or a tadbhava worn down by sound change, and say which sibling word is genuinely English’s cousin and which is not.

The chapter closes on बहीण, deliberately not a cousin of English sister: the reader produces मित्र, कुटुंब, भाऊ and बहीण, sorts the four into two tatsamas (मित्र, कुटुंब) and two tadbhavas (भाऊ, बहीण), and names भाऊ as the secure cousin of brother against बहीण’s unrelated root — while recalling कुटुंब’s gender split from Hindi and मित्र’s root in a covenant god’s name.

18.1 मित्र (mitra) — a friend, and a very old bond

You can ask for **bhākarī** now. This chapter turns from what you’d request to who you’d share it with.

You’ll want to know: मित्र

मित्र — *mitra* — friend (masculine)

The letters in this word

Two things worth pausing on. ि, the **short i** vowel sign, is new — written *before* the consonant it belongs to but said *after* it, so मि is read *mi*, not *im*.

And त्र is त joined to र by a *halant*, the same conjunct mechanism as *punhā*’s न्हा, just a different pair of letters. *Mi-tra*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मित्र is a **learned borrowing** straight from Sanskrit मित्र *mitra* — taken up whole, not worn down by centuries of sound change the way most everyday words are. Its root is Indo-European **mey-*, “to bind,” and the same word named a god: Avestan **Mithra** and Old Persian **Mithra** were divine witnesses to oaths — the bond itself, personified, before the word settled into ordinary Sanskrit as “friend.”

Grammar Lens: taken up whole, not worn down

Sanskrit-descended Marathi words come in two kinds: a **tatsama**, borrowed directly with its Sanskrit shape mostly intact — मित्र is one — and a **tadbhava**, one that passed through centuries of Prakrit sound change and came out reshaped. भाकरी was neither: it never touched Sanskrit at all. This chapter will show both a tatsama and a tadbhava for family words, so you can hear the difference.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **mitra** — friend
- *Say it:* what its root meant before “friend” — “to bind”
- *Name:* the god-name that shares this root — **Mithra**
- *Say it:* **mitra**, then **bhākarī** — a learned word beside a native one whose own root went no further back than “a heap, a lump”
- *Recall:* Chapter 17’s four requests and their three genders — **pāṇī** neuter, **chahā** masculine, **dūdh** neuter, **bhākarī** feminine

Before you move on

What did मित्र’s root mean before “friend”? (**To bind.**) What god-name shares that root? (**Mithra.**) Is मित्र a tatsama or a tadbhava? (**Tatsama** — taken up whole from Sanskrit.)
Sources: Wiktionary: मित्र.

18.2 One step later — retrieve मित्र

Say the Marathi word for **friend** before you uncover it: मित्र (*mitra*).

What you’ve built

Its old root meant **to bind**. Marathi took the Sanskrit form up whole, so it is a **tatsama**, not a word worn down through ordinary sound change.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

मित्र — **bind** — **tatsama**. Stop here; the next lesson adds family.

18.3 कुटुंब (kuṭumb) — family, and a gender Hindi disagrees with

मित्र (*mitra*) was taken up whole from Sanskrit, not worn down. This next word was too — and it names the group your friend belongs to as well.

You’ll want to know: कुटुंब

कुटुंब — *kuṭumb* — **family** (neuter)

The letters in this word

One new mark: ु, the **short u** vowel sign, a small hook under the consonant — the short partner of *dūdh*’s long ू. ट you have informally from *marāṭhī*; ं the familiar anusvāra. *Ku-tu-mb*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुटुंब is a **tatsama**, a learned borrowing from Sanskrit कुटुम्ब *kuṭumba*, “household, family” — like मित्र, taken up whole rather than worn down

by sound change. Unlike मित्र, its story does not reach a secure Indo-European root: a Dravidian origin for Sanskrit's own *kuṭumba* has been proposed, but it is not settled, so this lesson names the dispute rather than inventing a resolution.

Grammar Lens: a gender Hindi disagrees with

The very same Sanskrit word carries two different genders in its two daughters: Marathi's कुटुंब is **neuter**, Hindi's कुटुंब is **masculine**. Both borrowed the identical tatsama; each language then had to assign it a gender inside its own system, and they assigned it differently. A word's gender is not carried in with its meaning — it is decided fresh by whichever language receives it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **kuṭumb** — family
- *State:* its gender in Marathi against Hindi — neuter here, masculine there
- *Say it:* **mitra**, then **kuṭumb** — two tatsamas in a row
- *Recall:* Chapter 17's own gender lineup — कुटुंब's neuter joins पाणी and दूध, after **bhākarī**'s feminine closed out all three genders in one chapter

Before you move on

What gender is कुटुंब in Marathi, and how does that differ from Hindi? (**Neuter** here, **masculine** there — same borrowed word, different choice.) Is कुटुंब's pre-Sanskrit origin settled? (**No** — a Dravidian source is proposed but disputed.) Sources: Wiktionary: कुटुंब.

18.4 One step later — retrieve कुटुंब

Say the Marathi word for **family**: कुटुंब (*kuṭumb*).

What you've built

Marathi treats कुटुंब as **neuter**. Hindi assigns the same borrowed word masculine gender. Retrieve the Marathi choice, not a universal rule.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

कुटुंब — family — neuter.

18.5 भाऊ (bhāū) — brother, and this time the resemblance is real

मित्र and कुटुंब were both taken up whole from Sanskrit. This next word was not — it was worn down, letter by letter, over centuries.

You'll want to know: भाऊ

भाऊ — *bhāū* — brother (masculine)

The letters in this word

One new letter: ऊ, the **independent long *ū***, used here because a Marathi word cannot stack one vowel mark on top of another — after आ's ा, the second vowel needs its own full letter. भ you have from *bheṭū*. *Bhā-ū*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाऊ is a **tadbhava** — not borrowed whole like मित्र or कुटुंब, but the ordinary Prakrit-worn descendant of Sanskrit भ्रातृ *bhrātṛ*, three syllables ground down to two over a thousand years of speech. That root is Indo-European **b^hréh₂tēr*, and here the family resemblance to English is not a false friend — it is the real thing: **brother**, Latin **frāter**, and Sanskrit's own **bhrātṛ** are all the same word, worn down four different ways by four different languages.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **bhāū** — brother
- *Name:* three languages that share this root — English, Latin, Sanskrit
- *Say it:* the three so far — **mitra**, **kuṭumb**, **bhāū**

Before you move on

Is भाऊ a tatsama or a tadbhava? (**Tadbhava** — worn down by sound change, not borrowed whole.) Which English word is the very same word as भाऊ? (**Brother**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: भाऊ.

18.6 बहीण (bahīṇ) — sister, deliberately not English's cousin

Three words so far: **mitra**, **kuṭumb**, **bhāū**. Say them, and say which one is a genuine cousin of an English word. (**Bhāū** — brother.) Its pair is not so simple.

You'll want to know: बहीण

बहीण — *bahīṇ* — **sister** (feminine)

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ब from *baram*, ह from *namaskār*, ी the familiar long *ī*, ण from every -णे verb. *Ba-hī-ṇ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बहीण is a **tadbhava**, worn down like भाऊ: Old Marathi *bahīṇ*, from Maharastri Prakrit *bhaiṇ*, from Sanskrit भगिनी *bhaginī*. There the resemblance to **brother**'s pair ends. **Bhaginī** is traditionally connected to भज् *bhaj-*, “to share, to apportion” — a sister as one who shares in the household. That root has nothing to do with Indo-European **swésōr*, the ancestor of English **sister**. Two words that translate each other perfectly are, underneath, unrelated.

Grammar Lens: the chapter's whole shape, in two pairs

word	kind	route
मित्र, कुटुंब (<i>mitra</i> , <i>kuṭumb</i>)	tatsama	taken up whole from Sanskrit
भाऊ, बहीण (<i>bhāū</i> , <i>bahīṇ</i>)	tadbhava	worn down by Prakrit sound change

Notice, too, how each pair *looks*: मित्र and कुटुंब carry conjuncts and marks a learner has to stop for; भाऊ and बहीण do not — plain consonants and vowels, the shape sound change tends to leave behind. And of the tadbhava pair, only भाऊ is a secure English cousin; बहीण is not.

Your turn

- *Say it*: all four — **mitra**, **kuṭumb**, **bhāū**, **bahīṇ**
- *Sort*: which two are tatsama, which two are tadbhava
- *Name*: which sibling word is English's real cousin, and which is not — **bhāū** yes, **bahīṇ** no

Before you move on

Is बहीण related to English **sister**? (**No** — a different Sanskrit root entirely.) Which sibling word *is* related to its English counterpart? (भाऊ, to **brother**.) Sort the chapter's four words into tatsama and tadbhava. (**Mitra**, **kuṭumb** — tatsama; **bhāū**, **bahīṇ** — tadbhava.) What did कुटुंब's gender turn out to be, against Hindi's? (**Neuter** here, masculine there.) And what did मित्र's root mean before "friend"? (**To bind**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: बहीण; Wiktionary: भगिनी.

Chapter 19

Eye, Ear, Mouth, and Nose

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the eye, ear, mouth, and nose in Marathi, say the retroflex ऌ formally for the first time, and tell which of the four carries the most secure English cognate and which replaced its own inherited word entirely.

The chapter closes on नाक, completing the face: the reader produces डोळा, कान, तोंड and नाक with their genders, and sorts the four by kind of history — डोळा replaced the old Indo-Aryan eye-word with one that once meant “swing”; कान’s root is honestly disputed; तोंड keeps a formal doublet, मुख, standing beside it; नाक alone reaches English नोज़ / nose without qualification.

19.1 डोळा (ḍoḷā) — the letter you’ve heard since Chapter 11, formally

मित्र, कुटुंब, भाऊ, बहीण (*mitra, kuṭumb, bhāū, bahīṇ*) — the people you’d introduce. This chapter turns to the body you’d ask after when you check how someone is.

You’ll want to know: डोळा

डोळा — ḍoḷā — eye (masculine)

The letters in this word

ड you have from *āvaḍṇe*; ो the familiar *o* mark, from *bolṇe*. Then ङ — the **retroflex “l”** you first met, unlabeled, inside Chapter 11’s काळजी. Formally: tongue curled back, same place as ट and ण. Standard Hindi dropped this sound centuries ago; Marathi kept it, sharing it with the Dravidian languages to the south and with Gujarati. *Do-lā*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डोळा continues Maharastri Prakrit **ḍola**, “eye,” from Sanskrit दोल *dola* — “a swing, a swinging.” Somewhere in Prakrit, “a swinging thing” came to mean “eye,” and that word pushed out the one you might expect: the true inherited Indo-Aryan eye-word is Sanskrit अक्षि/अक्ष *akṣi/akṣa*, from Indo-European **h₃ek^w-*, the very cousin of Latin **oculus** and English **eye**. Hindi’s आँख *ākh* continues that old word, worn down through Prakrit *acchi*. Marathi’s eye is not that word at all — it is a replacement, built on something that once just meant *swing*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **ḍolā** — eye
- *Say it:* what its Sanskrit root actually meant — “a swing”
- *Name:* the word Marathi’s eye-word replaced — **akṣi**, Hindi’s **āṅkh**
- *Say it:* what you do with your डोळे — **pāhṇe**, “to see,” Chapter 14’s verb whose own root was Indo-European **spek-*
- *Recall:* Chapter 18’s tatsama/tadbhava split — मित्र, कुटुंब taken up whole, भाऊ, बहीण worn down — and कुटुंब’s own neuter gender against Hindi’s masculine

Before you move on

What did डोळा’s Sanskrit root originally mean? (**A swing.**) Is डोळा the same word as Hindi’s आँख? (**No** — Marathi replaced the old eye-word entirely.) What Marathi letter appears in डोळा that Hindi lost? (ङ, the retroflex *l*.)
Sources: Wiktionary: डोळा; Wiktionary: दोल.

19.2 कान (kān) — an ear, and a cluster you’ve seen simplify before

डोळा (*ḍolā*) — its own root turned out to be a surprise, a swing, not the old eye-word. This next word has a different kind of surprise: not what it meant, but how its middle got simpler.

You’ll want to know: कान

कान — *kān* — ear (masculine)

The letters in this word

Nothing new. क, ा, न are all familiar from Chapter 1 onward. *Kā-n*.

The letters in this word

कान continues Sanskrit कर्ण *karṇa*. Getting there took the same kind of step Chapter 13 traced in दोन: Prakrit could not keep Sanskrit’s consonant cluster **ṛṇ** intact, so it simplified — not by copying a neighbor this time, but by **doubling** the surviving consonant, *ṛṇ* → *ṇṇ*, giving Prakrit कण्ण *kaṇṇa*. Old Marathi then simplified the geminate back down to one *ṇ* with a lengthened vowel: *kāna*. Different cluster, different path, same underlying habit — Prakrit does not tolerate what Sanskrit could pack into one syllable.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Past Sanskrit, कर्ण’s own origin is genuinely **disputed** among scholars — proposals connect it to a word for “point, spike,” to a root for “handle, grip,” even to the verb “to hear,” but none has won general acceptance. Rather than choose one and present it as settled, this lesson names the dispute and stops there, the same honest gap Chapter 18 named for कुटुंब, and the same restraint that kept बहीण from being handed a false cousin — बहीण looks like it should match English *sister*, and does not.

Your turn

- Say it: **kān** — ear

- *Trace it:* *kaṇa* → *kaṇṇa* → *kāna*, the cluster ground down and then simplified again
- *Say it:* **ḍoḷā, kān** — eye, ear

Before you move on

What did Prakrit do to Sanskrit कर्ण's *rṇ* cluster? (**Doubled it** to *rṇṇ*, then Old Marathi simplified that back to one *rṇ*.) Is कर्ण's root beyond Sanskrit settled? (**No** — disputed.) Which Chapter 13 word also showed a consonant cluster changing shape? (दोन, whose final *n* came from copying तीन.)
Sources: Wiktionary: कान.

19.3 तोंड (tōḍ) — the mouth, and the formal word standing behind it

डोळा, कान — eye, ear. Recall how कान's middle got simpler — *rṇ* doubled to *rṇṇ*, then simplified again. One more word before the chapter's closing one.

You'll want to know: तोंड

तोंड — *tōḍ* — **mouth** (neuter)

The letters in this word

Nothing new. त, ो, ं, ड are all familiar. *Tō-ḍ*, the anusvāra nasalizing the *o*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तोंड continues Maharastri Prakrit तुंड *tuṇḍa*, from Sanskrit तुण्ड *tuṇḍa*, “mouth, snout, beak” — a tadbhava, worn down the way भाऊ was. Marathi keeps a second, formal word for the same thing: मुख *mukh*, borrowed whole from Sanskrit exactly the way मित्र and कुटुंब were — the same everyday-versus-formal split कुटुंब's chapter didn't need to show you for a body part until now. You'll hear तोंड in daily speech and मुख in writing, formal address, and words like *mukhya*, “chief, principal” — literally “at the mouth/face of things.”

Your turn

- *Say it:* तोंड — mouth
- *Name:* its formal doublet — **mukh**
- *Say it:* three so far — ढोळा, कान, तोंड

Before you move on

What is तोंड's formal Sanskrit doublet? (मुख, *mukh*.) Is तोंड itself borrowed whole or worn down? (**Worn down** — a tadbhava, like भाऊ.)

Sources: Wiktionary: तोंड.

19.4 नाक (nāk) — the face, completed

डोळा, कान, तोंड (ḍoḷā, kān, tōḍ) — say them. One face part left, and it is the one with the plainest history of the four.

You'll want to know: नाक

नाक — *nāk* — **nose** (neuter)

The letters in this word

Nothing new. न, ा, क — all familiar since Chapter 1. *Nā-k*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाक continues Prakrit णक्क *ṇakka*, “nose,” built on Sanskrit नस् *nas-*, “nose,” plus a suffix. You may have met the *other* Sanskrit route to “nose,” नासिका *nāsikā*, elsewhere — Marathi's नाक took the shorter one, straight from the bare root. Either way the destination is the same Indo-European **neh₂s-*, which English inherited directly as **nose**. Of this chapter's four words, नाक is the one whose English cousin needs no qualification at all.

Why it's said this way

Run the face back one more time, and notice each word told a different kind of story: डोळा replaced its old Indo-Aryan word entirely, with

something that once just meant *swing*; कान's root is honestly **disputed**, even though its $rn \rightarrow nn \rightarrow n$ path is not; तोंड keeps a formal Sanskrit doublet, मुख, standing beside it; and नाक is the plainest of the four — a straight, secure line to Sanskrit and to English both. Not every word in a family carries the same amount of history, and knowing which is which is worth more than assuming they all match.

Your turn

- *Say it*: all four, with gender — ढोलā m, kān m, tōḍ n, nāk n
- *Name*: which is a secure English cousin (**nāk**), which replaced its old word (ढोलā), which is disputed (**kān**), which has a formal doublet (**tōḍ**)
- *Say it*: what you do with your डीळे — pāhṇe, “to see”

Before you move on

Which English word is नाक's most secure cousin? (**Nose**.) Sort the four face words by their history — replaced, disputed, twinned, secure. (ढोलā replaced its old word; kān's root is disputed; tōḍ has the formal doublet **mukh**; nāk is the secure one.) What Chapter 14 verb names what your eyes do? (**Pāhṇe**, “to see.”)

Sources: Wiktionary: नाक.

Chapter 20

Heart

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the heart in Marathi, name three English words that share its root, and say what makes it different from every other word this book has taken apart: it never drifted at all.

The reader produces हृदय and its three secure English cousins — heart, cordial, cardiac — then sets it against वाचणे's drift from speaking to reading, समजणे's drift from waking to understanding, and डोळा's replacement of the old eye-word, naming हृदय as the one word among them that never drifted at all.

20.1 हृदय (hṛdaya) — the word that never drifted

The face is complete: ḍoḷā, kān, tōḍ, nāk — and nāk was the one whose English cousin, **nose**, needed no qualification at all. One organ is left, and its history could not be more different from डोळा's.

You'll want to know: हृदय

हृदय — *hṛdaya* — **heart** (neuter)

The letters in this word

One new mark, thirteen chapters in: ृ, the **vocalic *r*** — a small hook below the consonant, standing for a syllabic *r* sound with no vowel written beside it. ह, द, य are all familiar. *Hṛ-da-ya*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हृदय continues Sanskrit हृदय *hr̥daya* itself, unchanged in shape since this book's earliest chapters were still explaining what a *halant* does. Its root is Indo-European **kērd-*, “heart” — and this is about as secure as a cognate gets: English **heart**, Latin **cor/cordis** (behind **cordial**), and Greek **kardia** (behind **cardiac**) are all the same word, diverging by ordinary sound change and nothing stranger.

Why it's said this way

Set हृदय against the words this book has already taken apart. Chapter 15's वाचणे drifted from *vac-*, “to speak,” into “to read” by way of a causative twist — reading as *making the text speak*. The same chapter's समजणे drifted from *budh-*, “to wake,” into “to understand” — an idea arriving is a kind of waking up. Chapter 19's डोळा drifted furthest of all, from *dola*, “a swing,” into “eye,” pushing out the word it replaced. हृदय, by contrast, has drifted almost nowhere: no causative twist, no metaphor, no replacement — the same word, doing the same job, since before Sanskrit was written down.

Your turn

- *Say it:* हृदय — heart
- *Name:* three English words sharing its root — **heart**, **cordial**, **cardiac**
- *Say it:* all five body words this book has taught — ढोला, कान, तोंड, नाक, हृदय

Before you move on

Name three English words that share हृदय's root. (**Heart**, **cordial**, **cardiac**.) What makes हृदय different from वाचणे, समजणे, and डोळा? (Those three **drifted** — speaking to reading, waking to understanding, swinging to eye; हृदय did not drift at all.) What new Devanagari mark did this lesson add? (ॠ, the vocalic *r*.) Sources: Wiktionary: हृदय.

Chapter 21

Family Memory at Real Distance

Modes: 🗣️ voice (12) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can retrieve मित्र and कुटुंब after short, medium, and durable gaps; explain the binding root and tatsama path of मित्र; and recall that कुटुंब is neuter in Marathi.

After genuine intervening retrievals, produce the five-part comparison: मित्र, its binding root and tatsama path, then कुटुंब and its Marathi neuter gender.

21.1 After a gap — मित्र

Friend. Old root meaning **to bind**. Borrowed whole from Sanskrit. Say the three answers: मित्र — **bind** — **tatsama**.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Say मित्र once more, then stop.

21.2 After a gap — कुटुंब

Family. Marathi gender. Answer: कुटुंब — **neuter**.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Say कुटुंब once more.

21.3 Sibling retrieval

Say **brother, sister**: भाऊ, बहीण.

The two words and their histories

भाऊ is a secure cousin of English **brother**. Do not extend that claim to बहीण and English *sister*; those roots are unrelated.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

भाऊ, बहीण.

21.4 Eye and ear retrieval

Eye: डोळा. Ear: कान. In डोळा, keep ळ retroflex; do not replace it with ordinary ल.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

डोळा, कान.

21.5 Mouth and nose retrieval

Everyday **mouth** is तोंड; formal **मुख** stands beside it. **Nose** is नाक.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

तोंड, नाक.

21.6 Three request nouns

Say **water, tea, milk** in order: पाणी, चहा, दूध.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Repeat once, then stop.

21.7 Three doing verbs

Take: घेणे. Ask: विचारणे. Help: मदत करणे.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Repeat the trio once.

21.8 Three mind-and-page verbs

Think: विचार करणे. Understand: समजणे. Write: लिहिणे.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Repeat once.

21.9 Three core verbs

Be: असणे. Go: जाणे. Come: येणे.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Repeat once.

21.10 Durable retrieval — मित्र

Recover the word for **friend**, its old root meaning, and the name for a Sanskrit form borrowed whole.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

मित्र. One clean retrieval is enough.

21.11 Count, then notice

Count one through five. Then say चार with Marathi **tsā-**, and remember that a language can innovate in one place while retaining an older feature in another.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

Count once more without looking.

21.12 Durable family comparison

Friend: मित्र; old root **to bind**; tatsama. Family: कुटुंब; neuter in Marathi.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the missing piece.

Before you move on

मित्र, कुटुंब. End the session here.

Chapter 22

The Doorway Signs at Long Distance

Modes: 🗣️ voice (9) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 9 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write dhanyavad and retrieve all twelve doorway signs after more than eighty later lessons.

Retrieve the final sign batch from sound after every new doorway sign has crossed the long-distance window.

22.1 The doorway word, much later

Close every earlier model and listen before picking up the pencil.

Before you move on

Hear *dhanyavād*. Say its meaning, read धन्यवाद, then cover the model and write it once. This reconnects meaning and script without adding anything new.

22.2 First batch at long distance

Keep every model closed and one blank line ready.

Before you move on

From sound and spoken names only, write *dhanyavād*, visarga, independent *ā*, and *bha*. Compare once: धन्यवाद; ः आ भ.

22.3 Second batch at long distance

Keep every model closed and one blank line ready.

Before you move on

From spoken names only, write e-mark, anusvāra, and dental *ta*. Compare once: ऐ ं त.

22.4 Voiced batch at long distance

Keep every model closed and one blank line ready.

Before you move on

From spoken names only, write *da*, *dha*, and *ba*. Compare once: द ध ब.

22.5 Final batch at long distance

Keep every model closed and one blank line ready.

Before you move on

From spoken names only, write *ya*, curled-back *la*, and *va*. Compare once: य ल व.

22.6 The six marks, a whole book later

You have not been asked for these since the counting chapter. Say them anyway, and notice which one comes slowest.

Before you move on

Short *i* — before, above, or below? (**Before.**) [PAUSE 2s] Short *u*? (**Below.**) [PAUSE 2s] Long *ū*? (**Below, deeper.**) [PAUSE 2s] The vocalic *r*? (**Below, opening the other way.**) [PAUSE 2s] The candrabindu? (**Above, in a crescent.**) [PAUSE 2s] And short *a* standing alone? (**Its own letter.**)

22.7 Two rows, at book distance

If the pattern held, you will not be recalling seven separate things. Find out.

Before you move on

Velar row, plain to voiced-and-breathy. (*ka, kha, ga, gha.*)
 Palatal row, the same. (*ca, cha, ja, jha.*) [PAUSE 2s]
 Which sign does *mājhe* need? (*jha.*) [PAUSE 2s] Which one opens *gheṇe*? (*gha.*)

22.8 The curled row, a whole book later

These five are the reason the romanizations in this book carry dots under some letters and not others.

Before you move on

The four curled letters. (*ṭa, ṭha, ḍa, ṇa.*) [PAUSE 2s] What is the dot under *ṭ* telling you? (Curl the tongue back.) [PAUSE 2s] Which letter ends *bolṇe* and *khāṇe*? (*ṇa.*) [PAUSE 2s] And *ba* with the voice switched off? (*pa.*)

22.9 The last six, at book distance

The end of the second runway, asked for once more with everything else in between.

Before you move on

The plain *l*, beside the curled one. (*la.*) [PAUSE 2s] The two sibilants most speakers say alike. (*śa* and *ṣa.*) [PAUSE 2s] The three vowels that stand alone as well as leaning. (*u*, *ū*, *e.*) [PAUSE 2s] Why is a letter still written for a sound that merged? (Spelling outlives the sound it recorded.)

Chapter 23

Six Small Form Labels

Modes: ✍ pen (10) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read, copy, and retrieve six Marathi form labels, while keeping the two favorite-label agreement endings distinct.

After a delay and without a visible answer model, write the final three form labels and repair agreement before other spelling.

23.1 नाव — the first form label

You already know नाव as “name.” On a form, the same word becomes a request: write the name after it. Today the answer is the familiar practice name मीरा.

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace only नाव: मीरा. Keep the colon between the printed label and the answer. Then cover the line and point to the part that asks the question.

Before you move on

Stop after one label and one known answer.

23.2 शहर — the city box

The known sentence मी पुण्यात राहतो / राहते put the practice person in Pune. A short form asks for that place with शहर — “city.”

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace only शहर: पुणे. Say “city, Pune” once. Do not add an address; this box asks for one small thing.

Before you move on

Two labels are enough for one sitting.

23.3 भाषा — the language box

You can already say मी मराठी बोलतो / बोलते. A form compresses that whole sentence to a label and a value: भाषा: मराठी — “language: Marathi.”

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace भाषा: मराठी once. Keep भाषा on the question side and मराठी on the answer side.

Before you move on

Stop before the form grows longer.

23.4 आवडते पेय — favorite drink

The known drink is चहा. The label आवडते पेय means “favorite drink.” पेय is neuter, so the describing word takes neuter -ते: आवडते.

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace आवडते पेय: चहा once. Box only the ending -ते. The next lesson will change that ending for a feminine label; do not learn both today.

Before you move on

One agreement ending is enough.

23.5 आवडती कृती — favorite activity

Change one thing. कृती, “activity,” is feminine, so “favorite” becomes feminine आवडती. The familiar activity value is वाचणे, “reading.”

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace आवडती कृती: वाचणे once. Underline only -ती. Compare without rewriting: आवडते पेय but आवडती कृती.

Before you move on

Stop after the one-ending contrast.

23.6 मित्राचे नाव — friend’s name

You know मित्र, friend, and नाव, name. Marathi links them as मित्राचे नाव, “the friend’s name.” The -चे form agrees with neuter नाव. The familiar practice answer is अरुण.

Writing — observe and trace one pair

Trace मित्राचे नाव: अरुण once. Circle -चे and stop; no possessive table is needed for this form.

Before you move on

All six labels now have one first encounter.

23.7 Copy the first three rows

Say the three meanings once: name, city, language. Keep the model closed until you can say all three in that order.

Writing — guided copy

Copy exactly three short rows:

नाव: मीरा

>

शहर: पुणे भाषा: मराठी

After each row, point left of the colon and say what that label asks. Repair only a missing or misplaced character; do not add a fourth row.

Before you move on

Close the model before the next lesson.

23.8 Copy the last three rows

Say the three meanings once: favorite drink, favorite activity, friend's name. Listen for the one small job each label performs.

Writing — guided copy

Copy exactly three rows:

आवडते पेय: चहा

>

आवडती कृती: वाचणे मित्राचे नाव: अरुण

On the first two, underline only -ते / -ती. On the third, circle only -चे. One visible contrast, then stop.

Before you move on

Close the model before retrieval.

23.9 Hide, wait, write the first three labels

Close the copy lesson. Say name, city, language once, then start the ten-second delay.

Writing — delayed copy

Close the copy lesson and wait ten seconds. From the meaning cues **name** · **city** · **language**, write the three Marathi labels. There is no Devanagari model and no romanization in this attempt.

Only after all three are written, reopen the model. Check one row at a time and repair only the first differing character.

Before you move on

Stop after one delayed set.

23.10 Hide, wait, write the last three labels

Close the copy lesson. Say favorite drink, favorite activity, friend's name once, then start the ten-second delay.

Writing — delayed copy

Close the copy lesson and wait ten seconds. From **favorite drink** · **favorite activity** · **friend's name**, write the three Marathi labels without a model or romanization.

Then compare in two bounded passes: first -ते / -ती, then -चे. If the first pass differs, repair it and stop; leave the second pass for tomorrow.

Before you move on

The labels are ready; choosing answers belongs to the next runway.

Chapter 24

A Message for Mira

Modes: ✍ pen (18) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 18 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can independently write a 32-word Devanagari message to Mira for a familiar introduction and Marathi-study purpose.

Without romanization, a line bank, or a visible answer model, write the 30-40-word message from the named reader and purpose alone.

24.1 Write to one named reader

You already know नमस्कार. A message needs to show who receives that greeting. Today the reader is मीरा, the familiar practice name.

Writing — observe and trace one complete line

Trace नमस्कार मीरा. once. Leave one space between the greeting and the name. Touch the full stop; it closes this first line.

Before you move on

Stop after one reader, one greeting, and one boundary.

24.2 Add the sender's name

Write yesterday's reader greeting from memory. The next line is not new Marathi: माझं नाव अरुण आहे. already appeared in the

introduction recap.

Writing — guided copy

Copy the name line once beneath the greeting. Check only two things: अरुण is the sender, and आहे remains at the end before the full stop.

Before you move on

Two lines are enough for today.

24.3 One line for meeting the reader

Read the known line भेटून आनंद झाला. Say where it ends. The full stop keeps the sender's name and the meeting response from running together.

Writing — guided copy

Copy भेटून आनंद झाला. beneath the identity line. Compare the boundary first; compare spelling only after the full stop is present.

Before you move on

The opening now has three short lines; do not combine them yet.

24.4 Begin the purpose: Marathi

Say the known sentence मला मराठी येते. Marathi puts the knower in the dative and lets मराठी govern येते. Nothing grammatical is being added.

Writing — delayed copy

Study मला मराठी येते. for five seconds. Cover it, wait five more seconds, then write it. Repair the ending -ते before any other spelling.

Before you move on

Only one purpose line today.

24.5 Add one reading line

The sender is Arun, so retrieve the already-practised masculine sentence: मी मराठी वाचतो. Today you are placing it in a message, not learning a verb.

Writing — delayed copy

Look once, hide the model, wait five seconds, and write the line. Check वाचतो first. Do not add the next skill on the same line.

Before you move on

One skill, one sentence, one full stop.

24.6 Add one writing line

Read the old sentence मी माझं नाव लिहितो. The middle names the object; the last word carries Arun's masculine ending.

Writing — delayed copy

Study the line, hide it, and wait eight seconds. Write it from memory. Compare in two passes: first माझं नाव, then लिहितो. Repair only one pass today.

Before you move on

The first three purpose lines now exist separately. Combining them comes later.

24.7 Add the shortest skill line

Arun has already said मी बोलतो in the verb lessons. In a message it needs only one new habit: a full stop that keeps it separate

from the next skill.

Writing — delayed copy

Look at मी बोलतो., cover it, wait eight seconds, and write it. Compare the verb ending before the punctuation.

Before you move on

Do not join it with another verb yet.

24.8 Keep both pieces of thinking

Retrieve the known pair विचार करणे. In the sentence, विचार stays beside the light verb: मी विचार करतो.

Writing — delayed copy

Study the line, hide it, and wait eight seconds. Write it. Check for the two verb pieces first; check the full stop second.

Before you move on

One two-part verb is enough for today.

24.9 Return to the dative frame

Compare मला मराठी येते with मला मराठी समजते. The frame and ending stay; only the known verb changes.

Writing — delayed copy

Study मला मराठी समजते., cover it, and wait ten seconds. Write it. Repair the dative opening first and the verb ending second.

Before you move on

All six skill lines now exist separately.

24.10 One word can be a full line

Write धन्यवाद from memory. It is already durable; the only message habit today is closing the one-word sentence.

Writing — delayed copy

Look once at धन्यवाद., cover it, wait ten seconds, and write it. If the word is correct but the full stop is missing, repair only the boundary.

Before you move on

Stop after the single word and its boundary.

24.11 The first farewell line

The known phrase पुन्हा भेटू promises another meeting. Keep it on a new line after thanks.

Writing — delayed copy

Study पुन्हा भेटू., cover it, wait ten seconds, and write it. Compare the space between the two words before comparing the final mark.

Before you move on

Tomorrow's line comes in the next lesson.

24.12 The dated farewell line

Swap only the first known word: पुन्हा भेटू becomes उद्या भेटू. The message now says when the next meeting happens.

Writing — delayed copy

Study उद्या भेटू., cover it, wait ten seconds, and write it. Compare उद्या first; भेटू was retrieved yesterday.

Before you move on

All twelve lines have now been practised separately.

24.13 Order the opening block

Retrieve the three opening jobs: greet Mira, name Arun, acknowledge the meeting. Each job already has one practised line.

Writing — controlled composition

Put these known line cards in message order, then write them as three lines:

- भेटून आनंद झाला.
- नमस्कार मीरा.
- माझं नाव अरुण आहे.

Choose the order from the three jobs. Do not change any words.

Before you move on

Stop with one three-line block.

24.14 Order the first three skills

Say the three jobs in English: know Marathi, read Marathi, write my name. Keep the two grammar frames separate; मला and मी are not interchangeable.

Writing — controlled composition

Choose the matching known line for each job and write the jobs in that order. Do not add a conjunction. Check the two sentence openings before spelling.

Before you move on

The first skills block is complete; the next three stay separate until tomorrow.

24.15 Order the second three skills

Retrieve the three jobs: speak, think, understand Marathi. The middle job keeps two verb pieces; the last job returns to मला.

Writing — controlled composition

Write the matching known sentence for each job in that order. Check one dimension per pass: sentence opening, then verb, then full stop.

Before you move on

The two skills blocks remain separate for one more lesson.

24.16 Order the closing block

Retrieve the three closing jobs: thank Mira, promise another meeting, name tomorrow. All three lines are already known.

Writing — controlled composition

Write one known line for each job, in that order. Keep each farewell on its own line even though both end with भेटू.

Before you move on

The four message blocks are ready to meet.

24.17 Connect the four known blocks

Name the four blocks without writing: opening, first skills, second skills, closing. No block contains new Marathi.

Writing — connected composition

Use the four completed block lessons as cards. Put the cards in purpose order and write the message. Afterward, count words by spaces: the result has **32 words**, inside the A1 target of 30–40.

Repair in four passes: block order, sentence boundaries, verb frames, spelling. Stop after the first pass that finds a problem.

Before you move on

Tomorrow the cards and answer model disappear.

24.18 Independent 30–40-word message

Close every earlier lesson. On blank paper write four tiny English planning labels only: opening · skills 1 · skills 2 · closing.

Writing — connected composition, no model

Write **30–40 words** to Mira. Introduce Arun, state the six practised Marathi skills, thank her, and close for another meeting tomorrow.

There is no romanization, line bank, block card, or visible answer model during this checkpoint. The task is untimed. When finished, count words and run one repair pass of your choice.

Before you move on

This is untimed message evidence only. It does not claim form completion or the later integrated timed A1 writing task.

Chapter 25

A Six-Field Profile

Modes: ✍ pen (10) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can independently choose and write six requested Marathi profile values in Devanagari without a value bank or completed model.

Complete a new six-field Marathi profile from support-language meanings alone, with printed labels but no copyable answers.

25.1 Choose the first three answers

Read three known labels: नाव, शहर, भाषा. Today you choose what each row asks for; you do not yet write the whole form.

Your turn — one profile, three choices

Profile A says in the support language: **name Arun; city Pune; language Marathi**. Point to the matching detail when each Marathi label is shown. Keep the profile card open. There is no Marathi answer bank to copy.

Before you move on

Stop after three meaning choices.

25.2 Choose the last three answers

Say the three jobs once: favorite drink, favorite activity, friend's name. Keep -ते, -ती, and -चे attached to the printed labels.

Your turn — one profile, three choices

Profile A says: **favorite drink tea; favorite activity reading; friend Mira**. Choose the requested detail for each Marathi label. Do not write a full row yet.

Before you move on

Stop before entry begins.

25.3 Enter the first three values

Keep Profile A visible: **Arun; Pune; Marathi**. The card gives meanings, not copyable Devanagari answers.

Writing — supported controlled composition

Complete only these rows:

नाव: _____

>

शहर: _____

>

भाषा: _____

Choose the requested known value and write it in Devanagari. The labels stay visible because they are the form, not an answer model.

Before you move on

Stop after three rows.

25.4 Repair one value, not the whole form

Cover yesterday's entries. Say which row held the first spelling difference. Do not recopy a correct row.

Writing — bounded spelling repair

Write only the failed value from **name · city · language**. Compare in three passes: base letters, vowel signs, then the final headline. If it is correct, write the next requested value once instead.

Before you move on

One repair pass is enough.

25.5 Enter the last three values

Keep Profile A visible: **tea; reading; Mira**. Say the three printed label endings once: -ते, -ती, -चे.

Writing — supported controlled composition

Complete only the three blank value spaces. The support-language card chooses the meanings; you supply the known Marathi spellings. No Marathi answer bank is visible.

Before you move on

Stop after three rows.

25.6 Repair endings before values

Cover the values. Look only at the labels and say: neuter drink -ते, feminine activity -ती, neuter name -चे.

Writing — bounded agreement repair

Complete only these endings: आवड___ पेय · आवड___ कृती · मित्रा___ नाव. Do not rewrite tea, reading, or Mira. This pass repairs grammar separately from value spelling.

Before you move on

Stop before values return.

25.7 Delay the first three entries

Read Profile A once: Arun, Pune, Marathi. Close it and wait ten seconds.

Writing — delayed controlled composition

With only the three printed Marathi labels visible, fill all three values from the delayed profile. There is no romanization and no completed row to copy. Compare only after all three values are written.

Before you move on

Stop after one delayed attempt.

25.8 Delay the last three entries

Read Profile A once: tea, reading, Mira. Close it and wait ten seconds.

Writing — delayed controlled composition

Fill the three values with only the blank form visible. Compare in two passes afterward: requested value first, then the printed -ते / -ती / -चे forms.

Before you move on

Stop after one delayed attempt.

25.9 Join the two halves

Keep Profile A visible. The first three and last three rows have already passed separately; today the only new load is joining them.

Writing — supported six-field composition

Complete the six blank Marathi rows from the support-language profile. There is no Marathi value bank or completed example. Check rows 1–3, pause, then rows 4–6. Repair only the first failed half.

Before you move on

The independent profile changes next time.

25.10 Complete a new six-field form

Profile B says: **name Mira; city Pune; language Marathi; favorite drink milk; favorite activity writing; friend Arun.** These meanings are the task. No Marathi values are displayed.

Writing — independent controlled composition

Complete the six printed Marathi labels from Profile B. There is **no romanization, Marathi answer bank, or completed model**. Do not reveal the answer while scoring. The task is untimed; timing belongs to the later checkpoint issue.

Before you move on

This proves untimed practical-form composition only. It does not claim timed writing or full A1 readiness.

Chapter 26

Give, Bring, Put

Modes: ⇨ voice (1) 👁 eyes (4) ⇨ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for four everyday actions in Marathi – give, drink, bring, put – and name the Indo-European root under each.

Complete MR-R22-request-verbs and ask, unaided, for water to be given, tea to be brought, and milk to be put down, each with the polite kripaya frame.

26.1 देणे (deṇe) — to give

You can already ask for a thing by naming it: पाणी, कृपया. That request has no verb in it at all. Here is the verb it was doing without.

You’ll want to know: देणे

देणे — *deṇe* — to give

Asked of someone, it comes out as द्या *dyā* — “give,” said the way you would say it to a person you are being polite to.

पाणी द्या, कृपया. — *pāṇī dyā, kṛpayā.* — Give water, please.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. द *da* came with *dhanyavād*; े is the familiar *e* mark; ण has arrived with every -णे verb so far. दे-णे. In द्या the same द is bound to य by the halant you already write.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देणे continues Sanskrit ददाति *dadāti*, on the root दा *dā-*, “to give.” Behind that stands Indo-European **deh₃-*, and Latin took it up as *dare*. Three English words come out of that one Latin verb: **donate**, **dative** — the giving-case — and **data**, which began as *data*, “things given.” Greek’s own form of the root, *dídōmi*, is hiding in **antidote**: the thing given against.

Your turn

- Say it: **deṇe** — to give
- Say it: **pāṇī dyā, kṛpayā.** — give water, please
- Name: three English words standing on the same root — **donate**, **dative**, **data**

Before you move on

Ask someone to give you water, politely. (**Pāṇī dyā, kṛpayā.**)
What did Latin *data* mean before it meant numbers? (**Things given.**)
Sources: Wiktionary: देणे; Wiktionary: दा.

26.2 पिणे (piṇe) — to drink

देणे is what you ask another person to do. This one is what you do yourself, with पाणी, with चहा, with दूध.

You’ll want to know: पिणे

पिणे — *piṇe* — to drink

मी पाणी पितो / पिते. — *mī pāṇī pito / pite.* — I drink water.

The ending still declares who is speaking: *-to* from a man, *-te* from a woman, the same gendered present you have carried since the first verbs.

The letters in this word

प *pa* you have from *punhā* and from *pāṇī*; ि is the short *i* mark that leans in front of its consonant even though the sound follows it; ण closes it as always. पि-णे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

When you learned पाणी, you learned that it was built on पा *pā-*, “to drink,” and that Indo-European **peh₃(i)-* underneath it surfaces in English **potion**, **poison** and **symposium**. पिणे is that same root standing on its own: Sanskrit पिबति *pibati*, “he drinks.” So the word for water and the word for drinking are one word twice — the thing and the doing.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **piṇe** — to drink
- *Say it:* **mī pāṇī pito** or **mī pāṇī pite**, whichever declares you
- *Run through:* the same sentence with **chahā**, then with **dūdh**
- *Say it:* which earlier word carries this very root — **pāṇī**

Before you move on

Say “I drink tea” for your own gender. (**Mī chahā pito** / **pite**.)

Which word you already knew is built on the same root as पिणे?

(पाणी.)

Sources: Wiktionary: पिणे; Wiktionary: पिबति.

26.3 आणणे (āṇṇe) — to bring

जाणे and येणे were one root with a small piece added to the front of the second. That small piece turns up again here.

You'll want to know: आणणे

आणणे — *āṇṇe* — to bring

चहा आणा, कृपया. — *chahā āṇā, kṛpayā*. — **Bring tea, please.**

देणे hands a thing over. आणणे carries it here first.

The letters in this word

आ is the standing long *ā* you write at the head of आहे; then ण twice, the retroflex you have been writing since the first infinitive; then े. आ-ण-णे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आणणे continues Sanskrit आनयति *ānayati*, and that word comes apart into two pieces you have both met. नी *nī-* means “to lead.” आ *ā-* means “toward here” — the very prefix that made येणे, “to come,” out of the bare root for going. So bringing, in Marathi as in Sanskrit, is **leading a thing toward here**: the same shape of thought, built twice with the same brick.

Your turn

- Say it: *āṇṇe* — to bring
- Say it: *chahā āṇā, kṛpayā*. — bring tea, please
- Contrast: *dyā* and *āṇā* — handing over against carrying here
- Say it: which prefix *āṇṇe* shares with *yeṇe* — *ā-*, “toward here”

Before you move on

Ask for tea to be brought. (*Chahā āṇā, kṛpayā*.) What did the root नी mean on its own? (**To lead.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: आणणे; Wiktionary: नी.

26.4 ठेवणे (*ṭhevṇe*) — to put, to keep

द्या hands a thing over. आणा carries it here. The fourth request in this run asks for it to be set down and left there.

You'll want to know: ठेवणे

ठेवणे — *ṭhevṇe* — to put, to keep

दूध ठेवा. — *dūdh ṭhevā.* — Put the milk down.

The same verb covers keeping: what you put down and do not take back, you have kept.

The letters in this word

ठ is the breathy retroflex *ṭha* — tongue curled back, then a puff. े and व and णे are all familiar. ठे-व-णे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ठेवणे comes through Prakrit **ṭhavei** from Sanskrit *sthāpayati*, “causes to stand.” Prakrit had no taste for the *sth-* cluster and traded it for a single retroflex ठ, which is why the Marathi word looks nothing like its Sanskrit parent — a worn-down word, the *tadbhava* kind, beside the taken-up-whole kind you met with मित्र.

Underneath sits the root *sthā-*, “to stand,” from Indo-European ***steh₂-**. English holds four pieces of it: **stand**, **stay**, **state** and **statue**. Putting a thing down, in this family of languages, has meant making it stand for a very long time.

Your turn

- Say it: **ṭhevṇe** — to put, to keep
- Say it: **dūdh ṭhevā.** — put the milk down
- Run through: **dyā**, **āṇā**, **ṭhevā** in order — give, bring, put
- Name: four English words standing on **ṭhevṇe**’s deepest root — **stand**, **stay**, **state**, **statue**

Before you move on

Ask for the milk to be put down. (**Dūdh ṭhevā.**) What did the Sanskrit root under ठेवणे mean? (**To stand.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: ठेवणे; Wiktionary: sthā.

26.5 Four asked-for actions

Say the four infinitives in order: देणे, पिणे, आणणे, ठेवणे.

Your turn

Answer once, then repair only the piece that went missing.

Before you move on

Which of the four shares its root with पाणी? (पिणे.) Which one is built on a root meaning “to stand”? (ठेवणे.) Then stop.

Chapter 27

Sit, and How You Feel

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) ◉ eyes (4) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can run a short visit in Marathi – seat my guest, say how I feel on the dative frame, say that I am sleepy, and accept an offer with chalel.

Complete MR-R23-wellbeing-verbs and produce the whole small scene from memory: basa, mala baram vatam, chalel – then name which of the four verbs Marathi built for itself rather than inheriting.

27.1 बसणे (basṇe) — to sit

The last run of words was about things. This one is about how a person is doing — and it opens with what a Marathi household says to a visitor before anything else.

You'll want to know: बसणे

बसणे — *basṇe* — to sit

बसा. — *basā.* — Please sit.

One word, and it is hospitality: said at the door, it means *you are welcome, stay a while.*

मी बसतो / बसते. — *mī basto / baste.* — I sit.

The letters in this word

ब the quiet *ba*, स the *sa* of *namaskār*, and णे as ever. ब-स-णे. Nothing here is new to your hand.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बसणे comes through Prakrit **vaisai** from Sanskrit उपविशति *upaviśati*, “sits down” — उप *upa-*, “down, near,” on विश् *viś-*, “to enter, to settle in.”

That settling root is Indo-European **weyk-*, which named the dwelling and then the group of people in it. Latin took it as *vīcus*, a village or a quarter of a town, and English carries it, worn thin, at the end of place names: **Norwich**, **Warwick**, **Ipswich**. To sit down and to settle a village turn out to be the same idea at two sizes.

Your turn

- Say it: **basṇe** — to sit
- Say it: **basā.** — please sit, the way a host says it
- Say it: **mī basto** or **mī baste**, whichever declares you
- Name: what Latin *vīcus* meant — **a village**

Before you move on

Invite someone to sit. (**Basā.**) What did the root under बसणे mean before it meant sitting? (**To settle, to enter a dwelling.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: बसणे; Wiktionary: विश्.

27.2 वाटणे (vāṭṇe) — to feel, to seem

Two verbs you own put you in the dative rather than the nominative: मला मराठी आवडते and मला माहीत आहे. A third one joins them now, and it is the one you answer *how are you* with.

You'll want to know: वाटणे

वाटणे — *vāṭṇe* — to feel, to seem

मला बरं वाटतं. — *malā baram vāṭṭamī*. — I feel fine.

Grammar Lens: the third verb that puts you in the dative

Word for word, मला बरं वाटतं is *to-me fine seems*. You are not the one doing the feeling; the feeling arrives at you, and मला *malā* is where it lands. Three sentences now stand on that one frame:

- मला माहीत आहे — to me it is known
- मला मराठी आवडते — to me Marathi is pleasing
- मला बरं वाटतं — to me fine seems

Marathi keeps saying that what happens inside a person happens *to* them. Once that click lands, a whole family of verbs opens at once.

The letters in this word

व, ा, ट — the retroflex *ṭa*, tongue curled back — then णे. वा-ट-णे. In वाटतं the final तं carries the neuter ending that बरं also wears.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **vāṭṭe** — to feel, to seem
- *Say it:* **malā baram vāṭṭamī**. — I feel fine
- *Run through:* the three dative sentences in order — **malā māhīt āhe**, **malā marāṭhī āvaḍte**, **malā baram vāṭṭamī**
- *Say it:* what **malā** does in all three — it is where the feeling arrives
- *Recall:* बरं on its own, the agreeing word you have had since the first courtesy run, and hear it doing new work inside this sentence

Before you move on

Say that you feel fine. (**Malā baram vāṭṭamī**.) Translated word for word, what does that sentence say? (**To me fine seems**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: वाटणे.

27.3 झोपणे (jhopṇe) — to sleep

डोळा turned out not to be the old inherited eye-word at all — Marathi had swapped it for something else entirely. That happened more than once, and here is the second case.

You'll want to know: झोपणे

झोपणे — *jhopṇe* — to sleep

The noun sits inside it: झोप *jhop*, “sleep.”

मला झोप येते. — *malā jhop yete*. — I am sleepy.

Word for word: *to me sleep comes*. The dative frame you met a moment ago is already back at work, and the form carrying it is येते — the very leave-taking word you learned in your first courtesy run, doing a different job here.

The letters in this word

झ is the breathy *jha* you have from *mājhami*; ो the familiar *o* mark; प and णे are old friends. झो-प-णे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The inherited Indo-Aryan verb for sleeping is Sanskrit स्वपिति *svapiti*, and Hindi still uses its descendant: सोना *sonā*. Behind it stands Indo-European **swep-*, which Latin took as *sopor*, “deep sleep” — so English **soporific** is a cousin of Hindi’s word for going to bed. Marathi’s झोपणे is not that word. It rests on native झोप, whose pre-Marathi ancestry is not securely established, and this lesson does not invent one for it. What can be said is the pattern: with the eye, and again with sleep, Marathi let the inherited word go and built on something of its own.

Your turn

- Say it: **jhopṇe** — to sleep
- Say it: **malā jhop yete**. — I am sleepy, “to me sleep comes”

- *Run through:* **basā**, then **malā barami vāṭṭam**, then **malā jhop yete**
- *Name:* the English word that is cousin to Hindi's sleep-word — **soporific**

Before you move on

Say that you are sleepy. (**Malā jhop yete.**) Is झोपणे the same word as Hindi's सोना? (**No** — Marathi built its own, as it did with the eye.)

Sources: Wiktionary: झोप; Wiktionary: svapiti.

27.4 चालणे (chālṇe) — to walk, and the yes that comes out of it

विचार rested on a root meaning *to turn, to move about*. Its close relative walks in here on its own two feet.

You'll want to know: चालणे

चालणे — *chālṇe* — to walk, to go along

मी चालतो / चालते. — *mī chālto / chālṭe.* — I walk.

The letters in this word

च before ा lands closer to English *ts* than to *ch* in most Marathi mouths, so चा is nearer *tsā* — the same thing that happens in *chār*. Then ल and णे. चा-ल-णे.

Grammar Lens: the yes that means it will walk

चालेल. — *chālel.* — That will do. / Fine by me.

Formally this is the verb in the future: *it will walk*. In use it is one of the commonest small yeses in the language — offered a time, a plan, a cup of tea, you answer चालेल and the matter is settled. Beside बरं, which agrees, चालेल accepts.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चालणे continues Sanskrit चलति *calati*, “moves, stirs,” on the root चल् *cal-*, which is widely taken to be a variant of चर् *car-*, “to move about” — the root you already met sitting inside विचार. Sanskrit चंचल *cañcala*, “restless,” is built on the same piece. So thinking and walking, in this language, are two speeds of one old verb for moving.

Your turn

- Say it: **chālṇe** — to walk
- Say it: **mī chālto** or **mī chālte**, whichever declares you
- Say it: **chālel.** — that will do
- Run through: someone asks how you are; answer **malā baranī vāṭṭamī**, then accept their offer with **chālel**

Before you move on

Accept an offer in one word. (**Chālel.**) What is चालेल literally? (**It will walk.**) Which word you already knew stands on the same moving root? (विचार.)

Sources: Wiktionary: चालणे; Wiktionary: चलति.

27.5 One visit, four verbs

Say the four infinitives in order: बसणे, वाटणे, झोपणे, चालणे.

Your turn

Run it once as a small scene, then repair only what went missing.

Before you move on

Which of the four is a word Marathi built for itself instead of keeping the inherited one? (झोपणे.) Which one goes back to a root for settling a dwelling? (बसणे.) When you answer that you are well, which word carries the “well”? (बरं.) And which body word have you met for the place feeling is said to sit? (हृदय.) Then stop.

Chapter 28

What Passes Between Two People

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask someone to tell me their name, quote what I said, say that I am learning Marathi, and ask whether a thing is to be had – carrying one of the four by ear because its letter is still owed to me.

Complete MR-R24-passing-verbs and run the exchange unaided: ask for a name with the by-ear verb, say you are learning Marathi, and ask whether water is to be had.

28.1 sāṅṇe — to tell, by ear first

You have asked someone’s name with a whole question. There is a shorter way, and it turns on a verb you have not met.

You’ll want to know: sāṅṇe

sāṅṇe — **to tell**

Asked of a person you are being polite to, it comes out *sāṅgā*:

tumchamī nāv sāṅgā. — **Tell me your name.**

Two syllables, and it does the work your longer question was doing.

The letters in this word

This word is here **by ear only**, on purpose. Its middle consonant is *ga* — a letter this book has shown you inside other words but has never taught your hand to make, and asking you to read a shape nobody taught you would be the one thing a gentle ramp must not do.

So carry *sāṅḡe* the way a child carries a word off a shop sign: sayable, understandable, useful today, and readable later. The letter is owed to you, and it is written down as owed.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sāṅḡe comes through Prakrit *saṅgai* from Sanskrit *śaṃsati*, “recites, proclaims,” on the root *śaṃs-*. Behind that sits Indo-European ***kens-**, “to proclaim, to declare,” which Latin took up as *cēnseō*, “I assess, I declare.” Two English words fall out of that Latin verb: **census** — the formal declaring of who lives where — and **ensor**, the official who did the declaring. Telling someone your name is, at root, the same act as being counted.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāṅḡe* — to tell
- *Say it: tumchaṇi nāv sāṅḡā.* — tell me your name
- *Run through: basā*, then *tumchaṇi nāv sāṅḡā* — seat your visitor, then ask
- *Name:* two English words on the same root — **census**, **ensor**

Before you move on

Ask someone to tell you their name. (*Tumchaṇi nāv sāṅḡā.*) What did the Sanskrit root mean? (**To recite, to proclaim.**) Why is this word not printed here in its own script? (**Its *ga* has not been taught yet.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: sāṅḡe; Wiktionary: shams-.

28.2 म्हणणे (mhaṇṇe) — to say these words

The last word arrived by ear alone, with one letter still owed to your hand. This one owes you nothing: every piece of it is already yours to write.

You'll want to know: म्हणणे

म्हणणे — *mhaṇṇe* — to say

मी “नमस्कार” म्हणतो / म्हणते. — *mī* “*namaskār*” *mhaṇto* / *mhaṇte*.
— I say “*namaskār*.”

Two verbs, two jobs. *Sāṅṅe* tells a person something. म्हणणे utters the words themselves — what came out of the mouth, quoted.

The letters in this word

म bound to ह by the halant you have written since नमस्कार, then ण twice, then े. म्ह-ण-णे. Say it with the breath and the *m* together, not one after the other.

The same verb gives म्हणून *mhaṇūn*, “therefore” — literally *having said that*, which is how a good many Marathi sentences turn a corner.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

म्हणणे comes through Prakrit **bhaṇai** from Sanskrit भणति *bhaṇati*, “speaks.” The opening भ *bh-* did something Marathi is fond of: it shifted to the म्ह *mh-* cluster, breath and nasal at once. Hindi kept a plainer descendant in *bhannā*. Set beside *sāṅṅe*, which came from a root for proclaiming, Marathi ended up with one verb for reciting outward and one for plain uttering.

Your turn

- Say it: म्हणणे — to say
- Say it: मी “*namaskār*” म्हणतो or म्हणते, whichever declares you
- Contrast: *sāṅṅā* and म्हणतो — telling a person, uttering the words
- Write it: म्हणणे, and notice that every piece was already yours

- *Read aloud:* नमस्कार, whose halant and whose र you are reusing here

Before you move on

Which Sanskrit consonant became Marathi's म्ह? (भ *bh*-.) What does म्हणून mean? (**Therefore** — “having said that”).

Sources: Wiktionary: म्हणणे; Wiktionary: भणति.

28.3 शिकणे (shikṇe) — to learn

You can tell someone your name and you can quote what you said. The sentence a beginner most wants next is the one about what they are doing right now.

You'll want to know: शिकणे

शिकणे — *shikṇe* — to learn

मी मराठी शिकतो / शिकते. — *mī marāṭhī shikto / shikte*. — **I am learning Marathi.**

Said to a stranger in Maharashtra, that sentence usually ends the awkward part of the conversation and starts the good part.

The letters in this word

श the *sha* you write in कशी, then ि, then क, then णे. शि-क-णे. Keep श and the retroflex ष apart in your ear: this word takes the softer one.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शिकणे continues Sanskrit शिक्षते *śikṣate*, and that form is not a plain verb: it is the **desiderative** of शक् *śak*-, “to be able.” A desiderative is the shape Sanskrit puts a root into to mean *wanting to do it*. So *to learn* was built, quite literally, as **to want to be able**.

Two familiar words fall out of the same root: शक्ति *śakti*, “power, what one is able to do,” and शिक्षा *śikṣā*, “instruction.” Every one of them is the same idea turned a different way.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **shikṇe** — to learn
- *Say it:* **mī marāṭhī shikto** or **shikte**, whichever declares you
- *Say it:* what the Sanskrit root under it meant — **to be able**
- *Run through:* **mī “namaskār” mhaṇto**, then **mī marāṭhī shikto**

Before you move on

Say that you are learning Marathi. (**Mī marāṭhī shikto / shikte.**) What does शक्ति mean, and how is it related? (**Power** — the same root, without the wanting.)

Sources: Wiktionary: शिकणे; Wiktionary: शक्.

28.4 मिळणे (miḷṇe) — to be got, to be found

मला बरं वाटतं put the feeling at you rather than in you. One more everyday verb works the same way, and it is the one you need in a shop.

You’ll want to know: मिळणे

मिळणे — *miḷṇe* — to be got, to be found, to be available

पाणी मिळेल का? — *pāṇī miḷel kā?* — **Is water to be had?**

मला मिळतं. — *malā miḷtami.* — **I get it.**

Word for word the second one is *to me it is got*. English makes the person the getter; Marathi makes the thing the one that arrives. That is now the fourth sentence standing on the same dative frame.

The letters in this word

म, ि, then ळ — the retroflex *l* that Hindi lost and Marathi kept, the letter inside डोळा and काळजी — then णे. मि-ळ-णे. Curl the tongue back for ळ and let it flap.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिळणे continues Sanskrit मिलति *milati*, “meets, joins, comes together.” The Sanskrit *l* hardened on the way into Marathi and came out as ळ. The sense travelled too: what *joins* you is what you *get*, so a verb about meeting became the ordinary verb for a thing being available. Hindi’s मिलना *milnā* kept both senses side by side and kept the plain *l*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **miḷṇe** — to be got
- *Say it:* **pāṇī miḷel kā?** — is water to be had?
- *Run through:* the four dative sentences — **malā mähīt āhe**, **malā marāṭhī āvaḍte**, **malā baram vāṭtam**, **malā miḷtam**
- *Name:* the other two words you know carrying ळ

Before you move on

Ask whether water is to be had. (**Pāṇī miḷel kā?**) What did the Sanskrit verb behind मिळणे mean? (**To meet, to join.**)
Sources: Wiktionary: मिळणे; Wiktionary: मिलति.

28.5 Four things that pass between two people

Say the four in order: *sāṅgne*, then म्हणणे, शिकणे, मिळणे. Three of them you can also write; one is still owed a letter.

Your turn

Run the three aloud, then repair only what went missing.

Before you move on

Which of the four was built out of *wanting to be able*? (शिकणे.)
Which one puts you in the dative? (मिळणे.) Then stop.

Chapter 29

The Twelve, Further Apart

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can produce all twelve of the new verbs at a wider spacing, and say what the mala frame does in each of the four sentences built on it.

Complete MR-R25-dative-frame and produce feeling, sleepiness, and getting on one dative frame, then say word for word what mala is doing in each.

29.1 The twelve, further apart

The four you ask for: देणे, पिणे, आणणे, ठेवणे. Say them without looking anywhere.

Your turn

Then the four that pass between two people: *sāṅṅe*, म्हणणे, शिकणे, मिळणे.

Before you move on

Twelve verbs, three runs of four. Say the one you would use to accept an offer. (**Chālel.**) Say the one you would use to ask for water. (**Dyā.**) Then stop.

29.2 One frame, four sentences

मला is where things arrive. Say the two oldest ones: मला माहीत आहे, मला मराठी आवडते.

Your turn

Say each one, then say the word-for-word English under it.

Before you move on

What does मला do in every one of these? (It is where the knowing, the liking, the feeling and the getting arrive.) And name the body word this book gave you for where feeling is said to sit. (हृदय.) Then stop.

29.3 Recognition at distance: two signs and one sound

The first two shapes this book ever asked you to make were ह and the ो mark, and together they wrote हो. Make them both from memory.

Your turn

Say चालणे and चार one after the other and hear the same leaning in both.

Before you move on

Write हो once without a model, say चार with its leaning consonant, then stop.

29.4 Recognition at distance: five things from further back

Count to five out loud — *ek, don, tīn, chār, pāch* — and then put आहे at the end of a sentence about yourself, where Marathi keeps it.

Your turn

Both were taken up from Sanskrit whole rather than worn down, and कुटुंब takes a gender Hindi does not give it.

Before you move on

Say that Marathi is understandable to you (मला मराठी समजते) and then that you are learning it (मी मराठी शिकतो / शिकते). What did मित्र's root mean before it meant friend? (**To bind.**) Then stop.

Devanagari for Marathi — a reference

Not to be read before the lessons — they teach reading through real words. This page gathers the system, and flags what is special about *Marathi's* Devanagari.

The three facts

1. **Consonants carry a built-in “a.”** क ka, न na, म ma.
2. **A vowel sign (*mātrā*) changes it:** का k̄a, कि k̄i, की k̄ī, कु ku, के ke, को ko, कौ kau.
3. **A *halant* removes it,** and the bare consonant joins the next as a conjunct: स् + का → स्का; न् + य → न्य. The *anusvāra* dot ण̣ nasalises a vowel (बरं *barṇ*).

What is special about Marathi's Devanagari

- **The extra letter ऌ (*ḷa*)** — a **retroflex l**, made with the tongue curled back. Hindi does *not* have it; Marathi shares it with the Dravidian languages to the south (Tamil *ḷ*, Kannada, etc.), a mark of centuries of contact. It appears in common words like *kāḷ* (“time”) and *phāḷ* (“fruit”).
- **The vowel अँ / ऐँ** for the English “a” of *cat* — added for English loanwords (*bṇk*, “bank”).
- **Three genders.** Marathi keeps Sanskrit's masculine, feminine, *and* neuter, where Hindi collapsed to two — and it marks gender on verbs and adjectives more thoroughly than Hindi.

Marathi in the family

Marathi is **Indo-Aryan** (like Hindi, Punjabi, Bengali — descended from Sanskrit), spoken in Maharashtra. Its Devanagari and much of its formal vocabulary are shared with Hindi and Sanskrit; its sound system, its extra letter ष, and parts of its grammar bear the imprint of long contact with Dravidian. The lessons trace both threads.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

आहे *āhe*

is (āhe)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

आणणे *āṇṇe*

to bring — leading, with the same little prefix that turned going into coming

Introduced in Chapter 26.

असणे *asṇe*

to be — the verb behind **आहे**, the word a Marathi sentence ends on

Introduced in Chapter 14.

आवडणे *āvadṇe*

to like — a native Marathi verb that puts you in the dative, beside **प्रेम करणे**, to love

Introduced in Chapter 16.

बहीण *bahīṇ*

sister — worn down like **भाऊ**, but deliberately not its English counterpart's cousin

Introduced in Chapter 18.

बरं *baram*

okay / fine (baram)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

बसणे *basṇe*

to sit — the first word a Marathi host says to you, and a root that named villages

Introduced in Chapter 27.

भाकरी *bhākārī*

a round flatbread — the one word in this chapter that never left Marathi's own neighborhood, and Hindi's word for bread altogether

Introduced in Chapter 17.

भाऊ *bhāū*

brother — worn down by sound change rather than borrowed whole, and a secure cousin of the English word
Introduced in Chapter 18.

भेटू *bheṭū*

(we'll) meet (bheṭū)
Introduced in Chapter 11.

भेटून आनंद झाला *bheṭūn ānand jhālā*

pleased to meet you (bheṭūn ānand jhālā)
Introduced in Chapter 9.

बोलणे *bolṇe*

to speak (bolṇe)
Introduced in Chapter 12.

चहा *chahā*

tea — the one request in this chapter that is not inherited at all, and Marathi's first masculine noun
Introduced in Chapter 17.

चालणे *chālṇe*

to walk, to go along — and the everyday yes that means it will walk
Introduced in Chapter 27.

देणे *deṇe*

to give — the verb the request pattern had been doing without
Introduced in Chapter 26.

धन्यवाद *dhanyavad*

thank you (dhanyavād)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

डोळा *ḍoḷā*

eye — carrying Marathi's signature extra letter ढ, and a word that started life meaning something else entirely
Introduced in Chapter 19.

दूध *dūdh*

milk — back to inherited Sanskrit, and the same PIE root behind English doughty
Introduced in Chapter 17.

एक दोन तीन चार पाच *ek don tīn chār pāch*

one to five — nearly Hindi's, with two tells in the spelling and one in the sound
Introduced in Chapter 13.

घेणे *gheṇe*

to take — the verb hiding inside “take care,” on the Indo-European root behind English grab
Introduced in Chapter 16.

हो *ho*

yes (ho)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

हृदय *hrdaya*

heart — the surest cognate taught so far, and a new vowel sign that has waited thirteen chapters

Introduced in Chapter 20.

जाणे *jāṇe*

to go — and the present tense you cannot say without declaring your own gender

Introduced in Chapter 14.

झोपणे *jhopṇe*

to sleep — another inherited word Marathi let go of, where Hindi kept it

Introduced in Chapter 27.

काही हरकत नाही *kāhī harkat nāhī*

no problem / you're welcome (kāhī harkat nāhī)

Introduced in Chapter 10.

काळजी घ्या *kāḷjī ghyā*

take care (kāḷjī ghyā)

Introduced in Chapter 11.

काम करणे *kām karṇe*

to work (kām karṇe)

Introduced in Chapter 12.

कान *kān*

ear — a consonant cluster simplified the same way don copied teen, and a root disputed among Sanskrit scholars

Introduced in Chapter 19.

कसा / कशी / कसं *kasā / kaśī / kasam*

how (kasā m. / kaśī f. / kasam n.)

Introduced in Chapter 10.

काय *kāy*

what (kāy)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

खाणे *khāṇe*

to eat — and an infinitive that doubles as a noun of the third gender Hindi lost

Introduced in Chapter 14.

कुटुंब *kuṭumb*

family — another word borrowed whole from Sanskrit, and neuter where Hindi made the same word masculine

Introduced in Chapter 18.

लिहिणे *lihine*

to write — from a root that meant “to scratch,” and the chapter’s four verbs run back together

Introduced in Chapter 15.

मदत करणे *madat karṇe*

to help — an Arabic word for “reinforcements” that came through Persian and took करणे

Introduced in Chapter 16.

माहीत असणे *māhīt asṇe*

to know — built as “is known to me”, so the knower is never the subject

Introduced in Chapter 14.

माझं *mājhami*

my (*mājhami*, neuter)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

माझं नाव ... आहे *mājhami nāv ... āhe*

my name is... (*mājhami nāv ... āhe*)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

म्हणणे *mhaṇṇe*

to say these words — the readable partner of the verb you took by ear

Introduced in Chapter 28.

मी *mī*

I (*mī*)

Introduced in Chapter 10.

मी बरा आहे *mī barā āhe*

I’m well, thank you (*mī barā āhe*)

Introduced in Chapter 10.

मी मराठी बोलतो *mī marāṭhī bolto*

I speak Marathi (gendered)

Introduced in Chapter 12.

मिळणे *miḷṇe*

to be got, to be found — a fourth verb that puts you in the dative, and it carries ळ

Introduced in Chapter 28.

मित्र *mitra*

friend — taken up whole from Sanskrit rather than worn down, and a cousin of the god-name Mithra

Introduced in Chapter 18.

नाही *nahi*

no / is not (*nāhī*)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

नाक *nāk*

nose — completing the face, and the one of the four with the most secure English cousin

Introduced in Chapter 19.

नमस्कार *namaskar*

hello / goodbye (namaskār)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

नाव *nāv*

name (nāv)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

पाहणे *pāhṇe*

to see — from Sanskrit paś-, the root that reached English as spectacle, inspect and spy

Introduced in Chapter 14.

पाणी *pāṇī*

water — the first thing you would actually ask for, and the request pattern that opens a spine node this track had never realized

Introduced in Chapter 17.

पिणे *piṇe*

to drink — the verb that was already inside the word for water

Introduced in Chapter 26.

पुन्हा *punhā*

again (punhā)

Introduced in Chapter 11.

पुन्हा भेटू *punhā bheṭū*

see you again (punhā bheṭū)

Introduced in Chapter 11.

राहणे *rāhṇe*

to live, to stay (rāhṇe)

Introduced in Chapter 12.

समजणे *samajṇe*

to understand — built on the root that gave the Buddha his name, and taking the dative like knowing

Introduced in Chapter 15.

सांगणे *sāṅṇe*

to tell — a word you can use by ear today, whose last consonant your hand has not been taught yet

Introduced in Chapter 28.

शिकणे *shikṇe*

to learn — built, at root, out of wanting to be able

Introduced in Chapter 28.

ठेवणे *thevṇe*

to put, to keep — a standing word, worn down from Sanskrit through Prakrit
Introduced in Chapter 26.

तोंड *tōḍ*

mouth — the everyday word, beside a formal Sanskrit doublet you already
half-know

Introduced in Chapter 19.

तू / तुम्ही *tū / tumhī*

you (*tū* familiar / *tumhī* respectful)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

तुमचं नाव काय आहे? *tumcham̐ nāv kāy āhe?*

what's your name? (*tumcham̐ nāv kāy āhe?*)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

तुम्ही कसे आहात? *tumhī kase āhāt?*

how are you? (*tumhī kase āhāt?*)

Introduced in Chapter 10.

उद्या भेटू *udyā bheṭū*

see you tomorrow (*udyā bheṭū*)

Introduced in Chapter 11.

वाचणे *vāchṇe*

to read — from a causative meaning “to make speak,” cousin of voice and vocal

Introduced in Chapter 15.

वाटणे *vāṭṇe*

to feel, to seem — the answer to how are you, built the way liking and knowing
were

Introduced in Chapter 27.

विचार करणे *vichār karṇe*

to think — literally “to do a thought,” on a root that means turning something
over

Introduced in Chapter 15.

विचारणे *vichārṇe*

to ask — the word for thinking with an infinitive ending on it, so asking and
thinking share a root

Introduced in Chapter 16.

येणे *yeṇe*

to come — the same Sanskrit going-root as जाणे, turned around by one small
prefix

Introduced in Chapter 14.

येतो / येते *yeto / yete*

“I’ll be going” (*yeto* m. / *yete* f.)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 ह — *the consonant ha*

Trace the visible Devanagari consonant once, then name its built-in vowel.

1.2 ी — *the vowel sign that replaces the inherent a*

Copy the visible Marathi word for yes once, then name its two pieces.

1.3 हो — *look, hide, write, compare*

After hiding the model for five seconds, write the Marathi word for yes and then compare it.

1.4 One heard answer — *write what you know*

From the heard cue ho alone, write the known Marathi word for yes.

Chapter 2

2.1 ः — *a small breath after a vowel*

Copy the visible two-dot breath sign once.

2.2 आ — *long aa standing alone*

Copy the visible independent long-aa sign once, finishing with the headline.

2.3 भ — *bha, with a puff of breath*

Copy the visible breathy-b consonant once.

2.4 े — *e above the headline*

Copy the e mark, then retrieve the three preceding signs by name.

2.5 ँ — *one nasal dot*

Copy the visible one-dot nasal sign once.

2.6 त — dental ta

After a five-second delay, write dental ta from memory.

Chapter 3**3.1 द — dental da**

Write dental da after a delay, then retrieve the previous three sign names.

3.2 ध — dha, voiced and breathy

Write dha after a delay, then retrieve visarga, independent aa, and bha by name.

3.3 ब — ba without the puff

Write the consonant you hear: ba, without a puff.

3.4 य — ya

Write ya from sound, then retrieve da, dha, and ba by name.

3.5 ऌ — Marathi's curled-back lla

Write curled-back lla from sound, then retrieve e-mark, anusvara, and ta.

3.6 व — between English v and w

Write the consonant you hear: va.

3.7 धन्यवाद — now read what you already mean

Write the Marathi word you hear: dhanyavad. Then name the last three signs in this runway.

Chapter 4**4.1 हो (ho) — “yes”**

Write dhanyavad once, then write da, dha, and ba from their spoken names.

4.2 Chapter 4 — courtesy, responses, and leave-taking

Without a visible model, write the Marathi word you hear: ho (yes).

4.3 Chapter 4 — courtesy, responses, and leave-taking

Read नमस्कार and give its conversational meaning.

4.4 Chapter 4 — courtesy, responses, and leave-taking

From their spoken names, write ya, curled-back lla, and va once.

Chapter 5

5.1 ि — short i, written before, read after

Trace the short-i mark and say where it is written relative to its letter.

5.2 ु — short u, a small hook below

Copy the short-u hook under ta, then name the mark that is written to the left of its letter.

5.3 ू — long ū, the deeper hook below

Write long uu after a delay, then say what separates it from short u.

5.4 ृ — the vocalic r mark, said ru

Copy the vocalic-r curl on ka, then say which direction it opens compared with short u.

5.5 ॠ — the moon holding a dot

Trace the moon-and-dot, then name the mark that is a dot with no crescent.

5.6 अ — the vowel your consonants have been hiding

Write independent short a after a delay, then turn it into long aa.

5.7 Six marks, named without the page

Name the mark that is written left of its letter, the two that hang below, the one that opens the other way, the nasal with a crescent, and the vowel your consonants already hide.

Chapter 6

6.1 ख — ka with the breath let out

Trace aspirated kha, then say what separates it from ka.

6.2 ग — the same place, with the voice on

Copy ga, then write aspirated kha from memory.

6.3 घ — voice and breath together

Write gha after a delay, then name the two things it has that ka does not.

6.4 च — one letter, two Marathi sounds

Copy ca, then name its second Marathi pronunciation.

6.5 छ — the palate, with the breath let out

Trace aspirated chha, then say which earlier pair it copies.

6.6 ज — voice at the palate

Write ja after a delay, then retrieve the two preceding sign names.

6.7 झ — the letter inside mājhe

Copy majhe and name its four signs.

6.8 *Two rows, told apart by voice and breath*

Say the four velar letters in order, then the four palatal ones, naming for each whether voice and breath are on. Then reach back a chapter for the two below-the-line hooks, the vocalic-r curl, the crescent nasal, and the vowel every consonant hides.

Chapter 7**7.1** ढ — *the tongue curled back*

Trace retroflex ta, then say where the tongue goes for it.

7.2 ठ — *the curl, with the breath let out*

Copy aspirated retroflex tha, then write plain retroflex ta from memory.

7.3 ड — *the curl, with the voice on*

Write retroflex da after a delay, then name the plain and aspirated members of its row.

7.4 ण — *the nasal with the tongue curled back*

Copy retroflex na, then write dental na and say which needs the curled tongue.

7.5 प — *the lips, with the voice off*

Write pa after a delay, then name the letter it differs from by one dot.

7.6 *The curled row, and one letter from the lips*

Name the four curled letters in order, the lip letter that differs from ba by one dot, the two marks from two chapters ago by placement, and the plain, breathy and voiced letters of the palate row.

Chapter 8**8.1** ल — *the plain l, beside the curled one you know*

Trace plain la, then name the Marathi letter for the curled l.

8.2 श — *the sh at the roof of the mouth*

Copy palatal sha, then write plain sa from memory.

8.3 ष — *the third sibilant, kept on the page*

Write retroflex sha after a delay, then say how most Marathi speakers pronounce it.

8.4 उ — *short u standing on its own*

Copy independent short u, then say which form needs a consonant to lean on.

8.5 ऊ — *long ū standing on its own*

Write independent long uu after a delay, then name the four forms of this vowel.

8.6 ए — *the vowel that opens ek*

Copy ek, then say which form of this vowel needs a consonant to lean on.

8.7 *Twenty-four signs, at real distance*

Name the plain l beside the curled one, the two sibilants Marathi writes apart and says alike, the three standalone vowels of this chapter, one letter from each of the three consonant rows in this runway, and ba with the voice switched off.

Chapter 9

9.1 *The last six, one chapter on*

A chapter after learning them, name the plain l beside the curled one, the two sibilants written apart but said alike, and the three vowels that stand alone as well as leaning.

Chapter 13

13.1 *Three signs after a durable gap*

Write dhanyavad, visarga, independent aa, and bha after a durable gap.

13.2 *Three more signs after a durable gap*

Write e-mark, anusvara, and ta after a durable gap.

13.3 *Keep three voiced consonants apart*

Write da, dha, and ba after a durable gap.

13.4 *The final three doorway signs*

Write ya, lla, and va after a durable gap.

13.5 *Why Marathi two rhymes with three*

Did Marathi don preserve an ancient final n?

13.6 *The six marks, with the page shut*

Say where each of the six marks goes, and which of the two below-the-line hooks travels further.

13.7 *Two rows, rebuilt from two questions*

Say the four velar letters and the four palatal ones in order, naming the voice and breath state of each.

13.8 *The curled row, without a model*

Name the four curled letters in order and the lip letter that differs from ba by one dot.

13.9 *The last six, without a model*

Name the plain l beside the curled one, the two sibilants written apart but said alike, and the three vowels that also have marks.

Chapter 18

18.1 *One step later — retrieve* मित्र

Give the word for friend, the old root meaning, and its borrowing type.

18.2 *One step later — retrieve* कुटुंब

Give the Marathi word for family and its Marathi gender.

Chapter 21

21.1 *After a gap —* मित्र

Complete: friend = ____; old root = ____; borrowing type = ____.

21.2 *After a gap —* कुटुंब

Give family in Marathi and its Marathi gender.

21.3 *Sibling retrieval*

Say brother and sister, then name the one securely related to English.

21.4 *Eye and ear retrieval*

Give eye and ear in Marathi; identify the special consonant in dola.

21.5 *Mouth and nose retrieval*

Give everyday mouth, its formal doublet, and nose.

21.6 *Three request nouns*

Give water, tea, and milk in Marathi.

21.7 *Three doing verbs*

Give take, ask, and help in Marathi.

21.8 *Three mind-and-page verbs*

Give think, understand, and write in Marathi.

21.9 *Three core verbs*

Give be, go, and come in Marathi.

21.10 *Durable retrieval —* मित्र

After the long gap: friend; root meaning; borrowing type.

21.11 *Count, then notice*

Count one to five and give Marathi's diagnostic pronunciation of four.

21.12 *Durable family comparison*

Give the five-part durable comparison for mitra and kutumb.

Chapter 22

22.1 *The doorway word, much later*

Hear dhanyavad; give its meaning and write it in Devanagari.

22.2 *First batch at long distance*

Write dhanyavad, visarga, independent aa, and bha at long distance.

22.3 *Second batch at long distance*

Write e-mark, anusvara, and ta at long distance.

22.4 *Voiced batch at long distance*

Write da, dha, and ba at long distance.

22.5 *Final batch at long distance*

Write ya, lla, and va at long distance.

22.6 *The six marks, a whole book later*

From their sounds alone, name all six marks and say for each whether it is written before, above, below, or on its own.

22.7 *Two rows, at book distance*

Rebuild both four-step rows from the voice-and-breath pattern, then name the one that sits inside the word for my.

22.8 *The curled row, a whole book later*

Name the four curled letters, say what the dot under a romanized letter means, and name the lip letter that is ba with the voice off.

22.9 *The last six, at book distance*

Name the plain l, the two sibilants said alike, and the three standalone vowels, and say what a letter surviving a merged sound tells you about writing systems.

Chapter 23

23.1 नाव — *the first form label*

Which printed Marathi label asks for the person's name?

23.2 शहर — *the city box*

Which label asks for the city?

23.3 भाषा — *the language box*

Which label asks which language the person uses?

23.4 आवडते पेय — *favorite drink*

Complete the printed label for the neuter word pey: आवड___ पेय

23.5 आवडती कृती — *favorite activity*

Complete the printed label for feminine kruti: आवड___ कृती

23.6 मित्राचे नाव — friend's name

Which label asks for the friend's name?

23.7 Copy the first three rows

Give the three labels in order: name, city, language.

23.8 Copy the last three rows

Complete the two favorite labels: आवड___ पेय; आवड___ कृती.

23.9 Hide, wait, write the first three labels

After a delay, write name, city, language as Marathi form labels.

23.10 Hide, wait, write the last three labels

After a delay, write favorite drink, favorite activity, and friend's name as Marathi form labels.

Chapter 24

24.1 Write to one named reader

Write the greeting line addressed to Mira.

24.2 Add the sender's name

Copy the complete Arun identity line, including punctuation.

24.3 One line for meeting the reader

Write the familiar pleased-to-meet-you line and close it.

24.4 Begin the purpose: Marathi

After a short delay, write the line that says Arun knows Marathi.

24.5 Add one reading line

Write Arun's known Marathi-reading line after a delay.

24.6 Add one writing line

After a delay, write Arun's known name-writing line.

24.7 Add the shortest skill line

Write Arun's speaking line after a delay.

24.8 Keep both pieces of thinking

Write Arun's complete thinking line after a delay.

24.9 Return to the dative frame

After a delay, write the line saying Marathi is understood by Arun.

24.10 One word can be a full line

Write the one-word thanks line with its boundary.

24.11 The first farewell line

Write the see-you-again closing line.

24.12 The dated farewell line

Write the see-you-tomorrow closing line.

24.13 *Order the opening block*

Order and write the three opening lines for Mira and Arun.

24.14 *Order the first three skills*

Write the known know-Marathi, read-Marathi, and write-my-name lines in that order.

24.15 *Order the second three skills*

Write the known speak, think, and understand-Marathi lines in that order.

24.16 *Order the closing block*

Write the thanks, see-you-again, and see-you-tomorrow lines in that order.

24.17 *Connect the four known blocks*

Connect the four practised blocks into the 32-word message for Mira.

24.18 *Independent 30–40-word message*

Without a model, write the practised 30-40-word message to Mira for Arun's introduction and Marathi-study purpose.

Chapter 25

25.1 *Choose the first three answers*

Match the labels to Profile A's details: नाव; शहर; भाषा.

25.2 *Choose the last three answers*

Match the last three labels to Profile A's details.

25.3 *Enter the first three values*

Using Profile A, complete the first three blank rows without a Marathi answer bank.

25.4 *Repair one value, not the whole form*

Write only the first value that needs repair; if none failed, write Profile A's city value once.

25.5 *Enter the last three values*

Using Profile A, complete the last three blank rows without a Marathi answer bank.

25.6 *Repair endings before values*

Supply only the three missing endings: आवड___ पेय; आवड___ कृती; मित्रा___ नाव.

25.7 *Delay the first three entries*

After the delay, complete Profile A's first three rows without an answer model.

25.8 *Delay the last three entries*

After the delay, complete Profile A's last three rows without an answer model.

25.9 *Join the two halves*

With Profile A visible but no Marathi answer bank, complete all six blank rows.

25.10 *Complete a new six-field form*

Without a Marathi value model, complete Profile B's six-field form.

Chapter 26

26.1 *Four asked-for actions*

Ask politely for water to be given, tea to be brought, and milk to be put down.

Chapter 27

27.1 *One visit, four verbs*

Invite someone to sit, say that you feel fine, and accept their offer in one word.

Chapter 28

28.1 *Four things that pass between two people*

Ask for a name, say you are learning Marathi, and ask whether water is to be had.

Chapter 29

29.1 *The twelve, further apart*

Name the four verbs of a visit: sitting, feeling, sleeping, walking.

29.2 *One frame, four sentences*

Say that you feel fine, that you are sleepy, and that you get it — all on the mala frame.

29.3 *Recognition at distance: two signs and one sound*

How is cha said before a long aa in most Marathi mouths?

29.4 *Recognition at distance: five things from further back*

Give friend and family in Marathi, and say which gender kutumb takes.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 ह — *the consonant ha*

Answer: ह — ha, with inherent a

Also accepted: ह; ha; a; inherent a

1.2 ी — *the vowel sign that replaces the inherent a*

Answer: हो — ह plus ी

Also accepted: हो; ह + ी; ह plus ी

1.3 हो — *look, hide, write, compare*

Answer: हो

1.4 One heard answer — *write what you know*

Answer: हो

Chapter 2

2.1 ः — *a small breath after a vowel*

Answer: ः

2.2 आ — *long aa standing alone*

Answer: आ

2.3 भ — *bha, with a puff of breath*

Answer: भ

2.4 े — *e above the headline*

Answer: e mark; visarga; independent aa; bha

2.5 ँ — *one nasal dot*

Answer: ँ

2.6 त — *dental ta*

Answer: त

Chapter 3

3.1 द — *dental da*

Answer: da; e-mark; anusvara; ta

3.2 ध — *dha, voiced and breathy*

Answer: dha; visarga; independent aa; bha

3.3 ब — *ba without the puff*

Answer: ब

3.4 य — *ya*

Answer: ya; da; dha; ba

3.5 ळ — *Marathi's curled-back lla*

Answer: lla; e-mark; anusvara; ta

3.6 व — *between English v and w*

Answer: व

3.7 धन्यवाद — *now read what you already mean*

Answer: धन्यवाद; ya; lla; va

Chapter 4

4.1 हो (*ho*) — “yes”

Answer: धन्यवाद; द ध ब

4.2 Chapter 4 — *courtesy, responses, and leave-taking*

Answer: हो

4.3 Chapter 4 — *courtesy, responses, and leave-taking*

Answer: namaskar; greetings

Also accepted: hello; goodbye; greetings

4.4 Chapter 4 — *courtesy, responses, and leave-taking*

Answer: य ळ व

Chapter 5

5.1 ि — *short i, written before, read after*

Answer: i-matra; written before the letter, read after it

5.2 ु — *short u, a small hook below*

Answer: ु; the short-i matra

5.3 ू — *long ū, the deeper hook below*

Answer: ू; the long hook goes deeper and turns back

5.4 ृ — *the vocalic r mark, said ru*

Answer: ृ; it opens the other way

5.5 ँ — *the moon holding a dot*

Answer: candrabindu; the anusvara

5.6 अ — *the vowel your consonants have been hiding*

Answer: अ; आ

5.7 *Six marks, named without the page*

Answer: i-matra; u-matra and uu-matra; the vocalic-r curl; candrabindu; independent a

Chapter 6

6.1 ख — *ka with the breath let out*

Answer: ख; kha releases a puff of breath, ka does not

6.2 ग — *the same place, with the voice on*

Answer: ग; ख

6.3 घ — *voice and breath together*

Answer: घ; voice and breath

6.4 च — *one letter, two Marathi sounds*

Answer: च; ts

6.5 छ — *the palate, with the breath let out*

Answer: छ; ka and kha

6.6 ज — *voice at the palate*

Answer: ज; chha; ca

6.7 झ — *the letter inside mājhe*

Answer: माझे; ma, aa-matra, jha, e-matra

6.8 *Two rows, told apart by voice and breath*

Answer: ka kha ga gha; ca cha ja jha; u and uu below, the vocalic r opening the other way, candrabindu in a crescent, short a inside every consonant

Chapter 7

7.1 ण — *the tongue curled back*

Answer: ण; curled back to the ridge behind the teeth

7.2 ठ — *the curl, with the breath let out*

Answer: ठ; ण

7.3 ढ — *the curl, with the voice on*

Answer: ढ; ण; ढा

7.4 ण — *the nasal with the tongue curled back*

Answer: ण; ण; the retroflex one

7.5 प — *the lips, with the voice off*

Answer: प; ब

7.6 *The curled row, and one letter from the lips*

Answer: ढा ढा ढा ढा; पा; i-matra written left, u-matra hung below; चा चा जा

Chapter 8

8.1 ल — *the plain l, beside the curled one you know*

Answer: ल; ऌ

8.2 श — *the sh at the roof of the mouth*

Answer: श; स

8.3 ष — *the third sibilant, kept on the page*

Answer: ष; the same as श

8.4 उ — *short u standing on its own*

Answer: उ; the matra

8.5 ऊ — *long ū standing on its own*

Answer: ऊ; independent short, independent long, short matra, long matra

8.6 ए — *the vowel that opens ek*

Answer: ए; the e-matra

8.7 *Twenty-four signs, at real distance*

Answer: ला beside ला; शा and सा; उ, ऊ and ए; खा, ज्ञा, म्ना; पा

Chapter 9

9.1 *The last six, one chapter on*

Answer: ला beside ला; शा and सा; उ, ऊ and ए

Chapter 13

13.1 *Three signs after a durable gap*

Answer: धन्यवाद; ः आ भ

13.2 *Three more signs after a durable gap*

Answer: े ं त

13.3 *Keep three voiced consonants apart*

Answer: द ध ब

13.4 *The final three doorway signs*

Answer: य ऌ व

13.5 *Why Marathi two rhymes with three***Answer:** no**Also accepted:** no it copied three; it copied the pattern of three**13.6** *The six marks, with the page shut***Answer:** i before the letter; u and uu below; the vocalic-r curl below, opening the other way; candrabindu above in a crescent; independent a is its own letter; uu travels further**13.7** *Two rows, rebuilt from two questions***Answer:** ka kha ga gha; ca cha ja jha**13.8** *The curled row, without a model***Answer:** ṭa ṭha ḍa ṇa; pa**13.9** *The last six, without a model***Answer:** la beside ḷa; śa and ṣa; u, ū and e

Chapter 18

18.1 *One step later — retrieve मित्र***Answer:** mitra; to bind; tatsama**Also accepted:** मित्र; to bind; tatsama; mitra, bind, tatsama**18.2** *One step later — retrieve कुटुंब***Answer:** kutumb; neuter**Also accepted:** कुटुंब; neuter; kutumb, neuter

Chapter 21

21.1 *After a gap — मित्र***Answer:** mitra; bind; tatsama**Also accepted:** मित्र; bind; tatsama**21.2** *After a gap — कुटुंब***Answer:** kutumb; neuter**Also accepted:** कुटुंब; neuter**21.3** *Sibling retrieval***Answer:** bhau, bahin; bhau is related to brother**Also accepted:** भाऊ, बहीण; भाऊ**21.4** *Eye and ear retrieval***Answer:** dola, kaan; retroflex l**Also accepted:** डोळा, कान; ळ**21.5** *Mouth and nose retrieval***Answer:** tond, mukh, naak**Also accepted:** तोंड, मुख, नाक

21.6 *Three request nouns***Answer:** paani, chaha, dudh**Also accepted:** पाणी, चहा, दूध**21.7** *Three doing verbs***Answer:** ghene, vicharne, madat karne**Also accepted:** घेणे, विचारणे, मदत करणे**21.8** *Three mind-and-page verbs***Answer:** vichar karne, samajne, lihine**Also accepted:** विचार करणे, समजणे, लिहिणे**21.9** *Three core verbs***Answer:** asne, jane, yene**Also accepted:** असणे, जाणे, येणे**21.10** *Durable retrieval — मित्र***Answer:** mitra; to bind; tatsama**Also accepted:** मित्र; to bind; tatsama; mitra, bind, tatsama**21.11** *Count, then notice***Answer:** ek, don, tin, chaar, paach; chaar begins tsaa-**Also accepted:** एक, दोन, तीन, चार, पाच; tsaa**21.12** *Durable family comparison***Answer:** mitra; bind; tatsama; kutumb; neuter**Also accepted:** मित्र; bind; tatsama; कुटुंब; neuter

Chapter 22

22.1 *The doorway word, much later***Answer:** thank you; धन्यवाद**22.2** *First batch at long distance***Answer:** धन्यवाद; ः आ भ**22.3** *Second batch at long distance***Answer:** े ं त**22.4** *Voiced batch at long distance***Answer:** द थ ब**22.5** *Final batch at long distance***Answer:** य ळ व**22.6** *The six marks, a whole book later***Answer:** i before; u below; uu below; vocalic r below; candrabindu above; independent a on its own**22.7** *Two rows, at book distance***Answer:** ka kha ga gha; ca cha ja jha; jha**22.8** *The curled row, a whole book later***Answer:** ṭa ṭha ḍa ṇa; the dot means the tongue curls back; pa

22.9 *The last six, at book distance*

Answer: la; śa and ṣa; u, ū and e; spelling outlives the sound it recorded

Chapter 23

23.1 नाव — *the first form label*

Answer: नाव

Also accepted: naav; nav

23.2 शहर — *the city box*

Answer: शहर

Also accepted: shahar

23.3 भाषा — *the language box*

Answer: भाषा

Also accepted: bhasha; bhaasha

23.4 आवडते पेय — *favorite drink*

Answer: आवडते पेय

Also accepted: avadte pey

23.5 आवडती कृती — *favorite activity*

Answer: आवडती कृती

Also accepted: avadti kruti

23.6 मित्राचे नाव — *friend's name*

Answer: मित्राचे नाव

Also accepted: mitrache naav; mitrache nav

23.7 *Copy the first three rows*

Answer: नाव; शहर; भाषा

Also accepted: naav; shahar; bhasha; नाव शहर भाषा

23.8 *Copy the last three rows*

Answer: आवडते पेय; आवडती कृती

Also accepted: avadte pey; avadti kruti

23.9 *Hide, wait, write the first three labels*

Answer: नाव; शहर; भाषा

23.10 *Hide, wait, write the last three labels*

Answer: आवडते पेय; आवडती कृती; मित्राचे नाव

Chapter 24

24.1 *Write to one named reader*

Answer: नमस्कार मीरा.

24.2 *Add the sender's name*

Answer: माझं नाव अरुण आहे.

24.3 *One line for meeting the reader*

Answer: भेटून आनंद झाला.

24.4 *Begin the purpose: Marathi*

Answer: मला मराठी येते.

24.5 *Add one reading line*

Answer: मी मराठी वाचतो.

24.6 *Add one writing line*

Answer: मी माझं नाव लिहितो.

24.7 *Add the shortest skill line*

Answer: मी बोलतो.

24.8 *Keep both pieces of thinking*

Answer: मी विचार करतो.

24.9 *Return to the dative frame*

Answer: मला मराठी समजते.

24.10 *One word can be a full line*

Answer: धन्यवाद.

24.11 *The first farewell line*

Answer: पुन्हा भेटू.

24.12 *The dated farewell line*

Answer: उद्या भेटू.

24.13 *Order the opening block*

Answer: नमस्कार मीरा. माझं नाव अरुण आहे. भेटून आनंद झाला.

24.14 *Order the first three skills*

Answer: मला मराठी येते. मी मराठी वाचतो. मी माझं नाव लिहितो.

24.15 *Order the second three skills*

Answer: मी बोलतो. मी विचार करतो. मला मराठी समजते.

24.16 *Order the closing block*

Answer: धन्यवाद. पुन्हा भेटू. उद्या भेटू.

24.17 *Connect the four known blocks*

Answer: नमस्कार मीरा. माझं नाव अरुण आहे. भेटून आनंद झाला. मला मराठी येते. मी मराठी वाचतो. मी माझं नाव लिहितो. मी बोलतो. मी विचार करतो. मला मराठी समजते. धन्यवाद. पुन्हा भेटू. उद्या भेटू.

24.18 *Independent 30-40-word message*

Answer: नमस्कार मीरा. माझं नाव अरुण आहे. भेटून आनंद झाला. मला मराठी येते. मी मराठी वाचतो. मी माझं नाव लिहितो. मी बोलतो. मी विचार करतो. मला मराठी समजते. धन्यवाद. पुन्हा भेटू. उद्या भेटू.

Chapter 25

25.1 Choose the first three answers

Answer: name Arun; city Pune; language Marathi

25.2 Choose the last three answers

Answer: favorite drink tea; favorite activity reading; friend's name Mira

25.3 Enter the first three values

Answer: नाव: अरुण; शहर: पुणे; भाषा: मराठी

25.4 Repair one value, not the whole form

Answer: पुणे

Also accepted: अरुण; मराठी

25.5 Enter the last three values

Answer: आवडते पेय: चहा; आवडती कृती: वाचणे; मित्राचे नाव: मीरा

25.6 Repair endings before values

Answer: ते; ती; चे

Also accepted: -ते; -ती; -चे

25.7 Delay the first three entries

Answer: नाव: अरुण; शहर: पुणे; भाषा: मराठी

25.8 Delay the last three entries

Answer: आवडते पेय: चहा; आवडती कृती: वाचणे; मित्राचे नाव: मीरा

25.9 Join the two halves

Answer: नाव: अरुण; शहर: पुणे; भाषा: मराठी; आवडते पेय: चहा; आवडती कृती: वाचणे;
मित्राचे नाव: मीरा

25.10 Complete a new six-field form

Answer: नाव: मीरा; शहर: पुणे; भाषा: मराठी; आवडते पेय: दूध; आवडती कृती: लिहिणे; मित्राचे नाव: अरुण

Chapter 26

26.1 Four asked-for actions

Answer: paani dya krupaya, chaha aana krupaya, dudh theva

Also accepted: पाणी द्या कृपया, चहा आणा कृपया, दूध ठेवा

Chapter 27

27.1 One visit, four verbs

Answer: basa, mala baram vatam, chalel

Also accepted: बसा, मला बरं वाटतं, चालेल

Chapter 28

28.1 *Four things that pass between two people*

Answer: tumcham naav sanga, mi marathi shikto, paani milel ka

Also accepted: tumcham nav sanga, मी मराठी शिकतो, पाणी मिळेल का

Chapter 29

29.1 *The twelve, further apart*

Answer: basne, vatne, jhopne, chalne

Also accepted: बसणे, वाटणे, झोपणे, चालणे

29.2 *One frame, four sentences*

Answer: mala baram vatam, mala jhop yete, mala miltam

Also accepted: मला बरं वाटतं, मला झोप येते, मला मिळतं

29.3 *Recognition at distance: two signs and one sound*

Answer: nearer ts than ch

Also accepted: tsa; ts

29.4 *Recognition at distance: five things from further back*

Answer: mitra, kutumb, neuter

Also accepted: मित्र, कुटुंब, neuter

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

A

ी — **a mātrā that leans the other way**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

A Message for Mira

chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 143

a round flatbread — the one word in this chapter that never left Marathi’s own neighborhood, and Hindi’s word for bread altogether भाकरी (bhākārī)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 17, p. 105

ऌ — **a second vowel sign, and the simplest one in the script**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

A Six-Field Profile

chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 151

ः — **a small breath after a vowel**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

Add one reading line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Add one writing line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Add the sender’s name

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Add the shortest skill line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

again (punhā) पुन्हा (punhā)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 65

B

Begin the purpose: Marathi

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

brother — worn down by sound change rather than borrowed whole, and a secure cousin of the English word भाऊ (bhāū)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 111

C

Choose the first three answers

script and writing topic; Chapter 25, p. 151

Choose the last three answers

script and writing topic; Chapter 25, p. 151

Complete a new six-field form

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

Connect the four known blocks

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Copy the first three rows

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

Copy the last three rows

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

Courtesy, Responses, and Leave-Taking

chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 25

D

Delay the first three entries

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

Delay the last three entries

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

E

े — e above the headline

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

ear — a consonant cluster simplified the same way don copied teen, and a root disputed among Sanskrit scholars कान (kān)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 119

Enter the first three values

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

Enter the last three values

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

eye — carrying Marathi’s signature extra letter ऌ, and a word that started life meaning something else entirely डोळा (ḍoḷā)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 119

Eye, Ear, Mouth, and Nose

chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 119

F

family — another word borrowed whole from Sanskrit, and neuter where Hindi made the same word masculine कुटुंब (kuṭumb)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 111

Family Memory at Real Distance

chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 127

Farewells

chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 65

Friend and Family

chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 111

friend — taken up whole from Sanskrit rather than worn down, and a cousin of the god-name Mithra मित्र (mitra)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 111

G**Give, Bring, Put**

chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 157

H**Hear Thanks, Then Meet Six Signs**

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 13

Heart

chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 125

heart — the surest cognate taught so far, and a new vowel sign that has waited thirteen chapters हृदय (hṛdaya)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 20, p. 125

hello / goodbye (namaskār) नमस्कार (namaskar)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

Hide, wait, write the first three labels

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

Hide, wait, write the last three labels

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

How Are You?

chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 61

how are you? (tumhī kase āhāt?) तुम्ही कसे आहात? (tumhī kase āhāt?)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 61

how (kasā m. / kaśī f. / kasaṁ n.) कसा / कशी / कसं (kasā / kaśī / kasaṁ)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 61

I**“I’ll be going” (yeto m. / yete f.) येतो / येते** (yeto / yete)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 25

I’m well, thank you (mī barā āhe) मी बरा आहे (mī barā āhe)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 10, p. 61

I (mī) मी (mī)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 61

I speak Marathi (gendered) मी मराठी बोलतो (mī marāṭhī bolto)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 12, p. 69

Independent 30–40-word message

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Introducing Yourself

chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 55

is (āhe) आहे (āhe)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 55

J**Join the two halves**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

K**Keep both pieces of thinking**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

L**॥ — long ā, the deeper hook below**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

M

Marks Above, Below, and Beside the Letter

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 31

milk — back to inherited Sanskrit, and the same PIE root**behind English doughty** दूध (dūdh)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 105

mouth — the everyday word, beside a formal Sanskrit doublet**you already half-know** तोंड (tōḍ)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 119

my (mājhamī, neuter) माझं (mājhamī)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 55

my name is... (mājhamī nāv ... āhe) माझं नाव ... आहे (mājhamī nāv ... āhe)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 55

N

Namaskar, Piece by Piece

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

name (nāv) नाव (nāv)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 55

no / is not (nāhī) नाही (nahi)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 25

no problem / you're welcome (kāhī harkat nāhī) काही हरकत**नाही (kāhī harkat nāhī)**

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 61

nose — completing the face, and the one of the four with the**most secure English cousin नाक (nāk)**

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 19, p. 119

Numbers One to Five

chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 73

O

okay / fine (baram) बरं (baram)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 25

One heard answer — write what you know

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

One line for meeting the reader

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

◌ँ — **one nasal dot**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

one to five — nearly Hindi's, with two tells in the spelling and one in the sound एक दोन तीन चार पाच (ek don tīn chār pāch)

Chapter 13, p. 73

One word can be a full line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Order the closing block

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Order the first three skills

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Order the opening block

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Order the second three skills

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

P

pleased to meet you (bheṭūn ānand jhālā) भेटून आनंद झाला (bheṭūn ānand jhālā)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 55

R

Repair endings before values

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

Repair one value, not the whole form

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 25, p. 151

Return to the dative frame

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

S

see you again (punhā bheṭū) पुन्हा भेटू (punhā bheṭū)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 65

see you tomorrow (udyā bheṭū) उद्या भेटू (udyā bheṭū)

explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 65

ि — **short i, written before, read after**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

ु — **short u, a small hook below**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

sister — worn down like भाऊ, but deliberately not its English counterpart's cousin बहीण (bahīṇ)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 111

Sit, and How You Feel

chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 163

Six More Signs Make Thank You Readable

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 19

Six Small Form Labels

chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 137

T

take care (kāḷjī ghyā) काळजी घ्या (kāḷjī ghyā)

explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 65

Taking, Asking, Helping, Liking

chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 97

tea — the one request in this chapter that is not inherited at all, and Marathi's first masculine noun चहा (chahā)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 105

thank you (dhanyavād) धन्यवाद (dhanyavad)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 13

The Core Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 79

The Curled Row, and One Letter from the Lips

chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 43

The dated farewell line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

The Doorway Signs at Long Distance

chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 133

The first farewell line

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

The First Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 69

◌ — the mark that DELETES the inherent vowel and glues two consonants together

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

The Mind and the Page

chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 89

◌ — the moon holding a dot

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

The Throat Row and the Palate Row

chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 37

The Twelve, Further Apart

chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 175

ृ — the vocalic *r* mark, said *ru*

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

ी — the vowel sign that replaces the inherent *a*

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

to ask — the word for thinking with an infinitive ending on it, so asking and thinking share a root विचारणे (vichārṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 97

to be got, to be found — a fourth verb that puts you in the dative, and it carries ष मिळणे (miḷṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 169

to be — the verb behind आहे, the word a Marathi sentence ends on असणे (asṇe)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 79

to bring — leading, with the same little prefix that turned going into coming आणणे (āṇṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 157

to come — the same Sanskrit going-root as जाणे, turned around by one small prefix येणे (yeṇe)

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 79

to drink — the verb that was already inside the word for water पिणे (piṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 157

to eat — and an infinitive that doubles as a noun of the third gender Hindi lost खाने (khāṇe)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 14, p. 79

to feel, to seem — the answer to how are you, built the way liking and knowing were वाटणे (vāṭṇe)

explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 27, p. 163

to give — the verb the request pattern had been doing without देणे (deṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 157

to go — and the present tense you cannot say without declaring your own gender जाणे (jāṇe)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 14, p. 79

to help — an Arabic word for “reinforcements” that came through Persian and took करणे मदत करणे (madat karṇe)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 97

to know — built as “is known to me”, so the knower is never the subject माहीत असणे (māhīt asṇe)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 79

- to learn — built, at root, out of wanting to be able** शिकणे (shikṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 169
- to like — a native Marathi verb that puts you in the dative, beside** प्रेम करणे, **to love** आवडणे (āvaḍṇe)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 97
- to live, to stay** (rāhṇe) राहणे (rāhṇe)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 69
- to put, to keep — a standing word, worn down from Sanskrit through Prakrit** ठेवणे (ṭhevṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 157
- to read — from a causative meaning “to make speak,” cousin of voice and vocal** वाचणे (vāchṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 89
- to say these words — the readable partner of the verb you took by ear** म्हणणे (mhaṇṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 169
- to see — from Sanskrit paś-, the root that reached English as spectacle, inspect and spy** पाहणे (pāhṇe)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 79
- to sit — the first word a Marathi host says to you, and a root that named villages** बसणे (baṣṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 163
- to sleep — another inherited word Marathi let go of, where Hindi kept it** झोपणे (jhopṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 163
- to speak** (bolṇe) बोलणे (bolṇe)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 69
- to take — the verb hiding inside “take care,” on the Indo-European root behind English grab** घेणे (gheṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 97
- to tell — a word you can use by ear today, whose last consonant your hand has not been taught yet** सांगणे (sāṅṇe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 169
- to think — literally “to do a thought,” on a root that means turning something over** विचार करणे (vichār karṇe)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 89
- to understand — built on the root that gave the Buddha his name, and taking the dative like knowing** समजणे (samajṇe)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 89
- to walk, to go along — and the everyday yes that means it will walk** चालणे (chālṇe)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 163

to work (kām karṇe) काम करणे (kām karṇe)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 69

to write — from a root that meant “to scratch,” and the chapter’s four verbs run back together लिहिणे (lihīṇe)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 89

Two Sibilants, One Liquid, and Three Standalone Vowels

chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 49

W

Water, Tea, Milk, and Bhakri

chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 105

water — the first thing you would actually ask for, and the request pattern that opens a spine node this track had never realized पाणी (pāṇī)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 105

(we’ll) meet (bheṭū) भेटू (bheṭū)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 65

what (kāy) काय (kāy)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 55

What Passes Between Two People

chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 169

what’s your name? (tumchaṁ nāv kāy āhe?) तुमचं नाव काय

आहे? (tumchaṁ nāv kāy āhe?)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 55

Why Marathi *two* rhymes with *three*

etymology topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 73

Write to one named reader

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 24, p. 143

Y

yes (ho) हो (ho)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 25

you (tū familiar / tumhī respectful) तू / तुम्ही (tū / tumhī)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 55

Other

अ — the vowel your consonants have been hiding

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 5, p. 31

आ — long aa standing alone

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

आवडती कृती — favorite activity

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

आवडते पेय — favorite drink

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

उ — short u standing on its own

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

ऊ — long ū standing on its own

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

ए — the vowel that opens ek

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

क — the consonant ka

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

ख — ka with the breath let out

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

ग — the same place, with the voice on

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

घ — voice and breath together

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

च — one letter, two Marathi sounds

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

छ — the palate, with the breath let out

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

ज — voice at the palate

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

झ — the letter inside mājhe

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 37

ट — the tongue curled back

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 43

ठ — the curl, with the breath let out

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 43

ड — the curl, with the voice on

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 43

ण — the nasal with the tongue curled back

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 43

त — dental ta

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

द — dental da

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

ध — dha, voiced and breathy

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

धन्यवाद — now read what you already mean

script and writing topic; Chapter 3, p. 19

न — the consonant na

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

नमस्कार — seven pieces, all of them already yours

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

नाव — the first form label

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

प — the lips, with the voice off

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 43

ब — ba without the puff

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

भ — bha, with a puff of breath

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 13

भाषा — the language box

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

म — the consonant ma

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

मित्राचे नाव — friend's name

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

य — ya

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

र — the last consonant of the greeting

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

ल — the plain l, beside the curled one you know

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

ळ — Marathi's curled-back lla

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

व — between English v and w

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 19

श — the sh at the roof of the mouth

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

शहर — the city box

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 23, p. 137

ष — the third sibilant, kept on the page

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 49

स — the consonant sa

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

हो — look, hide, write, compare

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ह — the consonant ha

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1